
Mrs Bernice
Ofeibea Offei
25th February 1963 – 12th September 2026

TABLE OF Contents

OFFICIATING MINISTERS....8
ORDER OF SERVICE....8
- Part One – Pre-Burial Service....8
- Part Two – Burial and Thanksgiving Service....8
- Part Three – At the Cemetery....8

BIOGRAPHY OF THE LATE MRS. BERNICE OFEIBEA OFFEI....10
TRIBUTES....14
HUSBAND....15
SONS....20
- Kevin K. Offei....20
- Daniel K. Offei....22

MOTHER....24
SISTERS....25
- Eva....25
- Comfort....25
- Patience....26

DAUGHTERS SHE RAISED....29
- The Girls: Antoinette, Susie, Augusta & Grace....29
- Rhema and Gabrielle....30
- Dr. Sandra Esi Odonkor....31
- Mrs. Sarah Devis....32
- Hadija Nyante....32

NEPHEWS AND NIECES....34
- Janelle, Hilary, Roslyn and Walter to our dear Auntie Bernice....34
- Ewurakua, Belinda, Grace, Susana, Helena....35

COUSINS....35
- Mrs. Ofeibea Lomotey (nee Djoleto)....35
- Paternal Cousins....36
- Maternal Cousins....37

AUNTIES....37
MOTHER-IN-LAW (GRACE OFFEIBEA OFFEI)....38
BROTHERS-IN-LAW....39
- Fred Taylor....39
- Joseph Tagoe....40

SONS-IN-LAW....41
- Fred Damalie....41
- Albert Bright....42
- Kwadwo Owusu-Safo....42

BERNICE BEYOND THE STAGE....43
LEGON INTERDENOMINATIONAL CHURCH (LIC)....45
THE WORSHIP AND CREATIVE ARTS MINISTRY, LEGON INTERDENOMINATIONAL CHURCH....46
OLD ACHIMOTANS' ASSOCIATION (OAA) 1979....46
SCHOOLMATES OF BERNICE OFFEI (NÉE DJOLETO)....47
CALVARY ROAD INCORPORATED....50

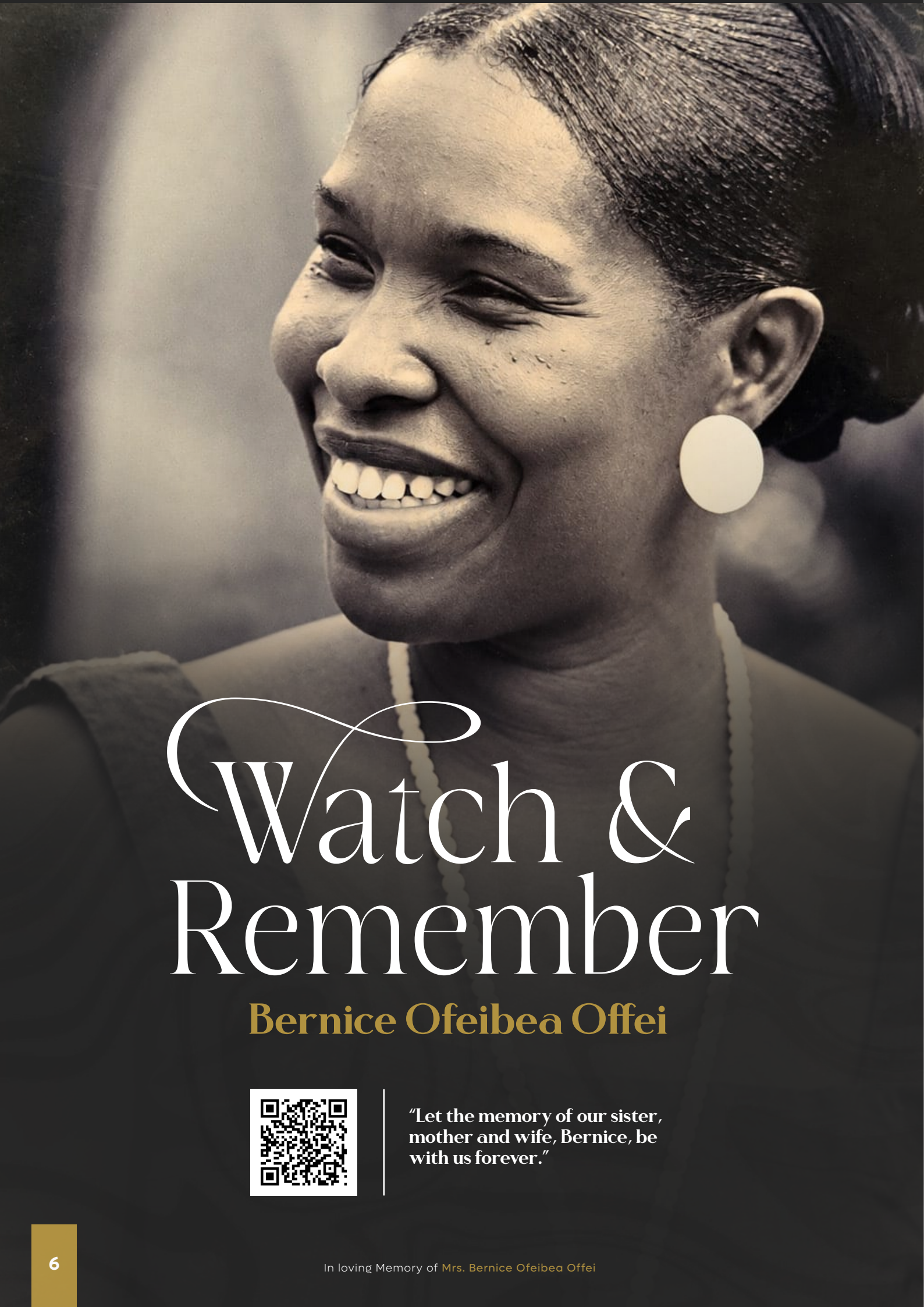
MEDIA EXCEL PRODUCTION....52
THE MUSICIANS UNION OF GHANA (MUSIGA)....52
T.V.O. LAMPTEY, KWESI DICKSON, AND KOJO FOLSON (BORAX)....53
STANDARD CHARTERED BANK, GHANA....55
MOST REV. PROF. JOHNSON K. ASAMOAH-GYADU....56
PASTOR MENSAH OTABIL CHANCELLOR, CENTRAL UNIVERSITY....58
REV. DR. NII AMOO DARKU....58
REV. FITZGERALD ODONKOR....60
REV. SPENCER CUNNAH AND KENSIT EVANGELICAL CHURCH....60
REV. BARIMAH KOFI ASARE & DOREEN KYEI-BAFFOUR....61
DIANA HOPESON....62
BERNICE TAMAKLOE AND FAMILY....63
PROF. E. KWEKU OSAM....64
PROF KWESI YANKAH....65
PROF. BILL BUENAR PUPLAMPU....66
PROF. ERIC YIRENKYI DANQUAH....66
PROF. ESTHER SAKYI-DAWSON....67
GLADYS BREW....68
FLORENCE HUTCHFUL....69
AWURAA AMMA ELEBLU....70
FRANKLIN ELEBLU....71
RABI BRIMAH....72
BOKPIN FAMILY....73
DR. EMMANUEL CANACOO....74
PHOTO GALLERY....75
HEPHZIBAH WORSHIP CONFERENCE & CMAG....76
GHAFES....77
INSPIRATIONAL HOUR MINISTRIES....78
LEGENDARY MINSTRELS ASSOCIATION OF GHANA (LeMAG)....78
CARDS SERVICES TEAM, STANDARD CHARTERED BANK, GHANA....78
NII OKAI....79
REV. KOFI AMPADU....80
REV. DR. JOYCE R. ARYEE....81
DR. SAMUEL KISSEADOO....82
APOSTLE JUDE HAMA....83
BETHEL AGYEMAN DONKOR....84
THE KORANTENGS....85
DR. GEORGE AMPONSEM....86
KAFUI OSUTEYE....87
NELLY ODOOM....87
DR. MAUREEN IHEANACHO....88
SIKA COLEMAN....89
AMB. DR. WINFRED NII OKAI HAMMOND....90
FRANK D. AMPONSAH-MENSAH ESQ. AND FAMILY....91
DEDO MATE-KODJO....92
MONICA SENANU....92
NANA ADJOA AND NANA AKUA SENANU....96



"Heaven Bound"

Jesus said to them,
"My food is to do the will of Him who
sent Me, and to finish His work"
(John 4:34 KJV).





Watch & Remember

Bernice Ofeibea Offei

"Let the memory of our sister, mother and wife, Bernice, be with us forever."

A Note to the Reader

These pages are our way of remembering Bernice.

Many knew her through her music: the voice, the songs, the ministry, but behind the music was a woman deeply rooted in faith, devoted to her family, generous in friendship and quietly faithful in the ordinary moments of life.

In these pages, we remember both: the Bernice whose songs reached many, and the Bernice known and loved by family and friends.

We hope that as you read, look through the photographs and revisit the music, you will smile, remember, give thanks, and perhaps hear once again the message that ran through so much of her life and ministry: to trust God and live for Him.

We thank God for her life, and for the privilege of sharing it with her.

OFFICIATING AND VISITING MINISTERS

REV. DR. JULIUS COOMSON
REV. IBRAHIM BAIDOO
REV. JFK MENSAH
REV. FRANCIS YAW BOAMAH
REV. AGNES PHILLIPS
REV. CECILIA-CLARA SIGFRID LYARUU
REV. EMMANUEL AGBOBLI
PROPHET CHRISTOPHER YAW ANNOR
REV. MAXWELL ARYEE
REV. SAMUEL KWESI DICKSON
REV. BETTY DONKOR
REV. EMMANUEL KITCHER
REV. EMMANUEL PAA JOE MARKWEI
REV. DANIEL ODONKOR
REV. MRS. THELMA ODONKOR
REV. EMMANUEL TITI-LARTEY
REV. KOFI OWUSU

ORDER OF BURIAL AND THANKSGIVING SERVICE

PART ONE – PRE-BURIAL SERVICE

1. Scripture Sentences
2. Hymn: "Father I know that all my life is portioned out for me" (MHB 602)
3. Prayer
4. Filing Past
5. Hymn: "Begone Unbelief, My Savior Is Near" (MHB 511)
6. Tributes
7. Filing Past
8. Hymn: "Workman Of God! O Lose Not Heart" (MHB 498)

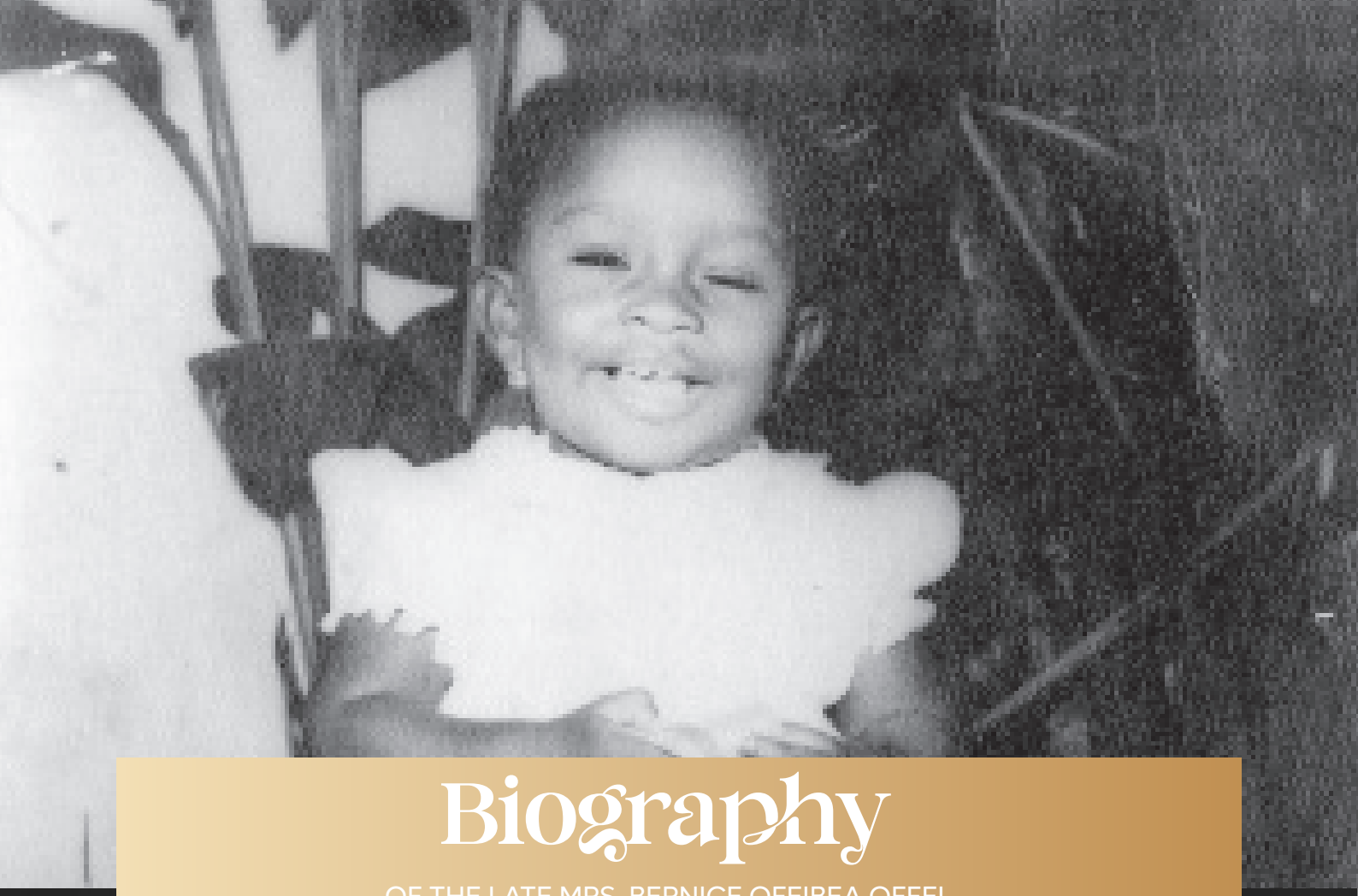
PART TWO – BURIAL AND THANKSGIVING SERVICE

1. Opening Sentences
2. Opening Prayer
3. Hymn: "Oh God Our Help In Ages Past" (MHB 878)
4. Biography
5. Tributes
6. Hymn: "In Heavenly Love Abiding" (MHB 528)
7. Tributes
8. Hymn: "Give Me The Wings Of Faith To Rise" (MHB 831)
9. Scripture Readings: Romans 8:31-39; John 14:1-4 and 27
10. Sermon
11. Offertory
12. Thanksgiving: "For All The Saints Who From Their Labors Rest" (MHB 832)
13. Announcements - Head of Family
14. Closing Hymn: "Now Praise We Great And Famous Men" (MHB 896)
15. Closing Prayer & Benediction
16. Dead March In Saul
17. Recession: "Guide Me, O Thou Great Jehovah" (MHB 615)

PART THREE –– AT THE CEMETERY

1. Hymn: "I'll Praise My Maker While I've Breath" (MHB 428)
2. Prayers
3. Committal
4. Hymn: "Immortal Invisible" (MHB 34)
5. Vote of Thanks
6. Benediction





Biography

OF THE LATE MRS. BERNICE OFEIBEA OFFEI

Early Life

The late Mrs. Bernice Ofeibea Offei was born in Accra on 25th February, 1963 to the late Mr. Walter Ofei Djoleto and his wife Mrs. Eva Aklerh Djoleto. She was the first of four daughters.

Education

Bernice attended preschool at a day nursery at Nyaniba Estates before proceeding to Royal Preparatory School, Osu. She completed Class Six in 1974, passing the Common Entrance Examination with the second-best results in the Greater Accra Region that year.

She gained admission to Achimota School, where she passed her O-Level with distinction, earning automatic admission to Sixth Form. She was an outstanding student who often won prizes on Speech and Prize-Giving Days. She was elected as the most suitable candidate for Girls' Senior Prefect for the 1980/81 academic year, a position she combined successfully with excellent academic and spiritual life.

She continued to the University of Ghana, Legon, Faculty of Agriculture, where she obtained a BSc in Agricultural Sciences and an MPhil in Crop Science. Though she held these degrees, neither agriculture nor academia appealed to her as a career.



After joining her husband in the United Kingdom, they decided she should pursue a second Master's degree in Information Technology to open up other career options. She enrolled at the University College London, where she

in 1998. Though it was a completely new field, she pursued it with great dedication and completed it successfully, which ultimately gave her a career path in banking.

Family

While studying at the Faculty of Agriculture, University of Ghana, she met the love of her life, Professor Samuel Kwame Offei. They married in October 1987, and their marriage was blessed with two sons, Kevin and Daniel. Their home not only sheltered their biological sons but also several daughters whom the Lord brought to them at different times. Together, they raised their sons and daughters in the fear of the Lord through their exemplary Christian lives and with God's guidance.

Career / Professional Life

After completing her studies in the United Kingdom, Bernice returned to Ghana and joined Standard Chartered Bank in May 1999. For nearly seventeen years, she distinguished herself in the banking profession while faithfully fulfilling her family and ministry commitments. In January 2016, when her stint at the Bank came to an end, she decided to focus more intentionally on the music ministry that had become an increasingly significant part of her life's work.



Christian Faith

As a child, Bernice fellowshipped with the Presbyterian Church of Ghana, Epiphany Congregation, Kaajaanor District, and later with Ebenezer Presbyterian Church, Osu. She gave her life to Christ quite early, at the beginning of her secondary school life, and later joined Calvary Road Incorporated, where she grew not only in her faith, but also in her ministry.

After marriage, she joined the Legon Interdenominational Church (LIC), where she remained a faithful member until her passing. As evident in her songs, Bernice understood the need for all to obtain salvation through the sacrifice of Christ. She believed firmly in the eternal sacrifice of Christ, as reflected in several of her songs, like "Mogya" and "Thank You" among others.

Entry into Music

According to Bernice, she first became aware of her musical talent when her primary class four teacher, the late Mr. Allotey, upon hearing her speak in class, drew her attention to the soothing and smooth nature of her voice and the possibility of her becoming a great singer. Taking a cue from his suggestion, she began discovering her musical gifts, which led to her ministry as a soloist and guitarist from the early age of 16.

Around the same time, she joined Calvary Road Incorporated, where she grew greatly as a singer with the Calvary Road Singers, joining in several of their recordings, including their famous trip to Nigeria for their first recording. While with the Calvary Road Singers, she steadily developed the solo ministry the Lord had placed upon her heart - a ministry that has blessed many to date.

Character

God has His own way of shaping each of us to suit our purposes and callings, and Bernice's case was no exception. Her sense of focus, self-discipline, determination and 'addiction' to excellence all came together to make her what she turned out to be and to assist her in fulfilling her destiny. As much as she enjoyed good friendships and loved spending time with friends, she was always careful to apportion her time to focus on her assignment. Being a wife, a mother and a sister to many, as well as a daughter, Bernice juggled all these roles to the best of her ability.

Major Life Milestones

The first major milestone, as one could almost hear her pointing out, was her born-again experience, which set her on the right trajectory for her life. Though she grew up in a

family where church attendance was sine qua non (non-negotiable), she later encountered Christ for herself at the beginning of her secondary school life.

Again, coming from a family where not too many had reached the higher echelons of education, it was quite an achievement for her to obtain two master's degrees. Her fruitful marriage to her beloved Prof. Kwame Offei was another stage of life to be grateful for.

Self-propelled, and with the encouragement of faithful friends like the late Rev. Owusu Afriyie of Youth Ambassadors for Christ Association (YAFCA), she took the bold step to record her first album, "We Are Victors," which opened the door for her subsequent albums.

Bernice received an award at the 2007 MTN Ceval Gospel Awards and two more at the 2009 MTN 10th Anniversary Ghana Music Awards: Best Female Vocal Performance (Solo) and Songwriter of the Year. She was deeply grateful but, as she often said, she was not singing for human awards. Though pleasantly surprised to be honoured, she gave all the glory to God.

Her 30th anniversary in music was a good reminder of God's faithfulness. She marked it not only with a musical concert at the National Conference Centre, but also with a breast cancer awareness campaign, thus becoming a key advocate for women's health.



Legacy

Apart from her studies, which she always gave serious attention to, her relationship with God, her ministry and her family formed the wider fabric of her life.

From the outset, she had a very consistent daily devotional life as the backbone of her relationship with the Lord. It was the norm to have her Bible, Daily Bread, and notebook tucked under her pillow, to be reached out for the moment she woke up. Indeed, she was a "born and bred" Scripture Union Daughter of Zion, always seeking to live in total obedience to her Maker. To her, holiness was the hallmark.

She valued her relationship with God and firmly understood that all she had attained was purely by grace. No doubt her songs, such as "N'adom Ara Kwa" and "It's By Grace," reflect this conviction. Fundamentally Word-based, her songs, such as "Heaven Bound," reflected her deep understanding of God's mercies and the strong hope she had in His salvation.

Departure

It was our heartfelt desire that Bernice would remain with us much longer, but the Lord, in His infinite wisdom, called her home after a brief period of hospitalization following her unceremonious departure from home on the 1st of September, 2026. She left this earthly life to be with her Maker on 12th September 2026, survived by her beloved husband, her two sons and the many daughters she became mother to, as well as her aged mother and three sisters.

Though our hearts are heavy with grief, we find comfort in knowing that she has gone to rest with the Lord. Like Paul, she could be saying, "I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. Now there is in store for me the crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous Judge, will award to me on that day - and not only to me, but also to all who have longed for his appearing" (2 Timothy 4:7-8 NIV).

Rest in peace, good soldier of Christ, till we meet again!

In this world, we live by the grace of the Most High

















Tributes





TRIBUTE FROM HUSBAND TO MY BELOVED WIFE, MRS. BERNICE OFFEI

"Who can command things to happen without the Lord's permission? (Lamentations 3:37 NLT).....

On Saturday, September 12, 2026, the quiet, agonizing hours of the early morning in the Intensive Care Unit at UGMC, became the darkest moment of my life. Standing beside our son, Daniel, we watched as the doctors fought to bring you back to life—only to gently tell us there was no pulse. Our Lord whom you served with an unwavering devotion called you home to eternal rest. It is the hardest thing I have ever had to do. It is heart breaking, yet my soul overflows with gratitude to God for blessing me with the privilege of walking this life beside such a remarkable, extraordinary woman.



My wife, my friend

Our paths first crossed in 1982 in the Department of Crop Science, University of Ghana while you were pursuing your Bachelor's degree. Following one practical lesson, we found ourselves engaged in a discussion about several biblical concepts. That conversation marked the beginning of a friendship that would stand the test of time and eventually blossom into marriage. Thereafter, we had regular meetings for Bible study and fellowship which became an important part of our lives and continued over the years.

By the end of 1983, our friendship had grown remarkably strong and culminated in our marriage in 1987. I recall our mutual decision to seek the Lord's guidance and confirmation before making any important decision such as marriage. I admired the seriousness with



which you approached matters of faith and commitment even at that time. Looking back, those years of our friendship were not merely a period of waiting; they were years of divine preparation. They laid the foundation for the enduring partnership, friendship, and love that we shared throughout our marriage. You demonstrated your faith in God in every way. I recall that you insisted that we return home after I finished my PhD in the UK in 1995 when the country was going through challenging times. And it was because you believed that God would bless us irrespective of our location and circumstances!

For over four decades, the world knew your radiant voice, your gift as an award-winning songwriter, and the deep faith that anchored your music. You were my lovely and beloved partner, my confidante, and my counsellor. You were my prayer partner, the absolute heart of our home, and my greatest encouragement. Despite the heavy demands of the administrative positions I occupied in the University of Ghana and other organisations, I knew I could always come home to peace. You had a quiet strength and never sought the spotlight, yet light followed you and brightened wherever you went. Your main focus in life was to do our Master's will and minister to people through the songs you sang. You were so passionate about this ministry that you requested that a music room be created when we were designing the structure of our house.

The Lord blessed us with two sons. However, our family extended far beyond them, as we also had the privilege of parenting four other young women, and many others who passed through our home during their formative years. Together, we sought to nurture them in the Christian faith, teaching them sound biblical doctrine and helping them gain the assurance of their salvation. You possessed an exceptionally generous and compassionate heart, and you lived out your faith with genuine sincerity. You warmly welcomed everyone who became part of our family and loved them as if they were your own children. Never once did you complain, even when our resources had to be stretched to accommodate the needs of a growing household. Instead, you gave freely of your time, energy, wisdom, and affection, creating a home where everyone felt accepted, valued and loved.

To our two sons and daughters, you were a devoted and nurturing mother/grandmother, combining unwavering discipline with boundless love. You taught them that education was important, that faith was not merely for Sundays but a daily walk with God, and that talent, no matter how great, was of little value without humility and godly character. Through your example, they learned lessons that no classroom could teach and received a foundation that has continued to guide their lives. Your influence reached far beyond the walls of our home. The lives you touched, the values you instilled, and the love you shared remain a lasting testimony to a life faithfully lived in service to God and to others.



Service to God Through Music

You were very devoted to serving God, and your music was first and foremost a ministry. You often spoke of your wish to give your CDs/cassettes away freely as an evangelistic tool. I admired the heart behind it, although, after all we had invested in producing them, I must confess that giving them all away for free was one vision I didn't quite appreciate as enthusiastically as you did! For you, the value of your music was never in what it could earn, but the souls it could



reach, demonstrating your passion for reaching souls for the kingdom. A passion that I later wholeheartedly embraced in the course of time. Your songs were inspirations to many, and you will be remembered as one of the finest gospel voices of our generation. I was utterly dismayed when you told me you were not selected to join the Achimota School choir on your first audition. It is obvious that the assessment criteria used by the music instructors were not a true reflection of your immense talent.

From your first album *We Are Victors* (1991), to *Hold On* (1997), Mɛ Kɔso (2003), *Grateful* (2004), and *Life Is Short* (2007), you produced songs that have become our national hymns of hope. Bernice, you were always thinking of how your gift can be used to serve God and bless others. I will always remember the many long nights we stayed up together, debating which Akan word or expression would best capture the message you wanted to convey through your Twi songs. Sometimes, we would linger over a single word, refer to the Twi Bible, go back and forth until we found the expression that carried the depth, meaning and impact you were searching for. You cared so deeply that the message in your heart was not simply to be heard but truly understood and felt. Those conversations, those little debates, those late nights together seemed so ordinary then. Today, they are among the precious memories of our life together that will hold close to my heart forever.

Your song *'Hold On'* encouraged a generation not to give up. Whilst *"Life Is Short"* reminded us that our days are numbered and must be lived for Christ. Your songs like Kaashe Gbeyei, Nyame Kokroko, N'adom Ara Kwa, No One Compares, The Heavens are Telling, Who Could Stand, Whom have I; were not just lyrics; they were sermons. In 2009, when you won Best Female Vocal Performance and Songwriter of the Year at the Vodafone Ghana Music Awards, you placed the plaques on the table and said, "Kwame, to God be the glory, not to me." That is Bernice.

I was happy to be part of your journey and proud to be the one who bought you your very first personal guitar.

The Woman Behind The Voice

Many were surprised to learn that despite being an award-winning gospel star, you were also a thorough professional banker with Standard Chartered Bank, an MPhil holder in Crop Science from the University of Ghana, and had an MSc in Information Technology from the University College of London, United Kingdom. You excelled in the boardroom and in the studio because you believed whatever you do, do it for the Lord.

My dear Bernice, you were deeply spiritual, and incredibly compassionate. You could spend hours counseling young women and supporting others without ever announcing it. You lived your life with such grace, elegance and purpose. Whether you were balancing a demanding professional career, nurturing our children, or spending hours writing lyrics that would uplift generations, you did it all with a quiet strength that I deeply admired. You walked away from the familiar halls of banking to dedicate your full self to ministry, trusting completely in the God you served so faithfully.



Bernice, you were my life's companion in the truest sense – my safe place and my home. You knew when to encourage me, when to challenge me and, often just what to say to spur me on. I remember, as a Senior Lecturer, proudly telling you that I was considering applying for Associate Professor. After listening

to everything I had achieved, your response was simply, "Is that all you have been able to publish all this while?" I remember thinking, this woman paaa! But that was your way – a few words, quietly spoken, that somehow made me expect more of myself. Two years later, I became a full Professor. Looking back, I realise just how often your subtle encouragement propelled me forward.



Our Last Days

The last couple of weeks have been heart-wrenching, and a harrowing journey of anguish that words cannot even begin to describe. A journey no husband wishes to travel. After stepping out of the house on that fateful day of 1st September 2026, our family was thrown into unimaginable distress. We searched and followed all the leads given to us, but to no avail. Members of the church, friends far and near joined in the search. The nation searched with us and prayed with us. We were overwhelmed with joy and relief when we found you! The entire nation and friends abroad, all celebrated with us. We thought the worst was over, but on 12th September, you went to be with the Lord.

My Farewell

My dearest Bernice, your favourite question in your songs was, "Life is so short, where will you spend eternity?" Today, I know you are spending it in the bosom of the Father you sang about all through your life. This timeless anthem echoes in my mind now more than ever. I keep reflecting on those very words, through which you reminded everyone that life is fleeting like the wind. In fact, you sang those truths not just as melodies, but as a profound philosophy on cherishing every single moment God gives us.

Though the suddenness of your departure has left an unfillable void in my life and in our family, I take comfort in the beautiful years we shared and the legacy you leave behind. Through your songs like "Hold On" and "Kaashe Gbeyei", you admonished us to trust in the Lord through every storm. Today, those are the exact words I must whisper to my own heart as I try to navigate a world without you.

Thank you for loving me. Thank you for extending your love to all who came into our lives. Thank you for letting me be the man beside the legend.

You spent your life singing about the goodness of God and His unfailing grace. Now, you are resting in His eternal presence. The voice that brought so much healing and joy to the nation and beyond has joined the heavenly choir, but the echo of your love remains vividly alive in my heart

You held on to your faith to the very end. Now you can finally take your rest.

I love you forever.

Rest in the arms of Jesus until we meet again.

Ps 125:1 "They that trust in the Lord shall be as Mt Zion, which can not be removed but abideth forever" KJV.....















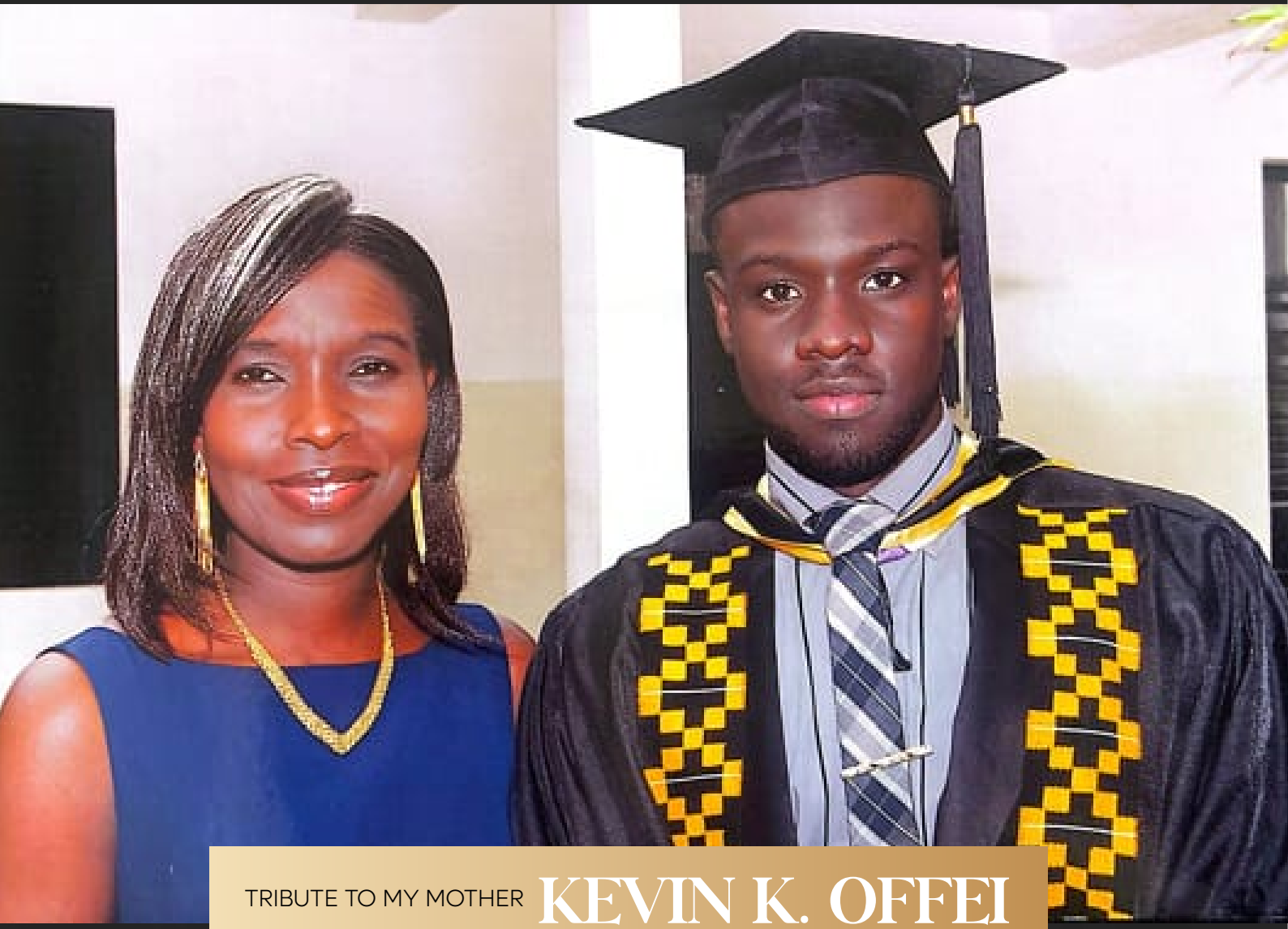








“I will keep loving You till the day I die”



TRIBUTE TO MY MOTHER

KEVIN K. OFFEI

To many people across Ghana, you were Bernice Offei, the gospel singer whose voice became a source of comfort, encouragement and faith to countless people. Your songs carried messages of hope, perseverance and, above all, a desire to one day be with God. Your voice healed and soothed wounds that sometimes could not be healed by anything else.

But to me, you were simply my mother, and I think that is the part of your life that I will miss the most. You never needed to live an extravagant life for people to know your worth. That was never what defined you.
I remember being about eight years old and accompanying you on your many music ministrations at events and in churches. Sometimes, as we were leaving, the organisers would chase after you "Aunty Bernice, won't you collect any money? Won't you charge?" You would turn it down until they practically forced you to take it. As a child, I used to eye those envelopes and wonder, why doesn't this woman like money? Lol.

I understand now that you valued purpose more than riches, and that your legacy was always going to be much bigger than material things. I remember one special moment when I woke up early one morning and found you sitting quietly by my bedside. I went back to sleep, and when I woke up about 20 minutes later, you were still there, sitting right beside me. After that experience, I started intentionally leaving my door unlocked just because I knew you would be coming there again. Looking back now, I realise how much those little moments meant to me.

You also allowed me to experience parts of your world. I remember going to the studio with Uncle TVO Lamptey, Borax and the others, recording into the night. Anytime I hear the song "You Are Worthy," I remember the laughter and joy that was shared in that studio while it was being recorded. It hits differently now that you are gone. At the time,



they seemed like ordinary moments. Today, they are priceless memories of my mother that I wish I could have back.

There are so many things I learnt from you, especially empathy. You taught me that people's struggles matter. You taught me not to be so quick to judge people because we never truly know what someone else is carrying.

When I decided to start my own business, you were one of the very few people who believed in me. You would take my flyers and share them in your office and at church with so much pride. You would look at me and say, "Kwesi, everyone started from somewhere. God won't abandon my son." Those words carried me.

There was a time during my first year at Legon Business School, I went to get food on campus with a friend. Coincidentally, the food vendor was playing Mum's song on her radio at the time. My friend quickly told her, "Madam, ɔbaa no ne ba no no!" - "Madam, this is her son!" She was so excited that she gave us our food for free. My friend looked at me and said, "You better not go and eat anywhere without me again!"

I believe you came to this earth to serve a perfect purpose, and when that purpose was fulfilled, God called you home. When I think about your life now, I think about the disciples - Peter, Paul and the others - who came, served their purpose and eventually made their grand exit to be with the Lord. I believe this is your grand exit.

It hurts deeply because, as your son, I would have wanted more time. More conversations. More memories. More ordinary days that I would probably have taken for granted. But your own music reminds us of something important: life is short.

That message was present throughout your ministry. You spent your life reminding people to think beyond this world and to prepare themselves for eternity. And now, Mum, that message feels different because the woman who sang about heaven is now the one we are saying goodbye to.

So the question your songs asked all those years ago now feels even more personal: Are we going to be with the Father after death? That is the question you leave behind for all of us.
Your voice touched people you never met. People loved you across the country because your music spoke to something deeper than entertainment. It spoke to faith. It spoke to hope. It spoke to the human struggle.
But beyond all of that, I am grateful that I got to call you "Mum."
I know you are up there in heaven, singing and praising God alongside the angels with your melodious voice.

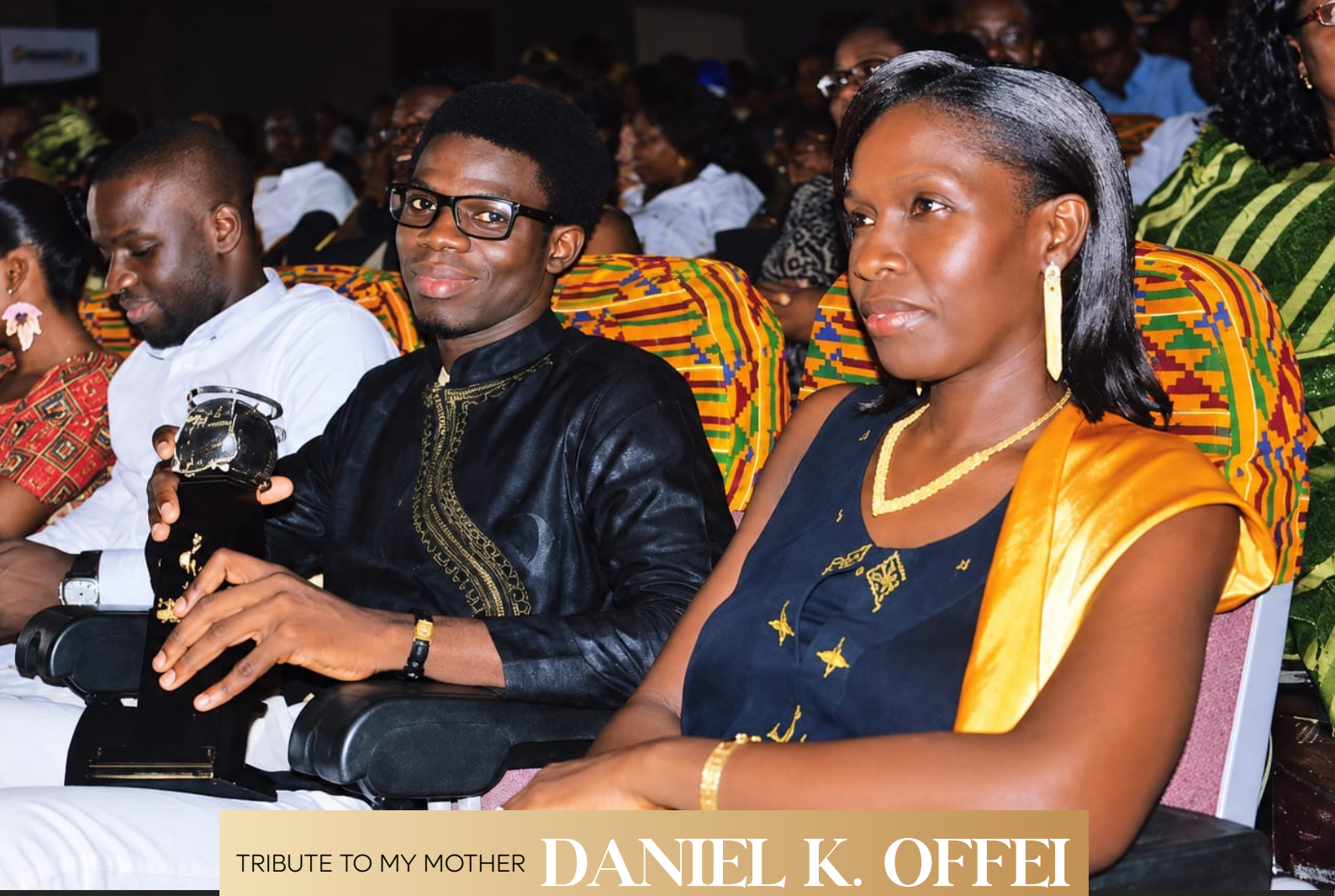
Thank you for the lessons. Thank you for the encouragement. Thank you for the love. Thank you for teaching me to care. Thank you for showing me, through your own life and music, that our time on earth is temporary and that our ultimate destination should be with God.

I don't know if there is ever a perfect way to say goodbye to your mother.
But I know this:
You came.
You served.
You touched lives.
You left your mark.

And now, when your work here is done, you have gone home to be with the Father you spent your whole life singing about.

Ayekoo.

Rest well, Mum.



TRIBUTE TO MY MOTHER

DANIEL K. OFFEI

"I don't know where I am going, or what I am going to do. I don't even know the way I am going to go..."

Sometimes our pathways are not clear. Often they are clouded in confusion and doubt. All I know is that you are in your Daddy's hands, and He has led you there. We knew where you were going, Mummy. We just did not know how you would go.

"Dani, Mummy has been moved to the ICU. Daddy says they are monitoring her condition."
I believe it was on that Friday, September 11, that the heavens started telling and preparing for your welcome party. I remember that fateful morning...

At exactly 5:51 a.m., my phone rang. "Hello, Mr. Offei. Please, can you come to the hospital with your family? Your mother's situation has changed."
"What do you mean, it has changed? What is wrong with my mother?"
"Sir, I'm sorry. I cannot say. I was only asked to call you in."

My heart sank into my stomach. Like the spillway of the Akosombo Dam thrown open, a flood of emotion made every step to my dad's room feel a thousand miles long.

With no time to waste, I rushed to UGMC, and there you lay with the doctors making every attempt to resuscitate you. Dad joined us soon after. For the boy who stood at LIC on Friday night, tomorrow had come, and you were gone.

I remember the doctors saying, "Let's call it," and how loud the silence was in my ears as your body, in a bag, was taken away to the morgue. Out of the dust of the earth Elohim formed man, and to dust we shall return; for it is appointed unto men once to die, and after this the judgment.

Down to the morgue we went, and from there to Transitions. At both the UGMC morgue and Transitions, barely five minutes after we had brought you in, the attendants asked us to come and identify the body we had just brought in. Standard operating procedure, I suppose. I must confess that after the first time, I could not hold back. My masculinity flew out of the window,



and all that was left manly about me was probably my beard, as I broke down in tears.

But at the second identification, it felt as if the Lord was telling me, "Look at her again." Standing over what remained of you, I noticed that slight smile on your face. It was as if you had already seen the verdict of your judgment before you left, and were smiling straight into your heavenly reward.

Your life was never short of principle in practice. You found a way to be stern, yet in the most ladylike manner, one that could make every GeyHey girl jealous.

Growing up at Ayido Flats, Sunday mornings had a regular feature song: "Daniel, you are always late! Eh, I told you to iron your clothes for church yesterday. You boys will walk to church today; we will leave you. When we talk, you don't listen. Bye!" And you were gone.

Your seat in the first few rows at church made it hard to miss you, and I had to consciously tell myself, in one instance, not to look in your direction during a stage play because you always beamed with a broad smile that would have made me break character and smile back, which would have ruined the drama. The type of smile that encouraged even when you knew you had forgotten your lines and all was not well.

No one could miss your stand whenever we discussed current trends or issues on which the rest of us had compromised: "Eeh, call me colo or old-fashioned. These things are not right, and we cannot be doing them as Christians."

You wrote songs not for the stage, but for the character of the Christian and the heart of a kingdom man. Yes, even jumping the red light featured in your gospel.

If we have sown [the seed of] spiritual good among you, [is it too] much if we reap from your material benefits? If others share in this rightful claim upon you, do not we [have a still better and greater claim]? However, we have never exercised this right, but we endure everything rather than put a hindrance in the way [of the spread] of the good news (the Gospel) of Christ. 1 Corinthians 9:11–12

It seems you discovered this passage early in life and decided to compete with the Apostle Paul in his boasting. We never understood why you would not accept material gain from your work of ministry. I remember to this day how you fought with your management over gate fees for your 30th anniversary in music. I mean, who does a music ministration at the National Theatre and charges the barest minimum, even in today's Accra?

To me, it always felt as if you never got your due from your music endeavours through the years. But you understood the difference between performance and ministration. You paid a price for eternal crowns that none of us here will ever fully understand.

Perhaps many of us missed the subliminal notes you left in your songs. Truly, you were heaven-bound, and the weights that hold men bound to this life had no latch on you.

I still remember that one ministration. After you had ministered, the host pastor prayed for children and asked parents who wished to dedicate their children to serve the Lord to stand. I can still see the look on your face as you stood up to implicate me, when I was not even sure of myself. Unfortunately, due to your health, you never got to see a glimpse of what you prayed for. I never got to manifest my greatest desire for a testimony of your healing someday in the future by God's grace.

You remembered your Creator and made sure you accounted for your days here. It is not about the number of days one lives, but about the quality of the investment one returns unto the Lord.

Thank you for showing us that it is possible to do this as a mother, a career woman, a wife and a woman in ministry. The gospel of your life has been preached to us all.

Rest well, Mummy. Until we meet again.
Your son, Daniel

TRIBUTE BY MOTHER FROM A

LOVING MOTHER
TO HER BELOVED DAUGHTER

"I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith" (2 Timothy 4:7 NKJV).

How do I write a tribute to my own child, just when I should be looking forward to you writing one for me when my time on earth is done?

Bernice, 63 years ago, you were the joy and pride of my life when God gave you to us as our very firstborn child. You brought so much joy to the family, especially as it turned out that beneath your very beautiful and gentle appearance lay so much treasure, soon to exhibit itself in many aspects of your life.
As a firstborn, you turned out to be a great example and pacesetter for your siblings, as well as to even the extended family, in many ways.

I watched you grow into a strong, focused, disciplined, and talented young woman, bringing great glory to God and to your family. As your mother, you made me proud with your academic excellence, your deep devotion to God from an early age, your very disciplined life which lightened my work as a mother, and your decent professional and social life. All these qualities were crowned by your unique musical talent, which was to bring you more fame than I could ever have hoped for.

Bernice, you always knew what you wanted and did not allow yourself to be dissuaded once you were convinced of what was right. You brought a lot of sunshine into our otherwise ordinary lives. You dedicated yourself to the assignment God had for you and, to the best of my judgement, you fulfilled it.

Your exemplary Christian life drew us all onto the right path with God. I remember when I decided to open my little shop in the house. You promised to support me if I could promise not to sell any alcoholic beverages. I wholeheartedly agreed and even settled for using the title of your song "Hold On" as the name of my enterprise. You simply lifted the banner in your walk with God!

Bernice, in my old age, I took it for granted that you would bury me. I never thought that I would have to witness your call to glory.

Needless to say, my heart is heavy, but I thank God that He chose me to be your mother.

As difficult as it is, I say with Job: "The Lord gave and the Lord has taken away; may the name of the Lord be praised" (Job 1:21b NIV).

I dare not be angry with God. He kept you for 63 years and has seen it fit to call you before me. You will always be my "Sweet Dede."

Go and rest well in His bosom until we meet again!

Rest well, my daughter. Rest well!











TRIBUTE FROM SISTERS

FROM EVA

"The righteous perishes, and no man takes it to heart; Merciful men are taken away, while no one considers that the righteous is taken away from evil. He shall enter into peace; They shall rest in their beds, each one walking in his uprightness" (Isaiah 57:1-2 NKJV).

Bjay," as I affectionately called you, you have expressly served the Lord. You gave your life to Christ in your early secondary school years and just walked the talk. You are an example of one setting their hands to the plough and not looking back.

Bjay, you were always a time-conscious person. Growing up, you made sure you were never late to school. Our primary school was a walking distance and whenever I delayed, you would take the lead. You couldn't be associated with lateness. You walked a path that the rest of us just had to follow.

When you chose Achimota School, we all had to follow. God knew you had to guide me, so in His wisdom, He put me in the same House you were in: Clark House.

How could I have been in Clark House under your watch and not go to Scripture Union (SU) meetings every Sunday? I remember in Form 3 when you were yet to come to school because the Lower 6 students hadn't come, one Sunday, I decided to 'rest' and not attend SU. Hmm! Even though you were not there, I wasn't spared being reprimanded on your behalf!!

Bjay, you were focused, intelligent and purpose driven. You were always first in class. Integrity was your hallmark. You will never bend the rules, not for any reason.
I remember after you wrote the Common Entrance exam, you came home having already calculated your results!!

In Sixth Form, you were the only girl among boys in the Physics, Maths and Chemistry class and you were not intimidated by that.
I believe God had His path cut out for you and you knew it.

Bjay, your walk with God was paramount. Growing up, we used to sing this song: "Awo feemɔ noko ni oshi oha wɔ ni wɔkɛ kai bo", which means 'leave a memorial or legacy.' You didn't just sing that song; you made it your project and lived it out.

My dear sister, your footprints are too deep for me to walk in! May God grant me the grace and wisdom to handle the baton you have prematurely handed to me.

We were all praying for your complete healing and restoration, but God had His own plans for you. I saw your smile, so I'm comforted to know that you are happy where you are.

My dear ones gathered here, Bernice would want me to say this to you all: "Are you sure you are heaven bound? If not, you can be by accepting Jesus Christ as your Lord and personal Saviour now and commit your all to Him." It's only by doing so that we will all meet with Bernice again someday.

Bjay, we love you, but God loves you more. Bjay, your legacy lives on.

Bernice, yaawɔ ojogbaŋŋ. Ofeibea, rest well till we meet again.

Amen.

FROM COMFORT



"My thoughts are nothing like your thoughts," says the Lord. "And my ways are far beyond anything you could imagine.
For just as the heavens are higher than the earth,so my ways are higher than your ways and my thoughts higher than your thoughts." Isaiah 55:8-9 (NLT)

Sister Ofeibea, your life depicted decency, determination, discipline, and diligence. Idleness was never your cup of tea. You were a model already set for me when I came to meet you. I did not have to look far. Like Paul, you seemed to be saying, "Imitate me as I also imitate Christ" (1 Cor. 11:1).

With the great privilege of being your sister, it was inspiring watching you sail through life victoriously. No wonder you wrote the song, "We Are Victors"! You rose steadily to higher heights and as your younger sisters, we almost had no choice but to follow the trail you blazed — but could we? You were in a class of your own! We could only toddle along in our own little steps.

Bernice, I certainly didn't express my gratitude to you sufficiently, but I am forever grateful to you for taking me along to the Calvary Road programme where my life was to take a dramatic turn forever!

You did not leave me to waste my life before attempting to retrieve it. Before I could understand what life was all about, you helped me find meaning to it. You found Christ and, like Andrew, you introduced me to Him (John 1:41-42). In the same way, you, as it were, "found" Achimota School and by God's grace, I could follow you there as well. I did not have to enter Achimota to determine whether to join the Scripture Union or not. I was there from day one, because you had already "reserved" my seat for me. As if these were not enough, I saw you tuck your Bible under your pillow and read it first thing in the morning, and by God's grace, it has been my style as well through the years. To crown it all, I remember a Sunday afternoon I saw you go out to share tracts and, as young as I was then, the Holy Spirit left a strong impression on my heart, a seed which has grown into a lifelong passion for evangelism. These opportunities definitely helped to define me!

Like a caring mother, I was deeply touched when you offered me your house, with the services of your home assistant, to always pick up my then little girls from school, to feed them, help with their assignments and sometimes even get them ready for bed before going home, since I couldn't be done with work early enough to pick them up myself.

Bernice, you seemed gentle and all set from the outside, but I saw even more of how gentle you were during our confidential little talks in the years preceding the downturn of your health.

In your last days, I was privileged to spend several nights with you at the hospital, praying and trusting God for His intervention. I reluctantly left you on the Thursday for a camp meeting before your passing, hoping to go and pray for a miracle and come back to see you fully restored. However, my camp had to be interrupted early Saturday morning with the sad news of your passing. Like anyone else, I really wanted to see you recover and see the miracle that I believed God, with whom nothing is impossible, would do with your health.

However, God had a more glorious plan for you, a brighter idea by far, to elevate you to serve directly in His presence! Today, you have joined the angels to sing even more melodious songs unto our God. You have obviously fought the good fight, BJay, and run your race very well!

My dearly beloved audience, I have no doubt that Bernice is extending a hand of invitation to all of us to do everything possible to be with her in that beautiful land one day. She received her place in heaven by handing over her life to Christ. Jesus said, "Unless a man is born again, he CANNOT enter the kingdom of heaven" (John 3:3). Please don't lose the marvellous opportunity to hear and see Bernice again one day! As you can see, "souls are parting to eternity" every day! When your turn comes, where will your soul be? Please sign in now to have your name written in the Book of Life. If you're already born again, let's together put our hands to the plough without looking back, because indeed, "The harvest is great, but the workers are few" (Matthew 9:37).
Thank you, Big Sis, for showing us the way!

Rest in absolute peace until we meet again on that golden shore!

FROM PATIENCE

Who have I in heaven but You? And there's none I desire on earth besides You (Psalm 73).

Hewɔ lɛ kɛ otsɔ dun mlin, aloo otsɔ la mlin hu, kaimɔ akɛ Milɛ, Mishin bo da.

'Sta Ofaa', Madam, must I write about you to others? How can I put to words what you are to me when I can't accept what I am being told? My earliest remembrance of you is as an infant in preschool. I remember how you would wake me up so early in the morning whilst the whole house still slept and get me ready for school. You put the charcoal in the coal pot the night before and placed the matchsticks on top, ready to boil water for my bath and breakfast. Needless to say, we were always one of the first if not the first to get to school at Royal Prep, Osu. Anyone who knows you knows they can set their time by you.
In my first year of high school, though I had by then come to know the Lord, I did not join the Christian fellowship (Scripture Union) because the friends I made said the SU people were



weird. Then, as though sent on a mission, you came to minister with your guitar at an SU

meeting. Now, how can I explain my absence to big sis? I had to go and it was the Lord's way of bringing me and some of my friends home to Jesus.

I know few people can testify to your culinary skills, but blessed are those who have had the privilege. I can remember that particular rice dish you brought to me on a visit not long after you got married. I am still waiting for an 'encore' of that dish. One of my many favourite times with you is cooking in your kitchen and I particularly enjoyed how you would scold me for using all your onions. Cooking, laughing, teasing and just being together in my kitchen whenever you came to visit can never be forgotten.

Sista Ofeibea, your humility and childlike faith was made apparent as we sat on the stairs at 3T as married women talking about the joys and challenges of marriage. You loved a good laugh and it was always a joy watching you hold your belly in laughter till you cried. Hanging out with you and watching you squirm because I wasn't being prim and proper enough are cherished memories that will always bring a smile to my face.

Ataa Ofei bi Ofeibea, I want to sing old Ga hymns and dance to new songs like Tobechuku with you again.

If I had read to this point and haven't heard you say "Bo nɛkɛ gbekɛ nɛɛ," it means even now, you have been granted the seniority allowance. It means in my negotiation with our Father God and you, my prayer to have you resurrected and sent back to us for His glory has been overridden by your desire to stay in heaven.

So, anyɛmi nukpa, bonamɔ, bohu bonamɔ..... hmm, I see top official refuses to comment. I parted with you and said see you on my next trip. My next trip has come, but you, my love are gone. Nbɛ noko noko ni makɛɛ bo eei. Hmmm! Yaawɔ ojogbaŋŋ? Daabi! Yaanya babaoo yɛ wɔ Nuŋstɔ lɛ hiɛ!. Till we meet again my dear friend and big sister. Love you plenty.







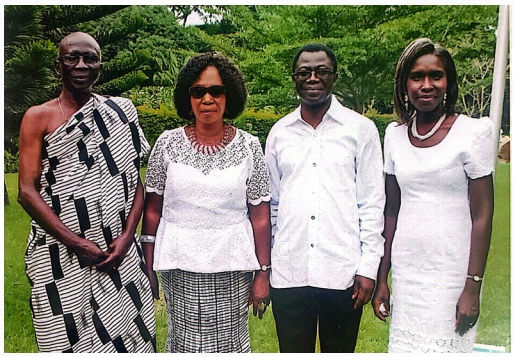










IGM











TRIBUTE FROM THE

DAUGHTERS SHE RAISED

THE GIRLS: ANTOINETTE, SUSIE, AUGUSTA & GRACE

TO A BEAUTIFUL SOUL WHO HAS BEEN A MOTHER TO US IN EVERY WAY THAT MATTERED.

Mummy, our hands can write these words, but our hearts are struggling to follow. Every sentence seems to make real something we are still struggling to accept - that we are saying goodbye to you.

You were kind, gentle and loving. You had a quiet presence, but your love was deeply felt - in your prayers, your encouragement, the way you showed up and in simply knowing you were always there.

You journeyed through life with us. You watched us grow from young girls into women, celebrating all our milestones and patiently witnessing all the boys who came and went along the way; some lasting a little longer than others. You would say "eei, this one too, where is he from?" You listened to our stories, shared in our joys and disappointments, prayed for us and constantly encouraged us in our faith. And when the right ones finally came along, you welcomed them into the family and proudly stood beside each of them as Mother of the Bride.

You always made an effort to bring us all together. Christmas was always particularly special. You would endeavour to gather everyone under one roof, ordering everything and anything to make sure there was abundance to truly celebrate the season. It was always a time to look forward to: a house full of family - near and far, food, laughter and the joy of simply being together. Through every season of our lives, in the big moments and in the seemingly ordinary ones, you were there. You were Mummy. Whenever any of us needed you, you stepped in without hesitation. Whether it was caring for our children, helping us to navigate a tricky conversation with Daddy or on one occasion, somehow producing many months' worth of bank statements within a matter of hours because one of us desperately needed them abroad; you found a way. Big or small, if it mattered to us, it mattered to you.

We can never talk about you without remembering "Strive for Holiness". When you released the album with that song, little did we know what you had started in the house. For the longest time, "Strive for Holiness ooh!" became the answer to everything. Big problem, small problem, disagreement, complaint. It didn't matter. Somehow the response was always "strive for holiness" (and it did fit). If we are being truthful, as young girls we sometimes wondered when we would legitimately flee the nest! We felt surrounded by practical reminders to live holy lives when, quite frankly, girls just wanted to be girls. We laughed about it, complained about it and probably rolled our eyes more times than we would ever admit. How little we understood

then!
And then, there was the fact that we could never hide you! We joked about it often. A quick errand with Mummy was hardly ever quick. We couldn't just go somewhere and come back unnoticed. We sometimes felt pressured that we had to show up in a certain way. Yet it didn't change how you, the legend, showed up and carried yourself. The woman people encountered outside was the same woman we knew at home. Your faith and godly character weren't simply something you sang or preached about, you lived it.

We underestimated the impact of being raised in a home where prayer, righteous living and dedication to God were woven in everyday life. What sometimes felt like a restriction was actually a foundation. The values you were quietly planting in us were taking root even when we didn't realise it. We may not have fully realised it then Mummy, but we do now.
Each of us carry our own many precious memories of you; your words, your encouragement, your laughter and all those little things that were uniquely Mummy.

Antoinette says:
Mummy, we will continue to strive for holiness. We will hold on to them and do our best to live by the example you gave us; for as you always reminded us, God is watching.

Susie says:
Mummy, whenever I came for encouragement you would say, "This too shall pass". How deeply those words hit now. Even in this moment, when saying goodbye feels painful, I hear your voice encouraging me that we will get through this. God can be trusted.



Augusta says:
Mummy, I have so many fond memories, from you proudly hosting my graduation party and all our bi-weekly shopping trips to the pride I felt standing beside you whenever people recognised you. We joked about how that made it hard to haggle and they were always astonished as to how humble you were! Relatable in every sense and living the Christ-like life you sang about.

Grace says:
Mummy, I will miss being your "pampered last girl" - the one you fussed over and hyped at every opportunity. I will miss hearing your voice saying "eei, wo no no! As for this girl dɛɛ, your head sweet pass." Who is going to hype me like that now? I will miss those words, your laughter and most of all the love behind them. What a privilege it has been to be loved by you!

And so even through our tears, we thank God for giving us you; for every year, every prayer, every visit, every celebration, every word of encouragement and every memory we were blessed to share. The world knew your music. Many knew your ministry and faith. We had the extraordinary privilege of simply knowing you as Mummy.

Rest peacefully, Mummy.







TRIBUTE BY RHEMA AND GABRIELLE

We remember Grandma came to visit us in the UK in 2017. We spent time with her, we watched her minister at a church for the one and only time, and she promised that we would make music together because we were just beginning to learn how to play the instruments. Despite the memory being hazy because of how young we were, it has stayed with us since, because this is one of our only memories of her.

One of the disadvantages of being a grandchild born in a different country is that you don't get to spend significant time with your grandparents; you don't get to make many memories with them, especially because the bulk of the beautiful ones were made when we were both under the age of ten.

When tragedies like this happen, it causes you to reflect. Perhaps you could become resentful of the distance that prevented you from sharing beautiful moments together, or sorrowful that you didn't try harder to make the moments that you did have more memorable. Our initial response to the news after the shock was an overwhelming sense of loss; not necessarily of what we had, but what could've been and ultimately will never happen because we don't have anecdotes. We didn't have many funny stories. We didn't have that amazing life-changing encounter with her that everyone seemed to have had. But luckily, we understand what we do have, and what will always be left on her; the effect she had on people. The joy she brought to her loved ones, the spirituality within her music, the generosity of her spirit linger on in every single person she met. The way everyone's eyes light up when they tell stories of her music, and the way the lights went out when we learned what had happened.

Grandma lived a beautiful, colourful, Christian life to the fullest extent for as long as she could, and we didn't need to have decades and decades of life with her to understand that. We just need to tell someone – anyone that our grandmother was Bernice Offei, and the stories, and the joy that she carried, come pouring out.

May she rest forever in peace and may her words and her message be carried in our hearts forever.

TO MUMMY

Some people come into our lives for a season. Others come into our lives and quietly become family. The first time I saw Mrs. Bernice Offei, I was seven years old. She was the first Ghanaian celebrity I had ever seen, and I remember thinking she was beautiful - her grey hair, her simple grey dress, and the quiet elegance she carried. I was a little girl, and I remember being fascinated by her. I could never have imagined that many years later, that same woman would become like a mother to me.

When I was at the University of Ghana, Legon, I became close to Professor Offei. He was intentional about loving people, and he became like a father to me. Eventually when I moved back to Ghana after a difficult season in the US, he invited me to come and see him. I remember sitting in their living room when Mummy walked out of their bedroom. I looked at her. Then I looked at Prof., and I remember thinking, "Prof, you never told me!"

I had known her as Bernice Offei, but somehow, it had never occurred to me that the woman I had admired as a little girl was the same woman who now standing in front of me. And then something even more beautiful happened. I stopped seeing her as a celebrity. She became my Mummy.

At the time, I was trying to build a little beauty business while pursuing my PhD. I had very little, and the business that would eventually become Everything Beauty GH was being run from my small room on campus. One day, I went to their home to collect a bag of beauty products that had been brought from America for me. Mummy looked at the products and asked me about them. I told her I had a beauty business.

She wasn't particularly interested in makeup herself, but instead of simply saying, "Oh, that's nice," she said, in essence, "Then let me see what you're doing." She got into the car with me. We drove to my little room on campus. She sat on my bed with me there and listened. She asked me questions. She wanted to understand what I was trying to build. She took an interest in something that, at the time, was so small that I don't think I fully understood what it would become.

She made me feel seen. That was who Mummy was. She was intentional about people. She made you feel that you mattered. Whenever I walked into the house and she set eyes on me, she would always say something along the lines of "Wobɔ life papa" whether in English, Akan, or Ga! As her health declined, I began visiting her every Sunday after church to pray with her.

Today, I am heartbroken, but deeply grateful. Grateful that God allowed our paths to cross twice - first when I was a little girl admiring her from afar, and later when I had the privilege of loving her as my mother.

Mummy, thank you for seeing me, loving me, and taking my little dream seriously. I will carry you with me always.

You were loved. You are missed, and you will forever be a part of my story.

Rest peacefully, Mummy.

Until we meet again.



TRIBUTE TO BERNICE OFFEI – FROM SARAH DEVIS

To the world, Mummy Bernice was a voice of healing, conviction, and timeless grace. Her music didn't just entertain; it broke chains, comforted weary souls, and reminded us of what truly matters in this life. But to me, she was something even more sacred: she was my Godmother.

Holding her close in my heart means remembering a woman who lived the very truth she sang. She didn't just perform the gospel; she embodied it. Her life was a masterclass in humility, integrity, and unwavering faith. Through her gentle wisdom and fierce devotion to God, she showed me how to navigate the storms of life with quiet dignity and an anchored soul.

Though her physical voice is now silent, the echoes of her love, her prayers, and her faith will resonate within me forever. She has finished her course, she has run her race, and she is finally resting in the arms of the Master she served so beautifully.

Thank you, Mama Bernice, for being a guiding light. Your legacy lives on in the lives you touched, and most deeply, in mine.

Rest in perfect peace and I will forever love you.

TRIBUTE BY – HADIJA TO MUMMY

...so teach us to number our days, that we may apply our hearts unto wisdom. (Psalm 90:12)

I remember that early Saturday morning in 2009 when I first stepped into your home. I walked in, not sure about what the days ahead were going to be - a young lady who had just come to know the Lord. But I recall Mummy walking up to me in the kitchen courtyard, after learning I had arrived, and saying with a warm smile, "Welcome." The days that followed begun a relationship which has earned me the privilege to call her Mummy. Her home became the crucible where our destinies and character in Christlikeness was formed.



I watched you have quiet time consistently. You would wake up every day before sunrise, with your Bible and Daily Bread by your side. You would do this before leaving for work. Later, I observed where many of the lines in your songs came from. Thank you for that example, Mummy. You and Daddy ensured that we had our family devotions together every Saturday morning. These spiritual disciplines have become part of our family now as we nurture the faith of our own children.

The Saturday mid-morning kenkey party was never to be missed. I remember our trips to the market, and the guest ministrations. It was always a joy following you around as I watched you minister. I had the opportunity to hear many of the songs first-hand from you during those times as you ministered.

You never complained about how many we had become in your home; the many girls you had raised at varying periods in time. You gave each of us all the support we needed. You not only welcomed us, but also our friends and families. We cannot forget your generosity. I remember the day after my wedding; you and Daddy organised lunch at no cost to us for all our families. Thank you Mummy.

You had a way of bringing all of us together especially at Easter and Christmas, reminding us that in Christ, we are all one and must live in unity irrespective of our different backgrounds.

You were so conscious of attending Church service on time and never wanted to be late. Anyone who wanted to join you had to be ready before 8:00am otherwise, we would have to walk, which we didn't want to. These principles and more have contributed to shaping my passion for the things of God.

You allowed us to grow and express ourselves freely, and you gave us the opportunity to be ourselves in an environment of love for one another and enjoying the fellowship and warmth of brotherliness.

It was a rare privilege spending the last hours of your life with you while you were on admission. I had injured my left toe and could barely walk, so I had not been able to come visit you the previous days, but that Friday was different. I had this strong urge to come, no matter the pain. I planned that day to pick up the children from school early, drop them off at the office temporarily so I could make it for visiting hours. The plan was to be there until visiting time was over, and then I would pick the children up afterwards. I knew I wanted that time alone with you.

But that planned short visit became several hours of anguish and tears as we watched you being transferred to the ICU. I couldn't

hold back my tears. When we were allowed in the ICU for a brief moment, I was privileged to have one last look at your face as you had opened your eyes. You just looked straight at us, and then our time was up to leave the ICU. We hoped that we could come by in the morning to see you again, recovering, but by morning, you were gone!

Gone to be with your Father. Your Father whom you loved so deeply and shared with the whole world. How unashamed you were to tell of your love for Him.

You found the treasure of great price and forsook all other vanities to obtain that eternal treasure.

Thank you for accepting me into your home.
Thank you for loving me.
Thank you for reminding me that life is indeed short.
Thank you for showing me the Father.
Thank you for your exemplary life.
Thank you for Your prayers.
Thank you for the encouragement.

We miss you so much Mummy.
Your food was to do the will of the Father and to finish it, and you have. Have your rest now, Mummy. You have fought a good fight. Have your rest until we meet again.
Love, Hadi.



TRIBUTE TO OUR DEAR AUNTIE BERNICE

JANELLE, HILARY, ROSLYN AND WALTER TO OUR DEAR AUNTIE BERNICE

Janelle

I recall, as a child, hearing a song by Aunty Bernice being played on the radio or TV and rushing to inform any family member around. It's not every day you get to see someone you personally know on these platforms, so I was always excited when this happened. Beyond her ministry in the public space though, Aunty Bernice lived an exemplary life. One thing that stood out to me was how she welcomed people into her home. My sister and I spent several holidays with her and her family at different times, and we were always well taken care of. Not just to the biological family was this hospitality shown, as I always saw various people in the house whom she and her husband had taken in.

Hilary

It greatly grieved my heart hearing of her departure on that fateful day as I was looking forward to hearing some new songs she had in the pipeline yet to be released. I remember tearing up with joy as I watched some interviews about one of her last songs and how she gracefully revealed the background story of this particular song: "Your Will" in 2019. This song greatly ministered to me. Hmmm.... God knows best. I'm at peace knowing that you're in the bosom of the Almighty and joining heaven's choir to sing joyfully to God. Surely, you'll be missed, not only for your music but also for your amazing personality. Thank you for taking such good care of us during the countless holidays you allowed us to spend in your house. Earth has indeed

lost a masterpiece, but heaven just gained an angel.

Walter
Today we remember and celebrate our loving Auntie Bernice. Her song "Hold On" has been a big reminder to keep faith in God and remember His unfailing love for us. I remember when she came to Cardiff and we were able to get a guitar for her. It was such a blessing to hear her play and sing. I know she is continuing to give praise and glory to God right now with the angels!

Roslyn
Auntie Bernice. What a beautiful and impactful woman of God! The lives she touched through her music and grace will stay with me forever! I have many fond memories of her laughter, jokes, and wisdom she shared with me about integrity as a woman of God, especially when I was younger and would misbehave sometimes. I remember once driving with a friend in the UK while listening to gospel music. I said, "Let's play one of my auntie's songs, Hold On." He replied, "Wow, this is your auntie? She is truly amazing! My family loves her!" At that moment, I was reminded that her music reached beyond us. God truly used her as a vessel of honour to share the gospel and touch souls around the world. I love you, Auntie Bernice. I thank God that you are with Him now, and I understand if you wouldn't want to come back.

Together we say:
Your songs will live on; you will forever be missed, and your impact shall never be forgotten. Aunty Bernice, rest well in the arms of our Maker!

TRIBUTE BY EWURAKUA, BELINDA, HELENA, ADWOA, GRACE

We gather here today with heavy yet grateful hearts to honor and celebrate the precious life of our beloved Mummy, Bernice Offei.

As your nephews and nieces, we find it hard to put into words how much you meant to us. Mummy, as we affectionately called you, was so much more than an aunt; you were a mother in every sense. A pillar of grace and a constant sanctuary of warmth, love, and comfort in our lives.

From our past, earliest, and recent memories, your home was a safe haven. Your gentle voice, your beautiful smile, and the unconditional love you showered upon us made every moment feel safe and cherished. You welcomed us with open arms, nurtured us with wisdom, and prayed over us with a heart full of endless devotion.

You stood faithfully by our uncle, building a home anchored in kindness, strength, and love. The bond you shared and the generosity you extended to the entire family will remain an everlasting legacy that time can never



erase.
Though our hearts ache with your demise, we find peace knowing that you are resting peacefully in the bosom of our Maker. Your love lives on in each of us, and we will carry your legacy of compassion, your faith, and your gentle spirit in everything we do.

Rest peacefully in the arms of the Almighty, dear Mummy. You were deeply loved, and you will be missed beyond measure.

You are forever in our hearts.

TRIBUTE TO MY DEAR COUSIN

Bernice, my dear cousin, was an extraordinary soul; immensely talented and brilliant in every way, but she still remained gracious, warm and welcoming to all.

I have many fond memories of her. I recall my first year at the University of Ghana, where I had the privilege of sharing accommodation with her. She made every effort to make me feel at home. She exemplified dignity, elegance, humility, grace and beauty - an inspiration in every way.

Anytime she was in London, she would call to have a chat and come over to visit and spend time with us. To us, she was a breath of fresh air.

The Scripture says, "The meek shall inherit the earth" and though she is gone too soon, the melodious and uplifting music she left us does indeed "inherit the earth."

I wish she had stayed a little longer, so that we could have had more chats and a little more time together in our old age, but the Lord Almighty knows best. So, even as I mourn her passing with great sorrow, I know that she is at rest in the presence of the Lord she loved and worshipped with all her heart.

Bernice, Rest in perfect peace till we meet again.

TRIBUTE TO OUR BELOVED COUSIN PATERNAL COUSINS

Ofeibea, from a very young age, you stood out as a remarkably smart and astute person, possessing a wisdom and sharpness of mind that were evident even in your early years.

Beyond your intelligence and admirable qualities, what stood out most was your love for God, and this was very obvious in your music.

As your cousins, we are especially grateful for the beautiful memories we shared growing up. We fondly remember our vacation days in Tema; moments that brought us together and gave us memories we would carry well into adulthood. And then there were our visits to Mayera! Oh, the excitement and sheer joy those visits brought us! Those were truly special times, filled with happiness and childhood delight.

Looking back now, we realise that these moments were far more precious than we may have understood at the time. They were little pieces of life that would eventually become treasured memories, reminding us of the bonds we shared and the beautiful story of our growing-up years. How we wish we could turn back the hands of time, if only for a moment, to relive those happy days and create a few more memories with you.
Sadly, life has reminded us that our time together on this earth is short, just as you sang in the words of your song. Indeed, we have just one life to live on earth, and you made the most of your time here with us by impacting several lives.

We are reminded that life is not measured only by the number of years we spend on earth, but also by the lives we touch, the examples we set, and the memories we leave in the hearts of those who knew us. In these ways, your life will continue to speak to us, beckoning us to live just and to live for God.

As we say our final goodbye, we pray that the God you loved and served will comfort your husband and children, your mom and your siblings, and all of us who mourn your passing. May He give us the strength to endure this painful loss and the grace to hold on to the beautiful memories we shared with you.

Rest peacefully, dear Ofeibea. Your journey on earth has ended, but your memory will remain alive in our hearts. We will remember your brilliance, your faith, the example you set, and, of course, the legacy you left behind through your music and walk with God. You will never be forgotten.

Till we meet again

Yaawɔ ojogbaŋŋ

Rest in the eternal peace of the Lord

TRIBUTE TO OUR DEAR COUSIN MATERNAL COUSINS

It is difficult to find the right words to describe how deeply we feel the loss of our cousin - Mrs. Bernice Offei. Sometimes losing someone makes us realize just how much their presence meant to us even in the ordinary moments we may have taken for granted.

Bernice was a woman of faith, and her love for God was such an important part of who she was. As a gospel singer, she had been blessed with a beautiful gift, and she used that gift to glorify God and touch the lives of others. Her music was more than just singing; it came from a place of faith and conviction. Through her voice, she was able to share hope, encouragement, and the love of God with many people.

But to us, she was not simply a gospel singer. She was a cousin, a member of our family; and someone whose life will always be connected to some of our own memories. That is what makes saying goodbye so difficult. There is a certain pain that comes with knowing that someone you expected to see, hear from, or share family moments with is no longer here.

We will always be grateful that God allowed our paths to cross as family. We are grateful for the memories, the conversations, the laughter and even the simple moments that may have seemed ordinary at the time but now mean so much more.

Bernice's passing has left a space that cannot simply be filled. Yet, in the midst of the sadness, we choose to remember her life with gratitude. We believe the greatest way we can honour her is by remembering the woman she was, cherishing the memories she gave us, and continuing to celebrate the gift that God placed within her.

Cousin Bernice, thank you for the life you lived and for the love, faith and music you shared with those around you. Your physical presence may be gone, but the memories you created and the lives you touched will continue to speak.

May your soul rest peacefully in the arms of the Lord. You will be deeply missed, lovingly remembered, and forever cherished.

TRIBUTE BY AUNTIES

"For everything there is a season. A time to be born and a time to die" (Ecclesiastes 3:1).

If Jesus tarries, as many as were born into this world will surely die one day, as we are witnessing now.

Ofeibea, as affectionately called by the family, was born to our elder sister, Bernice's mother, Eva Aklerh Djoleto and her husband Walter Ofei Djoleto all of Osu, Accra. Unfortunately, when our father passed away, some of us were still young and schooling, so we relocated to stay with our elder sister and her family to be able to continue our education. At that time Bernice and her sister Eva had already been born.

The following are some memories we have of Bernice:

She attended the Nyaniba Nursery School at the Nyaniba Estates, Osu (Accra). One thing we never forget is when the parents dropped her off at school in the morning, we had to go for her when school ended. Just like other children, on the way back home she would make demands for some delicacies, and woe

betide you if you didn't have any money on you. She would stop and cry and would not move until you bought her what she requested. Bernice's gift of singing started from primary school. Every morning when she was going to shower to go to school, she would be "making noise" in the bathroom. We did not realize she was having voice training at that tender age. In our ignorance, we thought she was 'disturbing.' Little did we realize she was preparing for her great future.

Ofeibea was 'addicted' to her books and ensured she did her homework without being forced. She liked reading and was always going to the Osu Children's Library to read and borrow story books like the Enid Blyton series. Along the line, one notable thing was that anytime she was studying, she had a Bible with her. When she took a break from her books, she would read the Bible for about thirty minutes before returning to her books. What wisdom and the fear of God at that early age! Bernice at a tender age understood morning devotion even when we the grownups just woke up in the morning without bothering to so much as pray! We would just get up and do our morning chores; but Bernice would spend some time in bed to do her morning devotion. If you called her, she wouldn't mind you until she finished. In fact, at that age, she knew God more than all of us! She was focused in life and knew God's will for her. Our mother, (i.e., Bernice's grandma), used to say to us that people who don't talk too much are generally intelligent. She was right. Bernice exhibited that intelligence when she sat for the Common Entrance Examination at Primary Six. She was the 2nd best in the whole of the Greater Accra Region. It was a great joy for the family.

Bernice had a zest for life and enjoyed family outings and parties on weekends. Bernice made sure she always celebrated her birthday no matter the situation.
When she entered Achimota School, she joined the Scripture Union. It was in Achimota School she started to learn to play the guitar. Most of her friends who came to her house were her Christian brothers. We didn't often see girls. Maybe not too surprising since she didn't have a biological brother. When she entered the University, she was away most of the time due to the structure and demands of her chosen programme. However, we stayed connected whenever possible, especially as constant guests at her birthday parties, as we had also married and moved to our matrimonial homes .

Ofeibea, we know you have joined the Heavenly Choir and are singing under greater anointing. "The Heavens are declaring God's glory" indeed! We love and cherish you. We thank God that you did not waste your life on earth. The Bible says in Psalm 30:5, "Weeping may endure for a night, but joy comes in the morning." Today we weep, but joy will surely come after today.

We entreat all, especially our elder sister, her mother, Mrs. Eva Djoleto, Prof. Offei, Kwesi and Daniel, her siblings, the family and all loved ones, to take consolation that God still remains God, and that Bernice's departure has impacted lives and many souls are being transformed through her songs.

We thank God that even after her death, many are rededicating their lives to God. Hallelujah!

Ofeibea, you have fought a good fight, you have finished the race.

Yaawɔ ojogbaŋŋ, biyoo. Nuŋtsɔ lɛ dientsɛ akwɛ onɔ yɛ Yesu Kristo gbɛi amli. Amen.

TRIBUTE TO MY BELOVED

DAUGHTER-IN-LAW



My dear Bernice, I never imagined that I would be the one saying goodbye to you. It should have been the other way around, for no mother expects to outlive her children. I always thought you would be here to bid me farewell, but today, I am the one mourning you. It is a pain words cannot express.

I still remember when my son introduced you to our family and told us he wanted to marry you. We were all delighted. You were warm, respectful, and loving, and I had no doubt he had chosen the right woman. Little did I know that we would also come to share the same name, Ofeibea. I fondly remember the preparations and journey to North Kaneshie for your engagement ceremony, a joyful occasion I will always cherish.

Following your marriage in 1987, I remember visiting you at Annex C and later at Ayido Flats on the Legon campus, when the children were young. You always welcomed me with such warmth. I remember the joy of learning you were expecting your first child and visiting you at North Kaneshie with food items. While I lived at Aboasa, you and my son would visit us, and I always looked forward to those moments.

I smile when I remember how particular you were about maintaining your figure. You would serve yourself such small portions of food, and I would say, "Bernice, this food is not enough! You need to eat more!" How precious those simple memories have become.

When my husband passed away, you came to sing at his funeral. Your beautiful ministration touched the church members and townspeople so deeply that they asked whether you could return to sing at their future programmes. In your usual humble manner, you promised to try whenever time permitted.

When I moved in with the family, you would sometimes stumble into my room and quietly sit beside me. Other times, you would bring pillows and place them behind my back to make me comfortable. I was hard of hearing, so communication was sometimes difficult, but words were not always necessary. Your presence alone brought me comfort.

The incidents of the days before you went home to heaven deeply troubled me. Even now, remembering those painful days brings tears to my eyes. When I heard you had gone missing, I was deeply troubled. I could hardly sleep and prayed constantly for your safe return. I remember telling my son that we must do everything possible to find you. Even now, remembering those painful days brings tears to my eyes.

When you passed away, I was heartbroken. I missed your unexpected visits, your quiet presence, and the little gestures of love that had become part of our lives.

Bernice, you loved people, and people loved you. You were a blessing to our family, and I thank God for the years we shared.

My dear Ofeibea, I will forever cherish your memory. Rest peacefully, my beloved daughter, until we meet again.

TRIBUTE BY BROTHERS-IN-LAW

Fred Fred Taylor

"So you see, my brother, that life is so short. It passes so quickly and soon it's gone.... So remember your Creator while you have breath."

Today, your Creator (the great I AM) has called you home because you have run the race well and accomplished your mission. God has opened Heaven's door for you and now you are walking with angels inside His beautiful garden with songs of praise on your lips.

I am proud to have known you for over 45 years and during this time, your love, support, frank advice and statements were very encouraging. The few times we spent during childhood at Osu with a couple of brethren from Come Back Incorporated (then Christian musical and ministering group) walking around and sharing ideas will be treasured by me and our mutual friends. The impact you had on us over the years cannot be measured.

Thank you for inviting me to some of your Christian programs during adulthood. I remembered the day you preached and ministered in songs at a church in Osu, Accra. The preaching was powerful and uncompromising of our Christian race. This has remained with me. I do remember occasions we accompanied you to minister in songs at churches in different parts of United Kingdom and few occasions we got lost but on time for you to minister. In all, the favour and mercy of God shines through you for His own glory.

I am blessed to have known you for many years and spent quality time with you in exchanging views on your songs, including Life is Short. Your laughter was a blessing, your presence at occasions was a comfort and your faith in Jesus Christ an inspiration.

You may have stood just outside the spotlight in recent years, but the light you gave off in Jesus reached far and wide. I will always be grateful for knowing you and sharing your life with all.

Goodbye till we meet again, my dear sister!

Joseph Tagoe

Today, I stand with the family to say farewell to our dear Bernice, with sadness, but also with gratitude to God for her life and for the privilege of having known her and called her family.

I have known Bernice for over 25 years. Though our encounters were mainly at family gatherings rather than during very personal moments together, it was still such a blessing knowing we belonged to the same family.

There was always that important knowledge that Bernice was part of my family and with that came affection, respect, admiration and, I must admit, a certain sense of pride because of the kind of personality she embodied.

I felt privileged when acquaintances or other family members discovered that Bernice Offei was my in-law. They would speak warmly of her, her music, her character, or how her songs had touched them. It was a special feeling to hear others speak so highly of someone and to be able to say quietly to myself, "Yes, she is part of my family." Perhaps I did not tell her that enough while she was with us, and that is one lesson moments like these teach us - to tell people what they mean to us while we still have the opportunity.

Recently, while reflecting on Bernice's life, a cousin shared with me one of his earliest memories of her. He remembers Bernice coming to PRESEC Legon sometime around 1983 or 1984, carrying her guitar. She went onto the stage in the school assembly hall and played and sang before the entire school. What particularly remained with him was her courage: a young woman entering a boys' school, guitar in hand, standing before that audience and confidently sharing her music.
Like anyone else, I feel sad at her passing so soon, but I thank God for the exemplary life she lived and the great influence that she has had on so many lives.

Sister Bernice, you will always be remembered for the quiet but impactful way you lived your life.

May God keep you in His bosom.
"Yaawɔ ojogbaŋŋ"

TRIBUTE FROM – # SONS-IN-LAW FRED DAMALIE

Going into a family with a celebrity musician as a mother-in-law was, I must admit, a little daunting. However, from the very first day I met "Auntie B" as I usually called her, she made me feel welcomed, loved, and special. From that moment, a beautiful and special relationship began - one that I will cherish forever.

Auntie B. was the most loving, caring, and encouraging mother-in-law I could ever have asked for. Whenever I shared with her a challenge or difficult situation, her response was always the same: "Trust God, and this too shall come to pass." And truly, every challenge did come to pass. Her words gave me strength, reassurance, and the confidence to keep trusting God.

Whenever Auntie B. visited us in Leicester (UK), she always looked for an opportunity to minister through her songs. Driving her from church to church and watching her minister was a joy. Our journeys together were filled with encouragement, laughter, wisdom, and conversations that I will always treasure.

What always stood out for me was her humility and her heart for ministry. I do not remember Auntie B. ever accepting money for ministering at any of the churches where she sang. Instead, she would encourage church members to support her ministry by purchasing her CDs, and sometimes she would even give them away for free. It was clear her desire was never about financial gain; it was about sharing the message of God and blessing people's lives through her music.
We truly loved having Auntie B. with us here in Leicester.

One memory that will always remain particularly special to me was her interview on BBC Radio Leicester during one of her visits. As we prepared to go to the studio, I was nervous for her; but Auntie B. remained completely calm. She simply said to me, "Fred, the Lord is in control," and, of course, she was right.

The interview went very well. While we were sitting in the waiting room, one of her songs, "Life Is Short," was played during one of the breaks. I remember watching people in the studio – both Black and White – moving their heads to the rhythm and listening attentively to the words of the song. The music touched people who had never heard her before.
I will never forget one person saying, "I don't believe in God, but these lyrics make me feel like going to church." That statement said so much about the power of Auntie B.'s music and the way God used her gift to reach people. Shortly afterwards, the producer contacted me to request some CDs from the Life Is Short album.

Looking back, I feel truly blessed to have known Auntie B. and to have shared so many precious moments with her. I will forever cherish the times we spent together, the journeys we took, the conversations we had, the laughter we shared and, most importantly, the wisdom and encouragement she poured into my life.

Auntie B., thank you for welcoming me into your family, for loving me, for encouraging me, and for always reminding me to trust God. Your music, your faith, your kindness, and your beautiful spirit touched many lives, including mine.

You may no longer be with us physically, but your voice, your music, your words, and the memories you created will live on in our hearts. Rest peacefully, Auntie B. Your legacy will continue to speak, and your memory will forever be cherished.

"Trust God, and this too shall come to pass."



TRIBUTE FROM –

ALBERT BRIGHT

I got to know Auntie Bernice in 2012, when I married the eldest of her girls, Antoinette. From the very first day, her reception towards me was warm and genuine, and that never changed until her passing. She welcomed me into the family and made me feel that I belonged.

She affectionately called me "Ɔdɔ" (love) - the name my wife calls me, and, to be honest, I cannot recall her ever addressing me by my name. To me, that was very unique, touching and humbling, especially coming from someone of her calibre. It was a small thing, but it meant a Great deal to me.

Auntie Bernice was genuine and quiet, but her actions spoke volumes. Her love, passion and understanding of God were firm, and she never compromised her faith. My wife would always tell you and I quote, "There are some things you dare not let Mummy hear." That statement alone says so much about the kind of woman she was and the values she upheld. She preached virtues and practised them - simply and consistently.

Her love and kindness towards others, especially strangers, were exceptional. She never discriminated or showed favouritism. To her, all children were equal, whether biological or not. Perhaps that is why I never felt like an outsider around her as her son-in-law, but she treated me as one of her own. She was down to earth, gentle and humble. In all the years I knew her, I honestly cannot remember ever seeing her angry. Auntie Bernice inspired me with her simplicity, gentleness and her life-filled songs. Her life was a testimony of love, faith, kindness and humility. To me, "Life Is Short" is more than just a song - it is almost a biography of the way she lived.

Who will call my children "Ɔdɔlets" now? And who will I disturb with my Twi? Hmmmm... Auntie Bernice, your place in our family and in our hearts can never be replaced. Thank you for accepting me, loving me and treating me as one of your own. I will remember not only the woman whose music touched so many, but the gentle woman of faith who simply called me "Ɔdɔ."

You lived simply. You loved genuinely. You served faithfully.
Farewell, Auntie Bernice. Sleep well. Until we meet again.



TRIBUTE FROM –

KWADWO OWUSU-SAFO



Of all the sons-in-law, I came into the family the latest, but from the very beginning, Auntie Bernice welcomed me with a warmth and affection that made me feel I belonged.

My encounter with Auntie Bernice is something I will never forget. I was preparing to marry her youngest daughter, and she said to me, *"I hear you want to marry my daughter, but I haven't met you. How can you marry my daughter without me meeting you?"* There was only one appropriate response to that! Within two days, I found myself on the plane to Ghana to meet her.

Of course, long before I met Auntie Bernice, I had heard plenty about her from her daughter. I knew the kind of woman she was supposed to be - what she stood for, what values she held dear, what she would tolerate and, perhaps even more importantly, what she absolutely would not. So, in many ways, I felt I already had a picture of the woman I was travelling to Ghana to meet.

Having now had the privilege of knowing her for myself, I can say that she was everything her daughter had told me she was. Strong in her values and convictions, but alongside that strength was genuine warmth, kindness and affection that I experienced personally. Looking back, that conversation still makes me smile. She loved her children deeply and had the highest standard for their spouses, and because I was coming for her 'baby last girl,' there were additional points to score. Once we met, she welcomed me wholeheartedly. There was no fuss and no formality; she simply made me feel at home.

I felt the warmth even more on our wedding day. Anyone who was there will know that I cried – buckets. Later, Auntie Bernice came up to me, gave me one of the biggest hugs and said, "I love a man who cries." (eeish!) I still smile when I think about it. In that brief moment, with that hug and a few words, I felt her warmth and affection so genuinely. It's a memory that has become even more precious now.

That was the Auntie Bernice I came to know - warm, kind and generous in spirit. It is difficult now to accept that there will be no more conversations, no more visits and no more opportunities to make memories we simply assumed we still had time to make. I wish we had been given more time.

Auntie Bernice, thank you for welcoming me. Thank you for the kindness, warmth and affection. Thank you for making room for me in your family and making that place feel like it had always been mine.

Rest peacefully, Auntie Bernice. Your memory will always be a blessing to us all.



BERNICE BEYOND THE STAGE

Hymn : Great is Thy Faithfulness

Bible verse: "So teach us to number our days, that we may gain a heart of wisdom." (Psalm 90.12, NKJV)

Sport (s): Long distance walking

Food: Red Red

Colour: Blue

Snack: Plantain chips

Drink: Malt

Foreign cuisine: Chinese (noodles)

Genre of music: Gospel



TRIBUTE FROM –

THE LEGON INTERDENOMINATIONAL CHURCH (LIC)

IN LOVING MEMORY OF MRS. BERNICE OFFEI

"The Righteous perish and no one takes it to heart; the devout are taken away, and no one understands that the righteous are taken away to be spared from evil. Those who walk uprightly enter into peace; they find rest as they lie in death" (Isaiah 57:1-2 NIV).

Today, we have gathered to bid farewell to a lovely woman of God, a professional banker and a songstress par excellence whose impact did not only bless her family and church, but humanity as a whole. The Offeis joined the Legon Interdenominational Church (LIC) family shortly after its formation and became a significant part of its life and story. Auntie Bernice married Dr. Kwame Offei in LIC, when the church was worshipping at the Legon Hall Chapel, in 1987. Their marriage was blessed with two sons - Kevin and Daniel, who are now young adults.

Much of Auntie Bernice's invaluable contribution to the life and ministry of the Church was expressed through her dedicated service in the Music Ministry and the Liturgy and Chapel Preparation Ministry, where she served faithfully as an Officiant. Her commitment to worship and her passion for serving God were evident in the time, energy, and gifts she generously devoted to these ministries.

Auntie Bernice also served as Deputy Ministry Leader of the Worship and Creative Arts Ministry under the leadership of Uncle T.V.O. Lamptey. In this capacity, she played an important role in supporting the ministry's work and enriching the worship life of the Church. Beyond her leadership responsibilities, she graced the choir with her presence on several occasions as a guest singer, sharing her musical gifts and contributing to the uplifting of congregational worship.

Through her service, leadership, and love for worship, Auntie Bernice left an enduring mark on the Church and on all who had the privilege of serving alongside her. Her contributions remain a cherished part of our collective story, and her legacy of faithful service will continue to inspire us for years to come.

As a woman of God, behind her cool and collected nature, she was deep in the things of God. This she demonstrated in her Bible knowledge and insights shared at any Bible



Study group she joined. Auntie Bernice was a member of the Joseph Bible Study Group before the groups were reorganized and later joined the Shalom Bible Study Group. She was also a member of the Lower Hill/Ayido Area Fellowship.

Auntie Bernice had a solo ministry that spanned nearly 40 years. LIC was blessed tremendously from her ministration in church. She was a prolific songwriter, whose faith and depth showed in her compositions. In the early years of her ministry, she sang and played her guitar (Uncle TVO Lamptey, who was involved in most of her recordings, called her the Dolly Parton of LIC then). Later, she used soundtracks from her numerous albums, which enriched her ministry tremendously.

As a gospel singer, Auntie Bernice was truly one of a kind. She was a minister of the gospel through song, using her God-given gift to proclaim His Word and touch lives. Her music was biblically sound and always carried a profound message - one that, in the weeks following her demise, has become especially poignant and relevant, particularly in the songs "Kaashe Gbeyei" and "Life Is So Short."

Auntie Bernice's voice was distinctive, graceful, soothing, and effortlessly expressive, with a rare smoothness that captivated the heart. Whenever she ministered on any platform, hers was never merely a performance; it was a true ministration. It is little wonder that her music has blessed countless hearts, not only in Ghana but across the world.

As a professional banker, she worked for many years with Standard Chartered Bank. Many young people in LIC benefitted from her guidance and counsel while seeking jobs in the corporate world in the pursuit of their careers. She balanced this with being a mother and a wife to a budding Senior Lecturer who rose to become the Professor and Pro-Vice Chancellor of the University of Ghana.

From the words of your first album, "We Are Victors," as believers, we are more than conquerors through Christ and we know nothing shall separate us from the Love of God (Romans 8:31–39).

Auntie Bernice, you have fought the good fight and faithfully finished the race set before you by your Maker. We can only imagine the joy with which the angelic hosts welcomed you into your eternal home. Yours was a life well lived, one that touched, inspired, and enriched many lives, and for this, we thank God.

To Professor Kwame Offei, Kevin, Daniel, Auntie Bernice's mother, siblings and the entire family, the LIC family, the Fraternity of Musical Artists, friends, colleagues, and all loved ones, our prayer is that you will experience the promise of Jesus in John 16:22, that "now you have sorrow, but I will visit you and give you joy, no one can take away."

Rest well, dear mother, wife, sister and friend. Rest in Perfect Peace until we meet again. Amen

TRIBUTE FROM –

THE WORSHIP AND CREATIVE ARTS MINISTRY, LEGON INTERDENOMINATIONAL CHURCH



In loving memory of Mrs Bernice Offei
"We Are Victors, yes, so we are in Him"

We, the members of the Worship and Creative Arts Ministry (WACAM) of the Legon Interdenominational Church, give thanks to God for the life of Mrs. Bernice Offei. We remember Auntie Bernice with deep affection and gratitude as a fellow minister, a leader, and a friend whose gifts and faithful service enriched our worship and encouraged many of us in our own ministry.

Auntie Bernice served as Deputy Ministry Leader of the Music Ministry, now the Worship and Creative Arts Ministry. Alongside the musical gifts for which she was widely known, she brought a calm and sweet spirit to our life together. She was accessible, willing to serve, and never expected special treatment. She made time to be part of the ministry.

One of Auntie Bernice's lasting contributions was the opportunity she gave young people to serve alongside her. She welcomed members of the Youth Ministry as backing vocalists, choreographers, dancers, and actors in her music videos and at her ministry engagements. Through these opportunities, she encouraged their gifts and gave them room to grow. Many continue to serve faithfully in the body of Christ. As a ministry, we give thanks for the part she played in nurturing that generation.
Auntie Bernice's public recognition never diminished her willingness to serve among us. There were no airs and no expectation of special treatment. She showed up and gave of herself. Her example reminds us to place our gifts at God's disposal and to make room for others to use theirs.

As a songwriter and gospel musician, Auntie Bernice expressed her faith with clarity and conviction. Her songs carried the truths of Scripture, a desire to honour God, and a confident hope in eternal life. Her voice was distinctive, graceful, and soothing, yet powerful in its expression. Her music moved us and directed our attention to God.

Since her passing, the words she sang have brought fresh comfort and meaning. The faith she shared through her music now helps sustain those who mourn her. We remember the message of "We Are Victors" and take comfort in the assurance of Romans 8:31–39 that nothing can separate us from the love of God in Christ Jesus.

For us in WACAM, Auntie Bernice's legacy lives on in the worship she enriched, the young people she encouraged, and the example of humble service she set. As we continue to lead others in worship, we will remember her care for the message we carry and her willingness to share opportunities with those growing in ministry.

Auntie Bernice, we thank God for the privilege of serving alongside you. We will miss your voice and your presence among us. You have fought the good fight and finished the race. We entrust you to the Lord whom you loved and served.

Rest well, dear colleague and friend. Rest in perfect peace.

















TRIBUTE TO BERNICE OFFEI NÉE DJOLETO –

BY THE OLD ACHIMOTANS' ASSOCIATION (OAA) 1979



Achimota School, 1981 - L-R: Charles Evans-Anfom (Senior Prefect); Bernice Djoleto (Girls' Senior Prefect); George Abankwa-Yeboah (Deputy Senior Prefect)

In September 1974, a shy young Nino walked through the gates of Achimota School into Clark House, Form 1D, one voice among six streams of freshmen beginning seven years that would shape a nation's gospel legend. That girl was Bernice Djoleto, who would later become Bernice Offei.

Achimota in those days tested more than academic ability. It was, as her classmates remember, a test of psychological and emotional resilience - a school whose halls held the children of the nation's most privileged families. For a girl of humble background, that could have been daunting. Bernice was not fazed. She stood tall, and remained consistent in character throughout her seven years there.

By Form 4, after the school's rearrangement of streams, Bernice had earned her place in 4A - among the strongest science students in the school. She excelled through her O' Levels, returned for Sixth Form, passed her A' Levels, and proceeded to the University of Ghana to study Agriculture. Yet for all her academic distinction, she remained - in the words of classmate Marion Acquaah-Harrison, "a good Clark House girl," modest enough that her character, not just her results, earned her the position of Girls' Senior Prefect in her final year.

It is fitting that the Achimota School hymn speaks of being "born but to rule through service given," and of learning "that we may teach." Bernice embodied that ethos long before she understood it as a creed. Classmate Kwasi Boateng remembers her, even as a young girl serving food in the dining hall, quietly swapping her own hard piece of plantain (doche) for his - a small, unprompted act of fairness that previewed a lifetime of kindness. Ama Anin remembers her singing in the Clark House bathroom, not yet knowing those were the beginnings of a Gospel legend. That gift, once private, became a ministry that touched a nation. Her songs - among them "Hold On" and the achingly prescient "Life Is Short" carried the same steadfast faith her schoolmates recognized in her as a girl: unshowy, firm, unwilling to compromise what she believed. The school hymn's image of living waters rising and flowing wider from Achimota's children finds its clearest expression in a voice that, decades later, still comforts strangers she never met.

In the final days before her passing, a video resurfaced of Bernice singing "Hold On", a cappella; words of endurance offered, it now seems, almost as her own farewell. As classmate Kofi Boohene put it simply, the words of her famous song feel prophetic now: remember your Maker.

Bernice leaves behind a husband, two children, a body of music that will keep ministering long after this tribute is read, and a class of 1979 that remembers her exactly as she was: quiet, firm, kind, and unmistakably touched by God. Rest well, Akora. You have held on, and now you rest.

Rest in perfect peace!



October 2019, during the OAA '79 40th Anniversary Service at Achimota School, Bernice is 2nd from left, front row

TRIBUTE FROM

SCHOOLMATES OF BERNICE OFFEI (NÉE DJOLETO)

Achimota Mourns

Dedo Mate-Kodjo, Clark House, OAA 1978
Those who got to know Bernice well appreciated that while she had a quiet disposition, she had a sharp sense of humour. She had a smile that would crinkle up her eyes and she could laugh! She was fun to be around. She also had a keen sense of right and wrong, stood firm and did not compromise what she believed in.

Ama Anin, Clark House, OAA '79
Oh Bernice! Who would have thought I would be writing your tribute at this time. Like your song "Life is so short and passes so quickly" - indeed it is almost like your farewell message now. I remember the early days in school when you sang in the bathroom. Little did we know those were the beginnings of a Gospel legend. Your praise songs touched many lives and will continue to do so always. You were a lovely person inside and out. Rest well with God, Bernice, till we meet again!



Charles Evans-Anfom, (Senior Prefect-1981), Guggisberg House, OAA 1979
As a classmate, I had always known Bernice to be quiet and unassuming from when we entered Achimota School in 1974. I got to know her much better when we both became Senior Prefects in our final year (Upper Sixth). She was kind but firm, principled, consistent, dependable and well respected by all. Someone rightfully described her as "Awula Kpakpa" (A proper Lady!), anchored in a strong Christian faith. A couple of decades later, I linked up with her on one of my visits back home and purchased all her CDs (at a former SP discount!). It was then that I discovered she was a Christian/Gospel star and legend! I introduced her to my late father (then in his early 90s), who also loved her songs and was honoured to meet her!

Upon my return to Ghana, I had lunch with her and was amazed at the number of people (across all demographics) who stopped by our table to greet her. I realized how powerful her music ministry was and how many lives she had impacted and continues to impact.
One of the activities during our year group's 40th anniversary celebrations in 2019 was to walk around the school campus and visit our former Houses. The young girls of Clark House were starstruck and in awe of one of their most famous alumni!

A few years ago, I used to walk around the Legon campus on Saturday mornings and would bump into Bernice occasionally. We talked about having kenkey, or "soaking" one day, but never got around to it.

Bernice, God in his infinite wisdom has called you home. The last stanza of our school hymn says "may living waters rise in thee," and Bernice has indeed been living water to a thirsty land.

My co-SP, rest in eternal peace.



Solace Amankwah (née Nyarko), Clark House, OAA '79
Bernice with Solace, 2019
The last time I saw Bernice was when she

came to visit me at my father's house in East Legon in 2019. She chatted a bit with my dad and then we spent some time talking. We also took a few pictures as a reminder of our time together. It seemed like after the visit we would meet again. Yet, God had His own plans.

It is so difficult to try to fathom the brevity of life and how Bernice and I will not be together again on this earth. However, the Bible says in Psalm 116:15 that "Precious in the sight of the LORD is the death of His godly ones."
Even though I am saddened by Bernice's passing, and I will miss her, I know that she is now with her precious Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ. To God alone be all the glory!



Clark House girls revisit, 2019. L–R: Delali, Ama, Bernice, Marion, Sally

Marion Acquaah-Harrison, Clark House, OAA '79

Clark House girls were always known to be good girls, but some of us were naughty. But Bernice was a good Clark House girl. She never got into trouble, and she was never far away from God.



Kwasi Boateng (La Boite), Guggisberg House, OAA '79

My earliest memory of Bernice and enduring demonstration of care:
From 1D to the dining table. G'berg (Guggisberg House) boys sat with Clark House girls in the dining hall. Bernice was ever so diligent with the serving of doach (fried plantain). I noticed that I was getting a disproportionate number of hard pieces and complained to Bernice. Even at that tender age she demonstrated that kindness/equity and swapped one of my hardest pieces for one of her semi-hard ones, and glanced back at me raising her eyebrows - as if to say satisfied?

Bernice always showed kindness to my family and took care of our younger sister Nana Adwoa Kwartema in Clark House and led her to Christ. Bernice took time out of her busy schedule to attend and sing at our sister's wedding in the UK.
Rest In Peace Bernice

Kofi Boohene, House 12. OAA 1979

She was so unassuming, and the words of her famous song are prophetic. 'Life is short, so remember your Maker...'

Naami Oddoye, House 11, OAA '79

Awula Kpakpa indeed. I loved your songs Bernice, and that will always keep your memory alive. May you rest peacefully with the Lord you so loved

Rosemary Asiedu (née Owusu), Kingsley House, OAA '79

....She left a wonderful legacy of inspiration through her music.....

Charles Kofinti, Livingstone House, OAA '79

Bernice! She was always cool, calm, and collected. Looking at you with those wise eyes like she knew something that you didn't. And she did!

She was a devout Christian, right from our early days in the Grey City of the Outlaw's Hill. I often sat behind her in class and like all naughty boys would do, occasionally playfully prod her in the back just to distract her from her studious attention to the teacher's delivery.

Later, in our golden years in life, our paths would cross again, often meeting on our walks on Legon Campus, with a brief interlude of greetings before resuming our exercise routes.

Bernice, you lived a saintly life, and your Creator will remember you, "now that you have (no) breath."

Sister Bernice, Rest in Peace.

TRIBUTE TO MRS. BERNICE OFEIBEA OFFEI –

FROM CALVARY ROAD INCORPORATED

"Therefore, my dear brothers and sisters, stand firm. Let nothing move you. Always give yourselves fully to the work of the Lord, because you know that your labor in the Lord is not in vain" (1 Corinthians 15:58).

We gather with hearts full of gratitude and reverence to celebrate the life and legacy of Bernice Ofeibea Offei, a true daughter of Zion whose unwavering devotion to God has left an indelible mark on our generation.

Bernice joined the Calvary Road Family at a tender age, as a student of Achimota School. She quickly distinguished herself not only by her musical gift, but also by her commitment, humility and willingness to serve. As an active member of the singing wing and one of the lead singers, she gave herself wholeheartedly to the ministry of the Gospel. Her voice became a vessel through which the message of Christ was proclaimed, bringing encouragement, hope, and blessing to many.

Her passion for God was never confined to the walls of a sanctuary. She embraced the evangelistic calling of Calvary Road and participated actively in our soul-winning campaigns and outreach programmes. She travelled with the team within Ghana and beyond to Nigeria, sharing in the work of proclaiming the unsearchable riches of Christ.

We remember the young Bernice who joined us, the committed sister who served and travelled with us, and the gifted musician whose voice would later bless countless lives. We give thanks to God for the privilege of having known her, served alongside her, and shared with her in the work of the Gospel.

Her dedication to ministry led her to pick up the guitar and learn to play it so well that she could accompany herself during her ministrations. With guitar in hand and praise on her lips, Bernice developed a distinctive style of ministry that reflected both her musical gift and the sincerity of her faith. Many called her the minstrel of gospel music. She allowed her Lord Jesus Christ to use her voice to propagate the gospel - from assembly halls to conference auditoriums, to church sanctuaries to crusade grounds; across the airwaves and through digital media.

In keeping with the Calvary Road ethos that encouraged academic excellence and godly living, Bernice also exemplified the grace of labouring for the Kingdom of God and simultaneously earning her stripes in the marketplace of life with her achievements in academia - two master's degrees; and in corporate Ghana as a consummate information technology (IT) professional with Standard Chartered Bank.

But, beyond the music, the recognition and the achievements, we at Calvary Road remember Bernice first as a sister and fellow worker in the Lord. Her greatest ornament was her simple and profound faith. She trusted God. She served Him. She gave herself and her gifts freely and wholly to His work. Her life was a testimony to what happens when a person responds to God's call with faith, humility, and an open heart.

In later years, Bernice was recognized as one of the leading female voices in Ghanaian gospel music, blessing the nation and beyond with songs born of a deep and abiding devotion to God, applying biblical truths to everyday life and experiences. Yes, her songs and her sterling example will bless this generation and generations yet to be born long after her transition into glory.

So, although her earthly voice is now silent, the songs she sang, the lives she touched and the memories she left with us remain an enduring part of our story.

As Scripture reminds us, *"The memory of the just is blessed" (Proverbs 10:7)*. Bernice's life also reminds us of the promise that "the righteous shall be in everlasting remembrance" (Psalm 112:6). Her labour in the Lord was not in vain, for "they that turn many to righteousness shall shine as the stars for ever and ever"

the faithful keeping of God, knowing that "precious in the sight of the Lord is the death of his saints" (Psalm 116:15). Only eternity will unravel the many lives that were encouraged, enriched, revived, restored, repurposed and refreshed through Bernice's award-winning music ministry.

Rest well, Bernice, our sister and fellow worker in the Lord. Rest well in the bosom of your Creator, until that glorious day when we meet again and join you and the heavenly choir in eternal praise.

From all of us at Calvary Road Incorporated,

WOMEN IN GOSPEL MUSIC



Through all the changing scenes of life, in trouble and in joy,
The praises of my God shall still my heart and tongue employ.

Today, we gather not just to mourn, but to celebrate the extraordinary life of our beloved Music Minister, Sister, and Founding Member, Bernice Offei, a true woman of God who walked this earth with grace, purpose, and an unwavering love for her Creator and Women in Gospel Music.
Your life was a living testimony of *Proverbs 31:30: "A woman that feareth the Lord, she shall be praised."*

From the way you spoke to us, the quiet acts of service and, particularly accommodating and hosting several of our quarterly meetings; this is a memorial for us. You did not just talk about longsuffering; you lived it in every season of trial and triumph. We can boldly say you supported God's kingdom with your all; A Legacy That Endures.

Though our hearts ache from the physical void you leave behind, we are deeply comforted by the sure and certain hope of the resurrection.

We know that your earthly labor has ended, and you have by now heard the words of your Master: "Well done, good and faithful servant. Enter into the joy of your Lord." Thank you, Aunt Bernice, for showing us what it means to trust God completely in your song titled, Hold On Fast. Life indeed is short, as you so well espoused in your song. This is a clarion call that the Word of God is immutable, and we will adhere to your sound advice.

Auntie Bernice, as we affectionately call you, thank you for your relentlessness, your unconditional love, and the beautiful blueprint of faith you left behind. Everywhere we went, as Women in Gospel Music, you represented gracefully. Your soft words of caution to always get us back on track can never be forgotten. You loved so deeply and you gave your all to the Gospel indeed.
You have fought the good fight; you have finished the race. Rest peacefully in the bosom of our Lord until we meet again to part no more.

Nante yie; Auntie Bernice, yaawɔ ojogbaŋŋ.



TRIBUTE FROM –

MEDIA EXCEL PRODUCTION

ON THE PASSING OF MRS. BERNICE OFFEI



The entire Management and Staff of MEDIA EXCEL PRODUCTION have received with deep shock and profound sadness the news of the passing of our beloved sister, mother, and gospel icon, Mrs. Bernice Offei.

For decades, Mrs. Bernice Offei's voice was not just music - it was ministry. With timeless songs that touched souls and drew hearts closer to God, she carved out a unique place in Ghanaian gospel music history. Her humility, grace, and unwavering commitment to God's work made her a pillar of inspiration to both old and young in the industry.

Years of working with her, from recordings to radio/TV promotions, and performances around the country were done with pure passion to serve a true minister of God who was dedicated to writing songs not just for dance and entertainment, but focused on winning souls for God.

You were not for the money but for pure evangelism, even till today as you lie before us, I can still echo your voice of caution. "Kwesi don't charge people when they need my services to minister, it doesn't feel right!" Mama our arguments about this go to suggest that you had Heaven on your mind and heart to make sure you are rewarded by God for good work done and not by man. Such was the exemplary lifestyle you demonstrated till your demise. As a multiple awards winner, you showed love and compassion to all mankind through your music journey. We were indeed blessed to be your Record Label and management.

With our combined hard work and dedication, Mummy was decorated with two major awards in Ghana's prestigious awards night. She won Best Female Vocal Performance and Songwriter of the Year at the 2009 Vodafone Ghana Music Awards.

At Media Excel, we remember Mrs. Offei not only as an accomplished artiste, but as a woman of extraordinary warmth, professionalism, and faith. She represented excellence, discipline, and true Christian values. Her contribution to gospel music and to the creative arts industry in Ghana will forever remain indelible.

To her husband, children, family, the gospel fraternity, and all who mourn her loss, we extend our deepest and heartfelt condolences. We have lost a legend, but Heaven has gained an angel.

May her gentle soul rest in perfect peace till we meet again.

TRIBUTE FROM –

THE MUSICIANS UNION OF GHANA (MUSIGA) - IN LOVING MEMORY OF BERNICE OFFEI



"I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. Now there is in store for me the crown of righteousness" (2 Timothy 4:7-8).

It is with heavy hearts and deep emotions that the Musicians Union of Ghana (MUSIGA) pays this tribute to our beloved sister, gospel minister, and friend, Bernice Offei.

Ghana has lost a voice, and heaven has gained a choir member. For over three decades, Bernice carried the nation on the wings of song. Her songs were a soundtrack to our lives. When we were weak and weary, she told us to "Hold On." When we forgot about the brevity of life and felt we were immortal, she reminded us that "Life Is Short." Those were not just lyrics. She lived them, and in every venue, church, and living room where her music played, hearts were lifted and faith was restored.

Bernice was a rare gift. A musician's musician with the unique skill of playing the guitar and singing - an uncommon feature particularly of our female musicians. She was a lady with multiple abilities, a banker who understood discipline and a minister who understood grace. Bernice was a scholar of Achimota and the University of Ghana who never let excellence diminish her humility. It was, therefore, no surprise when in 2009 she was honored with the Best Female Vocal Performance and Songwriter of the Year. Above all these, the awards that mattered most to her were the lives she touched. Her legacy of six albums and over forty songs remain as her testimony; and she showed a whole generation of creatives that talent, faith, and integrity can walk hand in hand.

To us in the music industry Bernice was a gracious presence; never loud, always warm, and always pointing us back to purpose. We will miss her laughter, her counsel and the quiet strength she carried.

To her devoted husband, Prof. Samuel Kwame Offei, to her two children, and to the entire Offei family, we offer our deepest condolences. Your loss is ours too. May the Almighty God she glorified with her voice wrap you in His peace and may the songs she left behind comfort you in the days ahead.

Rest well, Bernice. Your race is run, your song is sung, and your crown awaits. The stage may be silent tonight, but your music will never fade. MUSIGA stands with you in memory and in honour, today and always. Damirifa due.

"What we have done for ourselves alone dies with us; what we have done for others and the world remains and is immortal." - Albert Pike

TRIBUTE BY HER LONGSTANDING MUSIC PRODUCTION TEAM:

T.V.O. LAMPTEY, KWESI DICKSON, AND KOJO FOLSON (BORAX)



Bernito, as T.V.O. affectionately called her, coining the nickname from her maiden name - Bernice Djoleto was arguably one of the greatest Ghanaian gospel songwriters of all time, and we do not make this statement lightly. The catchy melodies as well as the relatable and biblically sound lyrics that characterized her compositions made them unique. She was a uniquely blessed person who lived the faith she believed and sang about; no doubt about that.

For us, as Bernice's longest-serving music production team, we will always cherish the special moments we shared while working with her as long as we live. While Bernice always provided the key elements of theme, lyrics and, sometimes chordal progression for the numerous songs she wrote and sang, our unique, divine giftings along with hers impacted each production to the end that vocal arrangements and instrumentation worked together to carry the message of each song.

Even though she knew exactly what she wanted when it came to recording and producing her songs, Bernice was easy to work with as an artiste or minstrel. Refreshingly, she was either firm or flexible whenever required. She was a person of deep faith in Jesus Christ our Saviour and Messiah, and clearly focused on her relationship with the LORD, her ministry and the reason for whatever production we were working on. On meeting her initially, she generally came across as being reserved, but she had a very warm personality, was affable, ready for a good laugh, and wonderfully pleasant to be with.

As a production team, we always seemed to work towards making Bernice's music timeless and characteristic, and we always sought that whatever song we recorded, she could also render by singing and strumming her guitar alone during her personal ministry away from the studio, if need be. In reality, it did not always work out perfectly, though. Nonetheless, we ventured into varying music genres and sub-genres such as highlife, kpanlogo, adowa, reggae, soft rock, country, world music, bossa nova, folk music, R&B and soul, pop, and the like, all with her approval and support. These musical influences collectively ended up serving the overriding purpose of projecting her voice and her message through the lyrics she sang.

The production team was a tightly-knit one. We paid personal to each other from time to time. We were not just a music production team; we all enjoyed meaningful friendships with each other and with Bernice of course, checking up on each other from time to time between studio productions. Thus, it is on record that for close to twenty years of working with her, there was never a rancorous moment - not even once! Yet, that is not to say that we absolutely always agreed on everything, but in reality, occasions of disagreement were refreshingly so rare, let alone ever descending into rancour. We worked in the Biblical spirit of mutual love and respect and "in honour preferring one another" (Romans 12:10).

As a team, we were blessed with a uniquely harmonious relationship, mutual creativity and vision that was second to none. This kind of mutual relation could have been crafted only in Heaven! Sometimes it was clear that we were experiencing angelic visitations and assistance in our work, because we could not explain by human reasoning why the productions worked the way they did. Together with Bernice, our creative ideas gelled into a synergy that could only have been inspired by the Spirit of God. In short, working with Bernice was always a pleasure,

an honour, and a memorable experience on each occasion.

Bernice's album productions were all special. Times of corporate prayer to begin each production were reinforced by the commitment in prayer of each studio session to God with thanksgiving at the end of each session. The prayer times may not have been noisy or lengthy according to the ways of men, yet such times were so spiritually deep, honest, and impactful! Each song we worked on ended up with memories and experiences of their own. Not infrequently, sessions would be overcome by such a deep sense of God's presence that work would be interrupted for worship and silence before the Lord. It is on record that once Bernice arrived late at the studio from her workplace, ostensibly due to the long distance and usually heavy traffic on that route. Instead of immediately taking her seat as expected, she went round and gave each of us a warm hug, including the session musicians and singers for that day; about ten of us altogether, before the recording began. Her action set the mood, gave the motivation, and provided heavenly inspiration for the song's subsequent success. It wasn't all that surprising, though; this was Bernito just being herself. Again, she was so intertwined with her songs that she would often be moved to tears while recording her lead vocals. Other times, she would burst into spontaneous worship when she returned to the studio to preview the final product by the team. Such awesome and unforgettable times we had!

Aside from being in ministry or song mode, Bernice had a wonderful personality, and we wish to reiterate this although we have previously alluded to it. She always made sure to bless us with meals or light refreshment during the main working breaks that occurred during each studio session. This was a testament to her kind nature and was meant to ensure that we always were well refreshed during our occasionally demanding studio sessions.

Bernice may have appeared under bright spotlights as well as on big stages during the course of her music ministry, but it was clear that she did not hanker after such experiences for self-validation. Her living faith in Jesus Christ precluded that. At the other end of the scale, she was equally at home ministering to small audiences at events with very little or no media attention, and where there was not impressive sound reinforcement or music production systems, but just her voice and her guitar. This was because she was a simple, genuine, humble, down-to-earth person and minstrel, and not associated with glitz or glamour.

Bringing together all our memories of Bernice for presentation in our tribute to her feels almost surreal. We did not expect her to leave us all at such a time as this, or for our special fellowship to end here so soon. We were always looking forward to Bernice calling us up to work together on her next music production. We have been processing her passing from when we first heard the news. Our hearts may be heavy with sadness because we will sorely miss her on this side of eternity, but we have hope, because Bernice has fought the good, honourable, and worthy fight; she has kept and firmly held the faith; she has stayed on course, and has run her race hard, right to the finish, on this side of eternity.

We know that Her Maker and Redeemer has called her home to be with Him in glory. We are also reminded that even though absent in body, she remains close in spirit and ever present in her music. Therefore, we are confident that her timeless songs will continue to echo the message of her heart through many generations to come, as we expect the glorious hope of the resurrection in Jesus Christ on that day, where we will meet up together with her in the glory and presence of the LORD.

Rest well from your labours, Bernito, as you take your place with the celestial choir to sing endless praise to our Lord whom you loved so well and sang about so passionately.



TRIBUTE TO MRS. BERNICE OFEIBEA OFFEI –

BY STANDARD CHARTERED BANK, GHANA



"The righteous perish, and no one takes it to heart; the devout are taken away, and no one understands that the righteous are taken away to be spared from evil. Those who walk uprightly enter into peace; they find rest as they lie in death" (Isaiah 57:1–2 NIV).

It is with indescribable heavy hearts that Standard Chartered Bank Ghana joins the family, friends, former colleagues and loved ones of Mrs. Bernice Ofeibea Offei in mourning her passing.

Bernice was not merely a former employee of Standard Chartered Bank. She was an important part of the Bank's history and family for eighteen years. Her journey with the Bank began in 1998, when she joined as a Temporary Staff. What began as a temporary engagement soon developed into a distinguished professional career characterised by growth, responsibility, commitment and self-challenge.

On 3rd May, 1999, Bernice's employment was confirmed, and she was appointed Merchant Sales Officer. After this, her career progressed through ever-increasing senior and specialised responsibilities. She worked as the Acquirer and Issuer Risk Manager, from November 1999, through March 2004. She then became the Acting Card Services Manager until August 2004. She was then promoted to the position of Card Services Manager. She served in this senior position until she departed the Bank in January, 2016.

Her progression from temporary staff to Card Services Manager is itself a testimony to her professional development and the confidence the Bank placed in her abilities. Her contributions in her role as Acquirer and Issuer Risk Manager showed her sound judgement, attention to detail, and an understanding of financial and operational risks. For more than eleven years as Card Services Manager, Bernice was able to bring her experience, knowledge, and leadership to bear on the work of the Bank.

When we reflect on her career today, we are reminded that professional legacies are often built quietly - through years of commitment, responsibility, teamwork, service and self-challenge. Bernice's career was such a legacy. Bernice's life, however, cannot be defined by her banking career alone. While building an impressive professional foundation, she also built what became a widely known gospel music ministry. She went on to establish herself as a respected Ghanaian gospel musician and songwriter, using her musical gifts to communicate messages of faith, hope, perseverance and God's grace.

Management regularly invited her to sing her gospel compositions at the Bank's town hall meetings and festive gatherings. Her beautiful voice brought special warmth to such occasions. The memory of her melody and the contagious emotion with which she sang will remain with us.

What is particularly remarkable about Bernice's story is the breadth of her life. For Standard Chartered Bank, Bernice will always remain part of our institutional history. She grew with the Bank. She assumed greater responsibilities. She developed expertise. She led. And she served!

Today, we remember not simply the positions she held, but the person who occupied them. We remember her as a colleague who shared in the work and life of the Bank.

She made a contribution to banking.

She contributed to the development of card services and risk management. She contributed to Ghana's gospel music tradition. And, most importantly, she contributed to the lives of the people who knew and loved her.

As we bid Bernice farewell, Standard Chartered Bank says:

Thank you, Bernice, for being part of our family.
Thank you for the years you gave to the Bank.
Thank you for your professionalism and contribution.
Thank you for the expertise and leadership you brought to Card Services.
Thank you for the memories you leave with your former colleagues.

And thank you for the music and messages that became another important part of your life's legacy.
Today, we close that chapter with gratitude and deep respect. Your career with us has ended, but your place in the Standard Chartered family remains.

May the memories of your years with us bring comfort to those who knew you. And may the melodies - the vehicle for the sharing of your faith, continue to speak long after your elevation to the heavenly choir, and your earthly voice has fallen silent.

Farewell, Bernice.

May your soul rest in the perfect peace of our Lord Jesus Christ.

"Those who walk uprightly enter into peace; they find rest as they lie in death" (Isaiah 57:2).









TRIBUTE BY

THE MOST REV'D PROF. JOHNSON K. ASAMOAH-GYADU

(PRESIDING BISHOP, THE METHODIST CHURCH GHANA)

It is still very difficult to believe that I have had to join many in Ghana and beyond to mourn the passing of our dear sister and beloved gospel musician, Bernice Offei. Over the years, I grew to love Bernice's music. In those years when they were in vogue, I shared her CDs with friends, home and abroad, as gifts on festive occasions. Her life and music ministry touched many of us and enriched our lives in many ways.

I first met Bernice as a first-year student at the then Trinity College in the early 1980s. At one of our evening programmes, we invited her, from across the road at the University of Ghana, to come and minister to us. A number of us gathered in the small Trinity College Chapel were simply awed by this young talented Christian woman, our contemporary, who played the guitar and sang from her heart. It was an uncommon sight at the time, and her ministry touched us deeply. From that evening, some of us began to follow her music and ministry.

As the Lord would have it, in the early to mid-1990s, I had the privilege of serving as pastor of the Legon Interdenominational Church (LIC). Bernice and her husband, Prof. Kwame Offei, were abroad at the time, but their names came up in conversations we remained indirectly in touch through friends of the church. When they eventually returned, I was leaving LIC, but we were able to sustain the relationship. I visited their home at the Ayido Flats on a number of occasions to pick up copies of Bernice's CDs. Her music had become a treasured part of my own life and that of many others.

There is one part of my story with Bernice that has remained with me for years. In early 1998, I was a graduate student at the University of Birmingham, UK, and was visiting Ghana for fieldwork. I travelled around the country collecting data and interviewing people. Most of the time, I was alone in my vehicle. My constant companion was the music of Bernice. Even today, I cannot think about that period of my doctoral research without remembering how Bernice's music inspired me and kept me company as I travelled across Ghana. There was one song I played over and over again, and on which I have also preached on occasion: *"The heavens are telling Your glory O Lord; the skies are proclaiming the work of Your hands; the nations are healed at the sound of Your voice; O Alpha and Omega, Thy great name we praise."* It remains for me a beautiful expression of music that lifts the soul and directs the heart towards God.

There is another connection that I have not forgotten. At some point in my research career as a theologian, I discovered that Bernice's late father was a photographer. I engaged him, for a short period, to take photographs of religious banners advertising religious programmes around Accra for me to help with my papers on religion and media in the African public square. Thus, not only did Bernice's music contribute to my research journey; her father, in his own small but meaningful way, also contributed to that work. I remain grateful for that contribution.

When we heard of the challenges Bernice faced in the last few years, we continued to hope and pray that our dear sister would recover fully and return to her music ministry. But in the wisdom of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Christ of the resurrection, He has called Bernice to eternal glory. We celebrate her husband, Professor Kwame Offei, for the years of love, care and devotion he gave to our dear sister. We thank God for her children and pray that the Lord will comfort them. They gave of their best to her, and we commend them to the comfort and peace of God. We prayed for health and restoration, but God decided differently. And for the gift of Bernice's life and ministry, we give Him thanks, honor, praise, and glory.

Today, we celebrate the life of a remarkably gifted woman who did not regard gospel music merely as entertainment or a commercial enterprise. Her music was born out of a love or God's word; a life of prayer; and a sincere desire to minister to people and draw them closer to God. Bernice's ministry reminds us that music can be more than sound; it is ministry. Gospel music must carry the word, nourish faith, strengthen the weary, and turn the hearts of people towards God. Through her music, Bernice ministered to generations, and that ministry will continue to speak long after her earthly voice has fallen silent. We thank God for Bernice Offei - for her life, her faith, her music and the blessing she has been to the Church and to many of us personally. Hail Bernice! And fare thee well.

TRIBUTE BY

PASTOR MENSAH OTABIL, CHANCELLOR CENTRAL UNIVERSITY

It is with a deep sense of sorrow that I extend, on behalf of the Governing Coil, Management, staff and the entire Central University community, our heartfelt condolences to Prof. Offei and the entire family on the passing of Mrs. Bernice Offei.

Her passing is a loss to the Christian community and Ghana's gospel music fraternity. At a time such as this, words often seem inadequate to express the depth of our grief. Bernice leaves behind a remarkable legacy of faith, music, professional excellence and service. For more than four decades, she used her God-given musical gifts to minister to generations of Ghanaians. Songs such as Life Is So Short and Hold On touched many lives because they carried messages that were both deeply personal and universally relevant.

Bernice was also a pioneer in her own right. Her willingness, from the early years of her musical journey, to take up the guitar and minister publicly at a time when this was uncommon for women in Christian music demonstrated courage, conviction and a willingness to break new ground. In doing so, she opened doors and provided inspiration for many women who followed after her.
What makes her story even more remarkable was the breadth of her accomplishments. She combined a demanding professional career in banking with academic achievement and a sustained music ministry. Yet, despite the recognition and honours she received, she remained deeply committed to the Christian calling that shaped her life and work.

As we mourn her passing, we also give thanks to God for the life she lived and for the many people she touched through her music, faith and example. We pray that the memory of her life and the enduring legacy of her ministry will bring comfort to you, the family and all who mourn her.

May the Almighty God grant Prof. Offei, the children and the entire family strength, comfort and peace in this difficult period. May He uphold you all with His grace and give you the assurance of His unfailing presence.

Bernice has fought a good fight, she has finished her race, and we trust that she now rests in the eternal peace of her Lord.

TRIBUTE BY –

REV. DR. NII AMOO DARKU

"I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. Now there is in store for me the crown of righteousness..." (2 Timothy 4:7-8).



My journey with Bernice began in the late '70s to the early '80s during a Winneba outreach mission with UCC. Even then, Bernice stood out. Her ministry was evangelism. She was a humble, sold-out believer, completely immersed in the work of ministry. A young, beautiful, inspiring singer whose voice in every meeting made a clear difference. I took a liking to her, and from that moment, we bonded as family.

What Bernice did to stamp her dedication to my ministry was truly extraordinary.

My senior brother, Kwabena Darko of Darko Farms, had a preaching appointment in

Wenchi at a Full Gospel Business Men's Fellowship meeting and asked me to stand in for him. At the time I was on fire, preaching all over the country. When I extended the invitation to her, Bernice came all the way from Accra and travelled with me to Wenchi for that program. I have never forgotten that sacrifice.

I was so excited when she married Brother Kwame Offei, a man who shared her deep faith and was already serving the Lord in his own capacity. It was a joy when they came over to Kumasi and stayed in our home as part of their honeymoon. When the Lord opened the door for him to pursue his PhD in England, Bernice used the opportunity to attain her second Masters in Information Technology. While there, I visited them and we shared some memorable moments.

Bernice has always been a part of my family. She would come home with her guitar and sing in the smallest and most modest meetings. Through her, I became acquainted with the Djoleto family and was intrigued to discover we came from the same Otublohum clan. In fact, my daughters shared the same names as Bernice and her sisters - with names like, Darkua, Densua, Dodoowa, and Ofeibea, according to the clan naming system where we name children after our fathers' siblings.

Bernice's family and that of Rev. Godfred Bamfo had a habit of seeing me off or picking me up from the airport whenever I had to travel. We shared deep family moments.

As the Lord would have it, years later my second daughter, Evangeline, worked in the same bank, Standard Chartered, with Bernice. They also sang together in the Bank Choir. It gave me great joy to know my daughter was in good company, along with another of my adopted sons, Nii Okai Okai, in the same bank. My own affiliation with the Legon Interdenominational Church also deepened our relationship. We tried to be at Bernice's album launches as often as they came.
We spent some Sundays together in their home on Legon campus and she would cook for my large family. By this time, Kwesi and Daniel - her two boys had come along. One such day, Bernice excused herself, went indoors, only to return with a fat envelope to support our building project at the time. I was really touched by this generosity.

We have always held her in prayer since we got to know of her condition, but these past few weeks have been rather difficult. I broke down helplessly on a call with the children.
But our confidence is in the Good Father who will never leave nor forsake us, and who knows how He has assigned our days.

Ofeibea, you blessed me so much. You have finished your assignment with grace, humility, and songs that will outlive you.

Rest in the Lord and expect us one of these mornings.

"Blessed are the dead who die in the Lord from now on... they will rest from their labor, for their deeds will follow them" (Revelation 14:13).





TRIBUTE BY – REV. FITZGERALD ODONKOR

I am just a little flower with an open face
I am fully turned to God
Receiving grace
I don't know how to try
This is my plea
Since I am a lily trusting God

This was one of the hymns that Ofeibea, as I called her, used to sing in her early days at the Scripture Union in Achimota School where we both studied although I was senior to her. This, for me, was a summary of her life; quiet faith in God and confidence in his ability to provide for his own through the changing scenes of life.

I got to know Bernice very early in her life while she was still a teenager due to the association between her mother and mine. They were our Sunday school teachers and good family friends. We shared many family occasions together and were often in each other's homes. She always had a quiet faith in God and when we joined Calvary Road Incorporated at about the same time around 1978, we shared a lot of moments together serving God. I remember her consistency for meetings even when she was writing critical examinations and her attitude was simply trusting God while she faithfully served him. She constantly excelled both in her academic work and her singing ministry, which spanned many decades.

Bernice always set a good example with her conduct. She was very dependable and kept her smile even in very trying times. I observed her growth in her faith, especially through her secondary school years when I was the president of the Scripture Union. She was a goal getter and although I did not have her gift of a melodious voice, I did my best to encourage her to be her best for God. She never allowed any physical frailties to stand between her and her work for God. All through her years at Calvary Road Incorporated and Achimota School, her humility propelled her into great prominence.

Family life, career and church activities did not allow us to stay in close touch in her later years, but we never lost contact with each other, especially on her birthdays. I still remember very vividly sharing pleasantries and catching up on old times when we celebrated her mother's 83rd birthday anniversary in our church.

We have lost a disciplined, consistent, humble, gifted and dedicated servant of God. Ofeibea has certainly performed her act excellently and she bows out leaving a legacy of very inspiring songs very beautifully crafted that basically reflected her life as that lovely lily, trusting God. Well done, sister!

Fare thee well.

TRIBUTE BY – REV. SPENCER CUNNAH AND KENSIT EVANGELICAL CHURCH

"Precious in the sight of the Lord is the death of his saints" (Psalm 116:15).

It is with a profound mix of heavy hearts and heavenly gratitude that we offer this tribute to our beloved sister in Christ, Bernice Offei. Though her earthly voice has fallen silent with her passing at age 63, the echoes of her ministry remain woven into the fabric of our church family here at Kensit Evangelical Church, London, UK.

We vividly remember the occasions when Bernice stood before our congregation. She first met with our gathered youth on Friday, 30th June 2017, joining our young people for a memorable meeting that truly demonstrated her heart for the next generation. She then ministered to the wider church congregation on Sunday, 2nd July 2017, serving in song with a rare, quiet dignity and a deep spiritual conviction that commanded the room. Having spent time studying here in the United Kingdom to earn her Master's Degree in Information Technology, she shared her unique blend of intellect, professional

excellence, and deep humility with the global Ghanaian diaspora and the wider church.

When she took the microphone, her warm, distinct voice brought the reality of heaven down to earth. As she sang her timeless songs, "Hold On" and "Life Is So Short", she reminded us all to number our days, to remember our Creator while we have breath, and to anchor our souls firmly in the grace of God through the only Saviour of sinners, the Lord Jesus Christ. Little did we know how poignantly those words would comfort us today.

We praise God for her life. She was a consummate professional, a brilliant academic, a devoted wife and mother and, above all, a faithful servant of the Lord. Her presence when she ministered in song left an indelible mark on our church.

To her husband, Professor Samuel Kwame Offei, her children, and her global family: we lift you up in fervent prayer. We pray that the same God she sang about so passionately will grant you His peace, and that He will comfort you during this difficult time.

From Kensit Evangelical Church And Reverend Spencer Cunnah - Finchley, London, Uk

TRIBUTE BY – REV. BARIMAH KOFI ASARE & DOREEN KYEI-BAFFOUR



IN LOVING MEMORY OF A BEAUTIFUL SOUL

Some people enter our lives and leave footprints that time can never erase. Mrs. Bernice Offei whom Doreen and I affectionately called "Auntie Bee" or "Sis. Bee", was one of those rare and beautiful souls whose warmth, kindness, and love, made every encounter a treasured experience.

Her unforgettable bear hugs we shared were more than embraces; they were expressions of genuine love that made my family and me feel cherished. Her beautiful voice, once filled with laughter and affection, will no longer echo through our gatherings, but its melody will forever linger in our hearts.

The warmth of her presence has given way to the silence of her absence. Yet, the memories of her kindness, her laughter, and the love she so generously shared will remain precious treasures in our hearts.

Today, while our hearts are heavy and our eyes filled with tears, we find comfort in the thought that heaven is lit with joy because a priceless and precious soul has finally come home. The beautiful part is that her departure from here is precious to her Maker, but to us, an agonizing pain. A pain that only God can heal.

Auntie Bernice, thank you for the love you gave, the joy you brought, and the beautiful memories you left behind. Our lives are richer because you were part of them.
Auntie Bernice, from us and our family, thank you.
Thank you for every embrace, every smile, every kind word, and every moment of genuine affection you shared with us. We never imagined that one day we would have to speak of you in the past tense.

Heaven has welcomed home a priceless soul, and until we meet again, you will always have a special place in our hearts.

Priceless are the memories. Contagious was the personality. You will forever be remembered by those of us for whom at some point in our lives, happiness was just a woman called Bernice Offei...

Rest peacefully, beautiful Auntie Bernice.

TRIBUTE TO BERNICE OFFEI – BY DIANA HOPESON



God be with you till we meet again, by His counsels guide, uphold you, with His sheep securely fold you; God be with you till we meet again.

I sing this song not as a farewell, but as a call to remember the woman whose music made people look for, listen to, and feel the difference when she was not there.

Some people enter a room and are noticed. Sister Bernice enters unnoticed but has a way of making people feel valued and welcomed. Her voice carried music, but her life carried something deeper: faith, warmth, humour, generosity, and a love for God and humanity that could be felt in the way she served.

And the winner is... Bernice Offei! The applause rose to the ceiling. And your life was no longer yours!
Yet, we still made time to connect. In our last meaningful conversation, I commented on your beautiful home, and you told me that I am living in a mansion! We both laughed and giggled and talked about our adult children.

Sister Bernice..., Big Sis., The children want you to sing for them!
We have a Women in Gospel Music (WIGM) meeting this coming week. Can you make it?
Sis Bernice, some people want you to come and sing LIFE for them on the ....
Prof. Offei, please. Some people need Sister Bernice to sing. Can she make it? I want to come for her so we drive together.
And there was silence...
I miss you Big Sis!
Where is my Big Sis?
Sister Bernice, I am waiting for you.
Sister Bernice!
Sister Bernice!
Alas! She took the lead to our Maker. The one we both live and sing for. Rest well till we meet again
Rest well in Christ, big Sis
Yaawɔ ojogbaŋŋ
Da yie

TRIBUTE FROM – BERNICE TAMAKLOE AND FAMILY

'Death leaves a heartache no one can heal, love leaves a memory no one can steal...'

Writing a tribute like this, at this time, is an undertaking I never imagined I would take... and the thought of the finality of death is so unbearable...Thank God for His assurance in His Word that death is only a physical end.

Indeed, life is so short. It seems like just a short while ago when Bernice and I met at the Faculty of Agriculture at the University of Ghana, as we enrolled for the BSc. Agricultural Science programme in October 1981. We were the only ladies in the class, and quickly earned the description Bernice Black and Bernice Red (or, in short, B-Black and B-Red). Though a couple of years my junior in age, Bernice became not just a classmate but also a friend. After the first year, she chose to do Crop Science, and I chose to do Animal Science. Our friendship continued throughout the years through the different phases of our lives. It was even more unique when it turned out that our husbands, Peter and Kwame, were also classmates at Manya Krobo Secondary School, Odumase Krobo. Our children also shared memorable times together as children in the late 1990s. In fact, the role Kwame and Bernice played in the genesis and fruition of our marriage cannot be overstated. We were even honored

when she sang one of her new songs at our wedding before she launched that album.

Bernice was a very humble and simple person with a gentle heart and spirit. She was very passionate about Christ, and I watched her work very hard with determination and purpose, as she composed and recorded her songs that are so deep and genuine, a legacy for all.

Over the years, Bernice and I kept our friendship though the pressures of life took their toll. We shared our experiences and the blessings of God through the different phases of our lives, our careers, her music ministry, and the progress of our families.

Bernice, I am still coming to terms with your departure to be with the Lord. I count myself blessed for the privilege of being part of the family to care for you during what turned out to be your last days on earth. We saw your satisfactory response to treatment at the hospital and knew, without any shred of a doubt, that you would be discharged within a matter of days. But alas, that was not to be. Even with all the pain of the loss that we feel, the Bible reminds us to give thanks in all situations, to praise God because He knows all things, and everything is good and for His glory. And so, we trust in His Word. We will always hold dear all the little things you did and said that have shaped our lives.

Fare thee well, my dear sis. God be with us all till we meet again.

Rest peacefully in the bosom of the Lord.

Peter: "Rest well, Bernice, I know you are at a better place. You've always told us about eternity, and I know you are there."
Sesi: Sleep well Auntie Bernice. Visits to your place in Legon will always be remembered as some of the best highlights of our childhood. Rest in peace.

Fafa: Aunty Bernice, it's unbelievable that you've left so soon and so suddenly. I'll always remember fondly the visits from our childhood with the boys (Kwesi & Daniel). I know you are with the Lord now and at peace.

Kellie: Dear Auntie Bernice, one of my favorite birthday memories is of the year you came over to our house during my birthday celebration. You said you had a special gift for me, and you played your new song "Happy Birthday" which had not yet been released. That song is so dear to my heart, indeed it is my favorite birthday song to this day, and I'm confident no other song can top it. I felt so loved, so seen and so special that a song had been made for me. Looking back now, the song's release may have just coincided with my birthday, but it makes no difference to me; it made a young Kellie so very happy. Hanging out with you and the boys was always a highlight in our younger years.

You gave me another special gift this year when you departed the earth to be with your Father just a day before my birthday. I smile when I imagine you running into your Father's arms and receiving your "well done my good and faithful servant".

Auntie Bernice, I continue to cherish all your wisdom-filled songs, your memory will always live in my heart. Your darling Kellie.



TRIBUTE FROM – # PROF. E. KWEKU OSAM



TO A MARTYR OF OUR TIMES

Bernice! It's me. I gave you a nickname: BE-NOO BE-NOO; and in the whole wide world I was the only one who called you by that name. And this goes back into the 1980s. Whenever I belted out BE-NOO BE-NOO, you'd smile and simply say: "As for you . . ." When I returned to the University of Ghana in October 1982 as a graduate student, you were pursuing your BSc (Agriculture) programme and an active member of the University Christian Fellowship.
That was when I noticed your music ministry.

You and Kwame were behind Susie and me in the courting game. Your silky voice and strumming skills on the acoustic guitar were already making an impact. I asked you to sing during our wedding reception on January 3, 1987. I must have asked you to sing the song by Sam Allotey: Christ the Messiah. You melted hearts with that song, especially the chorus:

You are Christ, the Son of the Living God
You were born to save us from our sins
So, you are not John the Baptist
You just couldn't be Elijah
You are not Jeremiah
You are Christ the Messiah

Your ministry went national and global for well over thirty-something years. And I pretentiously declared myself your manager. The songs you wrote were no cotton candy stuff. They were solidly biblical. And you lived the faith, true to the truth you sang about. Over the years, The Heavens Are Telling became my all-time favourite.

Then God chose you. He put you in His Team A, like Job, in the firing line. You prayed. We prayed. From across the world. Some fasted. And we prayed. You fought. All those who knew you and were familiar with the battle prayed. We pleaded with heaven. The struggle was intense. So intense, I shed tears virtually on each visit. The intensity was extreme. So extreme, you could no longer respond to my bellowing of "BE-NOO BE-NOO". The conflict was raging; with incredible fury. But God trusted you. And you didn't fail Him.

Then the host of heaven flung open the gates. The final stages of the engagement were on. You were on a mission; the mission to say your final goodbye to the whole nation. I wept. We wept. We prayed. Finally, God recruited the tripodal agents. Then, sort of like Elijah, you were whisked away. Whisked away in the chariots of fire.

Now it all must be making sense to you – a prestigious member of the constellation of the great cloud of witnesses, inducted into the Faith Hall of Fame. You've joined them; those who did not receive the things promised; you only saw them from afar and welcomed them from a distance; those who were tortured, refusing to be released so that they might gain an even better resurrection.

My dear sister and my cherished friend, BE-NOO BE-NOO:

Da yie, dɔfo fonafo - Rest well, dear pilgrim
W'edwuma abɔ adze - Your labour is over
W'akwantu ber no asa - Your journey has ended
Da yie, dɔfo fonafo - Rest well, dear pilgrim

TRIBUTE FROM – PROF KWESI YANKAH



SINGING ALONG WITH ANGELS

I dedicate this to Bernice Offei, a neighbor at Legon for more than a decade, and a fellow worshipper at Legon Interdenominational Church.

At Legon, the Offei family was part of a warm and friendly neighborhood along with the Dovlos, the Perbis, the Kwadwos. As a writer, I particularly took interest in artists in the Lower Hill corridor; and was thrilled with the incidental presence of one of Ghana's greatest singers: Bernice Offei. You could call our neighborhood The Artist's Enclave. Here was Ebow Daniel, my neighbor directly opposite, who became my literary mentor and counselor. Down the lane was Atukwei Okai, a poet of immeasurable warmth and depth. The Offeis were special. While I collaborated with Kwame Offei as a fellow academic and administrator, we relied on the silky voice of Bernice on ceremonial occasions. We needed a special singer. Bernice sang to mark my 60th birthday, walking across with Kwame to the house reception, where she was stunned hearing my Yankah Youth Band perform one of her songs, "Life Is So Short.'

For Bernice, the most memorable encounter was when as Vice Chancellor of Central University, I invited her as a special guest artist for the University's thanksgiving service to celebrate our new presidential charter in 2016.

The captivating voice of Bernice Offei lit the horizon that day, and warmed the 2000-capacity Faith auditorium, lifting our Christian University to the high heavens. 'Hold On' was an inspiration to abide by faith in our quest for academic laurels and brought the entire congregation to its feet. Gracing the occasion was the Founder of Central University, Pastor Mensa Otabil, past university presidents, and special guests including Dr. Mahmoud & Samira Bawumia. Within an hour, Bernice, through song and grace had registered herself in people's hearts, particularly among students experiencing her for the very first time.

Bernice belonged to a small class of gospel artists rarely seen, but deeply felt in moments of contemplation: early morning and late-night hours. That's where her lyrics find their niche: 'Mogya,' 'Life is Short,' 'N'adom' compel listening, lifting our dear friend miles beyond pedestrian gospel. Her maiden hit, Hold On, has a timeless tenacity that explains the abiding faith that kept her stars shining through life.

But there goes Bernice so soon, leaving behind lyrics that linger forever in our hearts.

Our condolences to the Offei Family.
TO BERNICE WE SAY FAREWELL
AS YOU SING ALONG WITH ANGELS.

Prof. Kwesi Yankah

TRIBUTE FROM – PROF. BILL BUENAR PUPLAMPU

DEAR BERNICE, WHAT CAN WE SAY?



Within the space of a few months, we have lost two stalwarts of the Calvary Road family. Elder Dr. Sammy Nkansah. Now, Bernice Offei has departed this life. Musician, minstrel, spiritual pacesetter: your music gave hope to many, reminded us of our necessary mortality and led others to and into the presence of the Lord.

We mourn your passing, Bernice. Your dignity, your poise, your measured demeanor...yes, we mourn, however, we are also reminded of our faith, which was your faith and our hope, which was also your hope. We were students on the University of Ghana Campus in the early to mid-1980s. But before then, we were in Calvary Road Singers/Inc. I still have a mental picture of seeing you on the stairs of Volta Hall Annex one evening during the 1982-85 'Ofeibea' days! Yours, Bernice, was a signature voice in the singing ministry of the time. Calm, quiet, composed and always immaculately dressed. It came as no surprise when you launched your Solo Career and birthed a quiet but forceful gospel music genre which focused more on melody with deep lyrics than repetitive rhythm.

You performed at the Thanksgiving Service at Central University in 2016. As always, singing with dignity and meaning. In more recent years, I recall meeting you one afternoon at one of the Legon ATMs, not knowing then, that you had taken ill, but noting that the interaction was not as before. Later, Kwame confirmed the battle. Rest well Bernice. Thank you for your music. Thank you for your ministry. Thank you for your impact. Thank you for the lives you touched. In our limited humanity and its equally limited spaces, we cannot understand many things. What we do know is that in all our circumstances, our lives and our times are cradled in the all-containing, watchful and ever-present palms of our Maker and our Lord - in whose bosom you now rest.

Here is a little photo reminder: Abraham (Zolonzo), Lydia, Bernice, Bill – we all Legon graduates of 1985 and we all saved by the Blood of the Lamb. Goodbye Bernice.

TRIBUTE FROM – PROF. ERIC YIRENKYI DANQUAH

"Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven" (Matthew 5:16 KJV).



The message that Bernice Offei had died reached me unexpectedly that morning and left me shaken. I was at Gbawe, commiserating with one of my PRESEC Legon classmates when Professor Kwame Offei, my friend and colleague, sent me a brief text: "Bernice is gone."

I first met Bernice, née Djoleto, in the 1981/82

academic year when she entered the Faculty of Agriculture, University of Ghana. She carried herself with quiet confidence and natural warmth.

We became closer after she married Kwame, of the Department of Crop Science. For about two years in our early working lives, I lived opposite the Offeis in the Fellows Flats, Legon Hall Annex C. Bernice made sure I fellowshipped with them at the Legon Interdenominational Church.

While Kwame pursued his PhD at Imperial College, London, I was at the University of Cambridge. Our families bonded through reciprocal visits. Bernice and Kwame were with Ernestina and me in Cambridge on the day our daughter, Akosua Asantewa, was born at Addenbrooke's Hospital. Their presence remains a treasured part of our shared family history.

After we returned to Ghana, our families lived at Ayido Flats and later close to one another at Lower Hill. We never had a family event without the other family being closely involved. Bernice and Kwame contributed greatly to my Christian growth. Through their friendship, conversations, prayers, and example, they strengthened my own walk with God. Bernice made faith feel both serious and accessible, something to be lived with humility, courage, and practical love.

When Bernice produced Life Is Short, its message spoke directly to me. The song made me reflect on how I was living my life and reminded me of the brevity of our time and our responsibility to live meaningfully and honour God. Years later, Bernice would still remind me of Life Is Short, almost as a personal ministration to me, a message between us that I now hold even more dearly. She was down to earth and related to me with warmth and simplicity. Whenever she saw me, she called me "Chairman" or "Bobo." She never addressed me by my formal titles. That familiarity expressed the affection and trust we shared. Bernice had the rare ability to make people feel accepted without making a show of it. She was gracious, confident and deeply committed to her faith.

Her songs, including Hold On and Life Is Short, encouraged many people and strengthened their faith. Through those songs, Bernice's voice will continue to touch lives.

My deepest condolences go to my dear friend and colleague, Kwame, their sons, Kevin and Daniel, and the entire family. I pray that God will comfort and strengthen them in the days ahead.

Bernice's departure leaves a painful absence, but also a clear legacy of friendship, faith, humility and service. I am grateful to have known her and to have been touched by her life.

May Bernice rest peacefully in the Lord.

TRIBUTE FROM – PROF. ESTHER SAKYI-DAWSON

I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith" (2 Timothy 4:7).

I thank God for the gift of Bernice's life and for the privilege of our family having known her for so many years. Each time I think of Bernice, the words that come to mind are: cool, calm, collected - a lady with poise. That was my first impression of her when I got to know her through SU at Achimota School. She was in Form 3 and I was in Upper 6. Those qualities, together with her unwavering faith in God, never changed. Bernice was reliable and consistent, and to me, she was always Awula Bernice.



Little did I know that, many years later, our lives would become deeply intertwined through the men we married. They were friends from Makrosec and both lectured in the School of Agriculture. Over the years, our friendship grew into something much deeper. We became more like family than friends, and Bernice related to me as a big sister. Our children grew up together as a family. We shared many memories - from London and Reading to Ayido Valley Flats and Lower Hill in Legon. We both loved walking, an chance meetings along the streets of Legon on Saturday mornings became treasured moments - pausing to talk, walk together for a while, and catch up on our lives. Her music was a feature in our home, and there was no way we would miss her album launches. As a family, we admired her talent, her humility and the quiet grace with which she carried herself. Bernice never allowed "stardom" to get into her head. She remained the same simple, beautiful, poised lady, with her trademark dangling earrings.

On a personal level, I found Bernice to be an incredibly reliable person. I will always remember the prayer support she gave me when Owuraku, my husband, was ill. Knowing how much he loved her music, she would sometimes sing to him when she visited. During those dark days, I told her how much I appreciated the song "Hold On Fast." It seemed as though it had been written especially for me. In the past couple of years, it was heartbreaking to watch Bernice slowly fade because of ill health. Yet, once again, that same song became the one we held on to whenever we prayed for her. Bernice was also someone I could call at the last minute to stand in as an officiant at church when there was an emergency. I never had to think twice. If she was available, she would willingly step in. She always officiated with grace, dignity and sincerity. That was Bernice - willing to serve, always faithful.

Today, as a family, our hearts are heavy because we will miss her gentle presence, her friendship, and of course, her beautiful voice. Our comfort lies in the knowledge that Bernice has fought the good fight, kept the faith and finished her earthly race, and we believe the Lord has received her with the words: "Well done, good and faithful servant".

Though Bernice's earthly voice may now be silent, through the songs she sang, the prayers she offered and the lives she touched she continues to speak. We who remain will continue to hold on fast - to our faith, to the precious memories she gave us, and to the hope of seeing her again.

Rest peacefully, dear Bernice. Awula Bernice yaawɔ yɛ toiŋ jɔlemli.

TRIBUTE FROM – GLADYS BREW

If in this life only we have hope in Christ, we are of all men the most pitiable. But now Christ has risen from the dead, and has become the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep (1 Corinthians 15:19-20).

My first recollection of Bernice was one of a very quiet girl who minded her own business in Clark House, Achimota School, where I was a year behind her. We came into closer contact as we both belonged to the Scripture Union. Perhaps our Presbyterian upbringing and a shared love for music may have brought us closer because I recall that we sang a duet "Wɔ Tsɛ Nyɔŋmɔ Ode Misusuma Yɔɔ" during one of the Gospel Rock Shows in Achimota in the late 70's.

I don't recall Bernice was a member of the School Choir, but she certainly made much melody in Clark House when her voice was regularly heard in the many songs she sang in the bathroom; she cared very little for the taboo of not singing while bathing.

Bernice and I were members of the music department of the then Calvary Road Evangelistic Ministry. As a soprano singer she sometimes took the solo part of the songs. I recall the solo she took for the last verse of the song "Onyankopɔn Dɔ" (written by Kofi Ampadu), which can never be erased from my

memory. This last verse echoes Scriptures on the open invitation to all to make the decision of faith and obedience to God a matter of urgency:
"Owu da hɔ ma yɛn nyinaa
Enti me nua bra Yesu nkyɛn
Ɔrefrɛ wo ɛnɛ da yi
Nkwa foforo bi retwɛn wo"

Her voice in this solo carried a vibrato that melted many a hardened heart to receive the gift of salvation through our Lord Jesus Christ. Bernice was not one who raised her voice; she raised her words through singing and blessed her generation.

My friend, although life pulled us in different directions, we crossed paths every now and then and we were happy to share memories. Even though years passed without a word, the foundation we built in our youth never faded.

I am so grateful for the last three years, which gave us a chance to reconnect.

Though memories slipped away, the warmth of who you were stayed with me.

It feels too soon to say goodbye, especially when I have found an opportunity to learn and reconnect with you. And yet it is not really a goodbye, but a good repose for you because you accomplished your purpose and our Heavenly Father chose to call you Home.

Rest well and get refreshed for the Great Day when there will be no more parting.

TRIBUTE FROM – FLORENCE HUTCHFUL

Bernice's passing has taken my mind back many years - to a time when her songs were played constantly in our home at Ayido Valley, on the University of Ghana campus. My late husband, Kweku, and I were both great lovers of Bernice's music. At the time, my favourite of Bernice's songs was 'The Little Boy'. Even today, hearing that song takes me back to those wonderful years and to the warmth and joy that her music brought into our lives.

I remember in particular, the joy surrounding Bernice and Kwame's wedding at Legon, in October, 1987. My daughter, Mammie, and Anita, Joe and Aggie Budu's daughter, had the honour of being their flower girls, while T.V.O. Lamptey and Alice's son, Selasie, served as their page boy. It was a beautiful and memorable occasion.

Bernice joined Standard Chartered Bank as a Merchant Sales Officer in May 1999, while I was working there as the Area Head, HR. She pursued both her professional career and music ministry with remarkable diligence and zeal. When I left the Bank some years later, Bernice had risen to the position of Manager in the Cards department.

In addition to her professional responsibilities, Bernice was often called upon to minister at some of the Bank's official functions. One particularly remarkable incident that remains vivid in my mind occurred in March 2002, when the Group CEO of the Bank, Mervyn Davies, visited Ghana. At a dinner held in his honor, Bernice gave a performance accompanied by a group of young women whom I believe were members of the Legon Interdenominational Church (LIC), where she worshipped.

After the performance, one of the Bank's top executives asked Bernice to tell the visiting Group CEO, should he inquire, that the women who had accompanied her were members of the Bank's staff.

Bernice firmly told the executive that she could not say something that was not true. She simply would not compromise her principles. That was Bernice, a woman of integrity, whose faith was not merely something she professed, but something she lived. The strong Christian values instilled in her and deeply rooted in her character guided her actions. She remained true to them, regardless of the circumstances or who was involved. She was not afraid to speak truth to power.

That quiet strength of character was one of the things that made Bernice so special and

always remember.

At this difficult time, my thoughts and prayers are especially with Kwame, Kevin, Daniel and the entire family. May the Lord grant you strength, comfort, and peace as you mourn this great loss.

May Bernice's beautiful soul rest in perfect peace.

TRIBUTE FROM – AWURAA AMMA ELEBLU

I do not remember exactly when I first met Auntie Bernice, but I remember when I first became captivated by her music. I was barely a teen when I would pick up the sleeve of the We Are Victors album on Saturday mornings and sing every song from beginning to end. Long before Auntie Bernice became my friend, she was a voice I loved.

She was one of my mother's "younger friends," which was how I was introduced to her. Somewhere along the way, she became one of my good "older friends."

I loved to tease her, especially about how a Ga-speaking woman had ended up singing so many Twi songs. At rehearsals, she would sometimes start singing while we were still working out the dance moves. I would turn to her in surprise and say, 'Ei, that's really your voice!' Somehow, hearing that familiar recorded voice coming from the person standing right beside me always caught me off guard. She would simply smile and shake her head at me.

Auntie Bernice became part of some of the most important moments of my life. When Franklin and I were getting married, there was never really a question about whether she would sing. The question was simply what we wanted her to sing. She ministered happily, and we had our first dance as husband and wife with Auntie Bernice singing.

Her music kept finding its way into our family story. When she filmed Life Is Short, I had just had my firstborn. The video was filmed at my parents' home while I was staying there, and my baby ended up having her first "gig" as the baby in the video. At the time, it was simply another Auntie Bernice adventure. Today, there is something deeply moving about that



memory.

She called me her "darling little sister." I called her "Auntie Beeeee." And one phrase appeared again and again between us: "Missed you." Sometimes it came from me. Sometimes from her.

When Auntie Bernice became unwell a couple of weeks before she went to be with the Lord, Franklin and I visited her. On one of those visits, I stood at her bedside, held her hand and sang to her until she fell asleep. She held my hand so tightly that when she eventually slept, I had to gently pull my hand out of hers.

I was hopeful. I thought the strength of her grip was a sign that she was going to get better and come back to us. I did not know that would be one of the last times I would hold her hand. I did not know I was singing her to sleep for the last time. I did not realise I was saying goodbye.

When I heard that she was gone, I wept. Then I did something I had been doing since I was a little girl. I played Auntie Bernice's songs and sang. For hours. Only this time, I was not

the little girl singing because I loved the voice coming through the speakers. I was singing the songs of someone I had come to love as a sister, friend and Auntie, and through those songs, I felt surrounded by the presence and comfort of the Lord.

Auntie Beeeee, "Missed you" used to mean that it had simply been too long since we had seen each other.

It means something very different now.
I miss you.
But I am grateful that your voice remains.
Until we meet again.

TRIBUTE FROM – FRANKLIN ELEBLU

My first encounter with Aunty Bernice was about 33 years ago, through a cassette I had borrowed from a friend. It was her first album. My favourite was not the popular "We Are Victors," but her lesser-known duet with Uncle T.V.O. Lamptey, "What Is Man?". To this day, it remains one of my personal favourites. Looking back, I can hear in that song the themes that would run through her music: God's greatness and sovereignty, and our call to live in obedience to Him, no matter the cost.

When the family later returned from abroad, and I began seeing her at LIC, she struck me as a very simple, unassuming person who would occasionally sing in church with her guitar. I was very shy and never quite dared to approach the celebrity. Of course she did nothing to make herself unapproachable; I supplied all the intimidation myself.

One 31st-night service, while I was home from university, she sang a song released during my time away. Almost immediately, large sections of the congregation got up to dance. Apparently, the song and the congregation already knew each other well. I was the one who needed an introduction. It was "Hold On", a song that would become a national favourite and an enduring source of encouragement.

Years later, when I was tasked with leading the newly-constituted LIC Choir, I worked closely with Uncle T.V.O., who led the music ministry, and Aunty Bernice, his deputy. The celebrity I had admired from a safe distance became a dear friend.

It helped that she was already friends with Awuraa Amma, then my girlfriend. Amma would later complain that whenever she introduced me to her friends, I "stole" them from her. Aunty Bernice became the chief exhibit in her case. Uncle Romeo was the other. I had very little to say in my defence.

It meant a great deal to me that Aunty Bernice



would occasionally ask for my thoughts on her music. Then, in 2009, she gave me the extraordinary privilege of serving as music director for her "Bernice@30" concert. I had borrowed a cassette from a friend simply to enjoy her music. I could never have imagined that one day she would trust me to help bring that music to the stage.

She was all about the message of her songs. "Moving the crowd" was not her priority. Her listeners knew her that way and loved her that way. She did not need to become someone else.

She also had names for Amma and me: "Mr Blue" and "Mrs Blue". Even now, I sometimes catch myself calling my wife 'Mrs Blue'. It's funny to think that I sometimes actually use a name for my wife that someone else chose.

Aunty Bernice, you taught me the value of staying in my lane: knowing what God has entrusted to me and being faithful to it, without feeling compelled to become someone else. You lived that lesson. You were yourself through and through, steadfast in your message and unhurried by the pressure to be anything else.

Thank you for the songs, the friendship and the privilege of making music together. I will miss you, Aunty Bernice. 'Mr Blue' and 'Mrs Blue' will remember you with love.

TRIBUTE FROM – RABI BRIMAH



Bernice... Sweet Bernice...
These last couple of months, I have been absolutely distraught, and I believe it's been the same for your loved ones too. Not because we don't know that you're in a better place, but because this is simply not the turn of events we expected.

For the last few years, I ached over and held in my heart the memory of the Bernice I once knew so well. There were moments I longed to share my own personal challenges with you for your prayer support, but circumstances made it impossible. I prayed earnestly for you, almost every single day, during these years. And especially over the days leading to your transition, my prayer tempo increased because I was so convinced our God was about to show up and show off. But as you would have reminded me, "The Lord's ways are not our ways. He sees what we cannot see; He knows what we do not know."

We don't have the full picture - we never will. Only God does, and we cannot question Him. Your songs are evident of the fact that you were completely sold out to your Maker and would never question Him. Lyrics like "We will follow till we die," or "I will keep holding on to your Word, even if You don't grant my request" and "I will keep loving You till the day I die" speak volumes about your faith. And if you would not question God, why should we?

I thank God for the rare privilege of knowing you as a sister - first through our time together at Standard Chartered Bank, and later as our bond deepened with your gracious presence and support on the Rev and Rab Show on Sunny FM. I'll say it again and again: I've never seen a purer soul than you, Bernice. You were so mindful of your words, not wanting to speak ill of anyone, even when they had offended you. You wouldn't hurt a fly; literally. You showed up for me whenever you could, and showed me so much kindness, Sis. I hope to God I was able to reciprocate that with my prayers, at least.

I remember how your face would light up whenever I played your songs during my visits. You would sing them with me word for word and even correct me when I got some of the lyrics wrong. And oh, I will never forget how you responded to 'Goodness of God' by CeCe Winans. I was amazed at how you sang and worshiped along with me. Those precious moments taught me something I will never forget: what is deeply rooted in our hearts will rise to the surface even when so much else becomes difficult to access. What God deposits in us is not easily erased.

You loved God passionately, and you loved His people deeply. Sometimes our conversations left me feeling like I wasn't "Christian" enough, simply because of the purity that emanated from your words and the depth of your love for Jesus.
My consolation is that you lived a good life - blessed with a supportive husband, well-brought-up sons, caring siblings and many other loved ones who surrounded you with love. Indeed, you lived well and were dearly loved.

You were not just a musician; you were a minister of God. Your music and your life pointed people to Jesus. You constantly reminded us of the brevity of life and the importance of getting our hearts right with God. And you left us with so many spirit-filled songs that have healed, encouraged, and carried people through some of their darkest seasons. What a legend! What a legacy!
You ran your race, Sis. You fought the good fight. You kept the faith. Well done, good and faithful servant.

And let me say this too: the devil did not win. No. He never does; not in the life of a child of God. Our hope has never been in how long we live, or in how perfectly our earthly journey unfolds. Our hope is in Christ; Christ in us, the hope of glory. So, we will continue to lift high His banner until He calls us home, just as you did.

Rest well in the Lord, my dear sister. Your race is finished. Your assignment is complete.

Till we meet again...

TRIBUTE FROM – BOKPIN FAMILY

It is with great grace and strength from God that we write this tribute as it takes us down memory lane, recalling the warm and kind person Aunty Bernice was.

As a family, we encountered you beyond your music, as we had a parent-child relationship with you and Prof. My wife admired and described you as a songwriter whose music was distinct, graced with a touch she couldn't really explain, but believed was divine.

On the night of the gas explosion in 2017, my family had a much closer encounter with you while I was outside the country; indeed, actions speak louder than words. On that fateful night, your family, including other welcoming families such as the Afranies and the Mettles, showed us love in action. On short notice, you welcomed us into your home and offered us a place to spend the night. Not only did you give us a place, but you prepared warm milk for the children, which they always remember and appreciate you for. The relationship we had grew stronger as, from time to time, we visited the house and you and Prof. offered us godly counsel. We still remember your warm smile and soft-spoken nature. Time and space will not allow us to recount the numerous gifts, especially during the Christmas seasons and the children's naming ceremonies at Dome and on campus.

Aunty Bernice, we are grateful for everything. You loved the LORD, and you served Him faithfully. We are convinced that you are resting in the bosom of your Maker.

Rest well, mother of many.

TRIBUTE FROM – DR. EMMANUEL CANACOO



My first meeting with Bernice was some four decades ago at the International Institute of Tropical Agriculture (IITA) at Ibadan, Nigeria, where she was on a short attachment. She made an instant impression on me - a beautiful ebony black woman with a charming smile. A few casual exchanges and before long, she returned to Ghana.

A year or two later came the second sighting of Bernice! It was in the Faculty of Agriculture, University of Ghana, where she was in the middle of her Master's program and I had come on staff. This was when I got to know Bernice better. Her beauty was not superficial. It was the external manifestation of inner beauty tethered to a solid Christian faith. It made it easy to relate with her. We talked about many things without the inhibition of a senior brother-little sister feeling.
I loved Bernice's songs and the genuineness of spirit with which they were rendered. I felt honored, therefore, when she asked me to offer the opening and closing prayers at one of her ministry events at the Osu Presbyterian Church. I also called on her many times to render special songs when I led the liturgy at the Legon Interdenominational Church (LIC). Such was the mutual admiration we had for each other.

The last time I saw Bernice was in October 2024 when I visited LIC. She had health challenges, but the philia connection we had resulted in an instant hug. Little did I know that it was going to be the last time we would see each other.

I will dearly miss the sights and sounds of Bernice, but I am happy she is at rest in the Lord.

To Kwame, Kevin and Daniel: be comforted that you had a lovely wife and mother loved by God and humanity. She touched many lives in a good way. She will be fondly remembered always.

TRIBUTE FROM THE –

HEPHZIBAH WORSHIP CONFERENCE & THE CHRISTIAN MUSIC ASSOCIATION, GHANA (CMAG)

Aunty Bernice was a phenomenal woman and a tremendous blessing to us at the Hephzibah Conference. Since the inception of the Hephzibah Summit retreat (formerly the Kitase Summit), that would eventually grow into the Hephzibah Worship Conference we know today, Aunty Bernice was among those who fully embraced the vision and committed their time, gifts, and resources to help build it. Her commitment flowed from the depth of her Christian conviction. Whenever she was able to attend, Aunty Bernice always arrived early and participated fully. She understood the importance of deliberately setting time aside, at least once a year, to retreat from the demands of ministry in order to reconnect with God, fellowship with fellow ministers, and receive strength for the journey ahead.

Aunty Bernice was soft-spoken, the very embodiment of gentleness. Her characteristic smile was warm; it both welcomed and reassured you. Yet, beneath that quiet disposition, she was a woman of remarkable depth.

Her contributions during our Bible studies, devotions, and discussion sessions inspired and instructed us all. Aunty Bernice had a way of speaking that reflected both wisdom and deep humility. She didn't need to shout to make an impact, for her words carried the weight of a lifetime spent walking with Christ.

The younger minstrels who had the privilege of sharing a room with Aunty Bernice often testified to the profound impact of those moments together. In the ordinary rhythms of fellowship, in daily conversation, prayer, and rest, she was a mentor and an example. Even without deliberate instruction, her life taught us.

Our musical gatherings were also greatly enriched by Aunty Bernice's presence. Her melodious voice gave beauty to our Hymns Nights and to the recordings we made together, deepening their quality and helping preserve memories that many of us will cherish for a lifetime.

Aunty Bernice was also active in Women In Gospel Music (WIGM) and participated as much as she could in all our efforts toward the establishment of the Christian Music Association, Ghana (CMAG). Her desire to see music ministers connected, strengthened, and equipped was evident in her participation and support.

And so, today, we mourn the passing of a gift. We mourn an illustrious music minister who served the Kingdom faithfully and bore fruit bountifully. We mourn an elder sister who was a great example and role model to emulate. We mourn a songwriter who captured messages about God in music and led hearts to seek Him. We mourn a gentle voice, a warm smile, a wise contributor, a faithful participant, and a beloved sister in the ministry, but we do not mourn as those who have no hope.

Together with the saints who have gone before us to await the resurrection morning, we will continue, as Aunty Bernice sang, to "Hold On Fast." We will hold firmly to Christ and to the hope of the gospel, refusing to allow the enemy to deceive or cause us to forget the promises of God.

We will continue singing "Kaashe Gbeyei," and we will never forget the sobering reminder that "Life is Short."

And perhaps this is one of the most beautiful ways in which Aunty Bernice's ministry continues to speak to us. Her songs were not merely melodies; they are vessels carrying truths about God, faith, life, and eternity. Now, in her absence, those songs take on an even deeper significance. We have lost a gift, but her testimony remains. Her songs remain, and the example of her life continues to speak.

So, Aunty Bernice, as we say farewell, we will hold on fast. We will keep singing, serving, and pointing hearts to Christ, and we will look forward to that glorious resurrection morning when, by the grace of God, we shall meet again in the presence of our Lord.

Till we meet again... fare thee well, Aunty Bernice.

TRIBUTE TO MRS. BERNICE OFFEI (NÉE DJOLETO) –

From the Ghana Fellowship of Evangelical Students (GHAFES)

On behalf of the National Director, the Board, the staff, and the students and alumni across our campuses, the Ghana Fellowship of Evangelical Students (GHAFES) extends our deepest condolences to the Offei and Djoleto families on the passing of Mrs. Bernice Offei, née Djoleto. We join you in grieving, and we join you in giving thanks to God for a life that sang His praise.

Bernice's story with our Fellowship family stretches back nearly half a century. Those who knew her recall meeting her at the Scripture Union Junior Camp at Labone Secondary School in 1976, and sharing the Youth Evangelism School at the turn of the 1980s. She was shy and quiet in those early days, and many first saw her learning to play the guitar. None of us could have known how far that guitar and that voice would carry the Gospel.

When Bernice entered the University of Ghana, Legon, in 1984, she found her place in the University Christian Fellowship (UCF), which later became GHAFES. There she joined the Outreach sub-group, whose calling was to take Christ to the unreached youth of our day through evangelism, musical concerts and joint programmes with other schools and campus ministries. As head of the musical team, she worked hand-in-hand with the evangelism team. Together they went to the Presbyterian Boys' Senior High School (PRESEC, Legon) and the School of Professional Studies (now University of Professional Studies, Accra – UPSA), and held a crusade at East Legon, among other places. At every weekly meeting, Bernice took up her guitar and ministered to her fellow students with her beautiful songs. Those who served beside her still remember her warmly and count it a joy to have belonged to that team. Bernice was an authentic person, and her faith came through in her songs. She had a rich, silky voice, and the ministry for which she became well known - Calvary Road, was a delight to all who heard it. She was also down-to-earth. Because she had found her identity in Christ, she had no need to show off or to put on airs. She belonged to a generation for which the question that mattered was not which church you attended, but whether you were born again. She lived that conviction humbly and sang it faithfully.

Bernice's songs say it all: life comes full circle so fast. For many of us, the years since we first met her have passed in what feels like a moment. Yet her music remains, and through it she continues to bear witness to the Saviour she loved. GHAFES is grateful to God for the ministry of Bernice in our early days, and for the many students and young people whose lives were touched through her songs and her service.

To her husband, children, family and friends, we pray that the God of all comfort will hold you close in this season. Bernice can now join the saints above, that great cloud of witnesses, making music to the Lamb. Her task here is done. May her good deeds follow her, and may her soul rest in perfect peace.

Rest in peace, Bernice.

National Director, on behalf of the GHAFES family

TRIBUTE TO MRS. BERNICE OFFEI (NÉE DJOLETO) –

FROM INSPIRATIONAL HOUR MINISTRIES

To the world, Aunty Bernice was a gospel singer whose songs carried people through hard days. To us, she was a mother, a counsellor, and a friend who believed in us before we had much to show.

When Inspirational Hour Ministries was just beginning, she and Prof. Offei opened their hearts and their home to us. They gave us a place to gather, wise advice, and constant encouragement. They never made us feel small for starting small. Without their support, this ministry would not be what it is today. We will always be grateful.

She was a woman of great gifts. She was a gifted singer and songwriter, an award-winning artist, a scholar, and a professional. Yet she carried all of it with humility. She was as comfortable sitting with a young ministry as she was on a big stage. She listened well, she spoke gently, and she prayed for people sincerely. If she said: "I'm praying for you," you knew she meant it.

Mama, you ran your race, and you ran it well. The songs you gave us will keep comforting people for years. The ministry you helped carry will keep going, and we will do our best to make you proud.

To Prof. Offei and the children: we are sorry for your loss, and we thank you for sharing her with us. Her love for you showed in everything she did, and we saw it often.

Thank you, Aunty Bernice. We love you, and we will miss you.

Home yie, Mama Bernice (Rest well, Mother Bernice).

Da yie. Home Asomdwe mu (Sleep well. Rest in peace).

TRIBUTE TO MRS. BERNICE OFFEI (NÉE DJOLETO) –

BY THE LEGENDARY MINSTRELS ASSOCIATION OF GHANA (LeMAG)

In 2024, when we started gathering Gospel Legends of the 80s and 90s, we were hinted about your ill-health. We prayed and hoped that you would get well soon to join us. Little did we know that you would take the lead.

In making a roll call for Ghanaian Gospel hits, your place in the late 90's cannot be over emphasized. Though we mourn because you are gone, we do not mourn as people without hope. Because we know you are at a better place.

We may want to pause and reflect on Sabine Baring-Gould's hymn.

Now the day is over, night is drawing nigh;
Shadows of the evening, steal across the sky
Sleep well in our anointed vessel. May you find rest in His presence.

TRIBUTE IN MEMORY OF THE LATE MRS. BERNICE OFEIBEA OFFEI –

BY THE CARDS SERVICES TEAM, STANDARD CHARTERED BANK, GHANA

"For I am persuaded, that neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor powers, nor things present, nor things to come, nor height, nor depth, nor any other creature, shall be able to separate us from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus our Lord" (Romans 8:38-39).

Our dearest Sis Bee, as we affectionately called you - you were more than the Head of Card Services leading a team that served six African countries; you were the heart that held us together. It was a demanding role, yet you carried it with remarkable grace, dignity, and quiet strength.

Your leadership shaped us and brought out the best in everyone. You made us resilient, both mentally and emotionally. Under you, we recorded many successes and shared countless moments of laughter that we will always cherish.

In all your years with us, you never raised your voice, yet your correction carried weight because of the deep respect and love we had for you. You embodied kindness and were firm when it mattered most.
With time, you ceased to be just our manager. You became our mother, our big sister, our confidante and our safe haven.

You transformed the Cards Team into a family. Although many of us have moved on to different paths, the bond you nurtured remains unbroken. The WhatsApp group we cherish daily, where we laugh, check on one another and share life, is your enduring legacy. Sis Bee, your passing has left us heartbroken. We wish we had more time and more moments together, for the bond we shared was truly precious.

But who are we to question the sovereignty of God?

We are profoundly grateful for the light you were to us and to the many whose lives were touched by your music and the divine gift God bestowed on you. Your presence was warm, your strength reassuring, and your smile healing. You will be greatly missed.
May your gentle soul rest in perfect peace till we meet again.

"Those we love don't go away, they walk beside us every day, unseen, unheard, but always near, still loved, still missed, and very dear."

Rest well, our dear Sis Bee. Forever in our hearts.

TRIBUTE TO BERNICE OFFEI –

FROM NII OKAI, LEAD PASTOR, THE iCHURCH, TEMA; CONVENOR, THE HEPHZIBAH CONFERENCE

It was Wednesday, March 29, 2006, between 8:30 a.m. and 9:30 a.m. GMT, the venue was the rooftop of the then Standard Chartered Ghana Head Office at the High Street, opposite the Holy Trinity Cathedral. I was then the Outserve Champion of the Shared Service Centre and she was the Card Services Manager of the same division. But the meeting was of a global nature - the eclipse of the Sun, which actually lasted about 4 minutes and 7 seconds in the wider path, and had the entire country in a frenzy; the staff were all in our special protective eyewear which included filtered glasses and makeshift cardboard viewers to prevent eye damage. Ordinarily, the Cards Centre was a restricted zone, and yet retained the only access to the rooftop, so the event made a way for regular staff to have a one-time access to the rooftop for this global viewing event.

Not so for me, because our shared calling and leadership roles within the Shared Service Center afforded us the opportunity to interact almost every week. Card issues were one of the top complaints I had to follow up

on with our service providers; the gallant men and women that were being managed by Bernice Offei - the legendary songstress we grew up listening to. So we stood side-by-side on the rooftop and witnessed the eclipse of the sun. During the experience, she lifted up her hands and started worshipping. As soon as the spectacle was over and we were returning to our offices, she went on and on about the handiworks of God and I could sense a song coming.

It didn't take too long afterwards. I got a call from my mentor and her sound engineer, Uncle T.V.O. Lamptey, to get ready to come do the backing vocals for her upcoming project. Prior to joining the bank, I was a regular session backing vocalist at the Vision Audio Lab in Haatso, Accra, with the likes of Grace Obeng-Darko (Aida-Graciella / Mother Maya), Abigail Nkansah Mensah and Maana Ampa Sowa, depending on who the client was. I had, however, burst onto the scene with my maiden hit album - Moko Bɛ, and coupled with the bank work, I wasn't available for regular sessions anymore. Bernice's projects were, however, not the regular.

She was meek and knew exactly what she heard in her spirit when it came to producing her songs. Only a few 'Bezaleels' like Uncle Kwesi Dickson, another senior banker, could chaperone her work, and Uncle T.V.O. was there to guide us all in keeping the integrity of her music. My brothers Makafui Kwami and Samuel Koranteng were assisting Uncle T.V.O. at the time, and left to us alone, we would have rebranded Auntie Bernice's music into our contemporary groove. Uncle T.V.O. would, however, steer us gently into submission. It was a priceless learning experience working with the legend, who had become my colleague at the bank.

Guess my excitement when we started laying the tracks one after the other and we got to the song - Your handiwork is so beautiful. It was so surreal. Auntie Bernice had beautifully captured the experience of the eclipse in song, and I was standing right beside her during the experience with no clue as to what to do with the same. That was my introduction to Songwriting 101. I do receive, write, and arrange songs, but I had never felt the weight of responsibility to capture moments in song. She was in the masterclass. She was never concerned with goings in the industry, so she approached albums from a pure ministry perspective. The onus was always on the likes of Uncles Kwesi & T.V.O. to try and package her music. And they always found the right balance.

Our friendship would grow into that of a big sister and small brother, and I was privileged to be among the few who could call her Ofeibea. She was a regular at our annual Hephzibah Conference in Peduase, where we prayed, broke bread and sang hymns until she was unable to attend due to ill health. Over a year ago, we invaded her living room and sang through her entire repertoire with her, and her family remarked that it was the most joyful experience for her at the time. We really wished we could do more, but The Lord knows best.

During my year abroad stint in Cotonou, Benin, we visited l'Eglise de la Foi Agissante (Action Chapel), and guess what song the francophone choir was ministering: Hold on Fast by Bernice Offei. We literally took over the song and felt a sense of pride. I believe she sang her life's purpose and all one needs to do is to stream her music to discover the life and ministry of Bernice Offei.

From Nii Okai, Lead Pastor, The iChurch, Tema; Convenor, The Hephzibah Conference

TRIBUTE BY – REV. KOFI AMPADU

"Precious in the sight of the Lord is the death of His saints" (Psalm 116:15).

I never imagined that a day would come when I would have to write a tribute to my beloved sister and friend, Bernice, with a heart filled with both sadness and gratitude.

Sadness, because I have lost someone very special; gratitude, because for 45 years, I had the privilege of calling Bernice my sister and friend. In time, that friendship also extended to Prof. Kwame Offei, who became part of the story we shared.

In 1979, we met as members of the Calvary Road Singers where I was the music director. Little did either of us know that this meeting would mark the beginning of a friendship that would span four and a half decades. Our shared love for God, expressed through music, was the thread that first wove our lives together.

One memory I will forever cherish is Bernice singing a solo on one of my compositions, "Onyankopɔn Dɔ" which, in 1979, captured the hearts of many across Ghana. Through the airwaves of GBC Radio, Bernice's voice could be heard on many afternoons, bringing those words and that music to life.

There was something truly special about hearing Bernice sing. Her voice carried emotion, and she also had that rare gift of making people both hear and feel the music. And that gift was recognised far beyond our own circle.

Bernice went on to become a celebrated and accomplished musician, earning three awards in recognition of her extraordinary talent.

But those of us who knew her personally understand that beyond that impressive persona and accolades was a woman who was a real gem - kind-hearted, compassionate and precious in ways that no award could ever fully capture.

Bernice visited us in the UK and it was a privilege having her sing in our Church. During her ministry that day she remarked that my musical prowess and anointing had contributed to her own music ministry. Those words meant a great deal to me, and I remain grateful for that special moment.

Perhaps, the greatest tribute we can pay Bernice is to celebrate the life she lived. For a life well-lived leaves traces of its goodness long after its earthly journey has ended.

Bernice, I will always be grateful that you became part of my story, and I became part of yours through friendship, faith and music; creating a bond that the passing years would not erase.

Death may have brought our earthly fellowship to an end, but it cannot erase the memory of the voice that sang "Onyankopɔn Dɔ."
Rest peacefully, Bernice. Though you are now out of our sight, you will forever remain in our hearts.

Your laughter, your music and the inspiration you brought into mine, and other lives will be deeply missed. Yet, the beautiful legacy you leave behind will continue to speak, and the melody of your life will linger in the hearts of all who knew and loved you.

Rest in perfect peace, until we meet again.



TRIBUTE IN LOVING MEMORY OF OUR DEAR SISTER IN CHRIST , BERNICE OFFEI –

REV. DR. JOYCE R. ARYEE - EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR, SALT AND LIGHT MINISTRIES

It is with a deeply reflective yet grateful heart that I pay tribute to a truly remarkable daughter of Zion - our beloved Bernice Offei. Bernice was not merely a gifted singer; she was a vessel of grace, a paragon of humility, and a shining light whose ministry bridged the sacred intersection of faith, integrity, and artistic excellence.

In a world often preoccupied with the noise of fleeting fame, Bernice stood out for her quiet dignity and steadfast devotion. Her music was a pure reflection of her character - polished, principled, and deeply rooted in the Gospel. Through her evergreen songs like **"Hold On"** and **"Life is Short,"** she reminded us of the ultimate truth of our pilgrimage on earth: that our time here is a precious trust, and our highest calling is to live with eternity in view.

I am reminded of the words of the Holy Scripture in **2 Timothy 4:7–8: "I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. Now there is in store for me the crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous Judge, will award to me on that day..."**

Bernice fought her fight with grace and kept the faith with unyielding integrity. Her songs were non-formal sermons that brought comfort to the brokenhearted, strength to the weary, and moral clarity to our nation. She carried herself with the dignity of a true Ghanaian woman and the humility of a devoted servant of God, showing us that one can reach the highest peaks of excellence without compromising one's values.

As we bid farewell to this sweet psalmist, we do not mourn as those without hope.

We draw comfort from the timeless hymn that assures us:

"When peace like a river attendeth my way,
When sorrows like sea billows roll;
Whatever my lot, Thou hast taught me to say,
It is well, it is well with my soul."

To her family, loved ones, and the entire body of Christ: May the Peace of God, which surpasses all human understanding, guard your hearts and minds. Bernice has run her course, she has completed her assignment, and she has entered into the joyful rest of her Creator and Redeemer.

May the Almighty God grant her soul peaceful eternal rest in His heavenly courts.

TRIBUTE FROM–

DR. SAMUEL KISSEADOO

"Precious in the sight of the Lord is the death of His saints." (Psalm 116:15).

I first met Bernice in March 1975, when I ministered at Achimota College during a Sunday morning Scripture Union (SU) meeting. That first encounter marked the beginning of a relationship that would remain meaningful over the years.

At the time, I was an undergraduate at KNUST in Kumasi, travelling to schools across Accra and Tema to share the Gospel. She and her SU friends recommitted their lives to Christ and from then on Bernice became a very dear daughter of mine in the Lord.

I visited Bernice at home and school, praying with her and sharing God's Word. We stayed in touch over the years, even while I was in Europe and later the USA.

What I remember most about Bernice was her gentle spirit, deep humility and genuine love for the Lord and His work.

Her godliness was not merely something she displayed, it was evident in the way she lived and related to others. Indeed, a director of a leading media house once described her as one of the few minstrels who had remained faithful to the godly standards with which she began her ministry.

Bernice remained a cherished part of my journey over the years. In 1982, she and the Calvary Road Singers added a special touch to our wedding (my wife Henrietta and I) by ministering in song at the Aggrey Chapel in Achimota School. Then, in September 2009, while I lay seriously ill at Korle Bu Hospital, Bernice reached out to tell me about a special concert being held in her honour. Unable to attend because of my critical condition, I could only scribble a brief testimony on a piece of paper to be read on my behalf.

Our God is sovereign!

If we were to fully understand Him, He would not be big enough to be Lord God The Almighty. We therefore give God the glory for His Wisdom in whatever He allows to happen.
Precious daughter Bernice, your excellent and godly works will forever remain indelible and evergreen in our hearts.

Bernice, Rest in Perfect Peace in the Loving and Comforting arms of the Lord Jesus whom you have known, sang for, and served from your childhood —- till we meet again.

Dr. Samuel Kisseadoo, Hampton, Virginia, USA

TRIBUTE FROM– APOSTLE JUDE HAMA

"When we die and leave this earthly body, we will have a body in heaven, an eternal body made for us by God Himself" (2 Corinthians 5:1 NLT).

Mrs. Bernice Offei, you have made the name of Christ heard on all continents through the power of timeless Gospel music, and that was Awesome! Indeed, Princess Bernice is a legend in the Gospel music space. A veritable witness of Christ. Here are excerpts from my all-time favourite of your worship songs:
The heavens are telling Your glory, o Lord
The skies are proclaiming the works of Your hands
The nations are healed at the sound of Your voice
O Alpha, Omega, Your praise we declare

O God of the earth, the sky and the sea;
You're clothed with great splendour and majesty
You stretch out the heavens and send forth the winds;
All creatures extol you for You are their king
You send forth Your word and all things appeared;
The sun and the rain in their seasons to be
All honour and power to you now we bring;
O master, Creator, You are King of all kings.

Immortal You are, Omnipotent too;
Yet gracious, compassionate, loving and true
No other besides You and who can compare;
We blossom, we perish but You are still there
Your glory and praise no mortal can share;
Your presence, so awesome Your foes have to flee
We bow down and worship; we fall at your feet
(All hail ...King of kings (All hail Lord Almighty, all hail King of kings)

Princess Bernice Offei was a woman who was ransomed and restored; forgiven and redeemed by Christ, and she sang it! Her music brings together all strands of the church in worship of the biblical majestic God. And today, we gather to worship Christ and thank God for you, Bernice.

One of the goals of the Christian programs I organize is for the guests to say, "I have encountered Christ and His Holy Spirit here, and I'm thankful". And so, I carefully choose musicians who will help us fulfill that goal. Princess Bernice and her Holy Spirit saturated music was what I turned to again and again. She sang at my Gospel ministry conferences, and my 50th birthday celebration at the La Palm Royal Beach Hotel, my end of service as SU CEO, thanksgiving service at the Accra Ridge church; and at my maiden book launch programme at the Fiesta Royal Hotel, Accra, among others.

Princess Bernice Offei is now "absent from the body, present with the Lord." What happened when Bernice Offei arrived in Heaven?

Tambourines, cymbals, and guitars rose to spontaneous activity. There is rejoicing to welcome the worship Princess into Heaven, the land of all-time worship.

Meanwhile, on earth, her remarkable Gospel ministry works will outlive her. She has left a legacy of a complement of Gospel music lyrics, drama, and videos. Princess Bernice, your legacy outlives you into many further generations.

Our heart goes out in deepest condolences to Prof. Sam Kwame Offei and the boys; and the family. May the wounded hands of Christ touch your wounded hearts with Divine healing and comfort.

Princess Bernice rests well till the last trumpet sounds when all eyes shall see Christ. We shall see Him face to face.

Rest well, Princess Bernice Offei, in the bosom of Christ Jesus your Redeemer King.
Amen!

Apostle Jude Hama, Former National Director & Ceo Scripture Union Ghana

TRIBUTE FROM– BETHEL AGYEMAN DONKOR

To me, she was Bernice. Sometimes Ofeibea. But always a dear friend, a younger sister, and a fellow worker in the Lord's vineyard.

I first met Bernice sometime in or around 1978, when she was a student at Achimota School. I was then a very young lawyer and a member of the Calvary Road Singers (CRS) of Calvary Road Incorporated - a youth evangelistic ministry committed to reaching young people through music, drama and the preaching of the Word of God. One Saturday evening, we went to Achimota to minister to the students and invited those who wished to join the ministry. Bernice was one of those who responded. She came into CRS as a young student, but her devotion soon became evident. She was dependable, rarely missed a meeting, and gave herself fully to the work. What began that Saturday evening became a friendship that lasted for decades. Bernice became my younger sister.

Bernice had a voice you could never mistake. It was distinctive and uniquely hers, but what made her singing special was not simply her voice; it was the heart behind it. She loved the Lord. She sang what she believed, and she lived what she sang. Her commitment to evangelism was equally strong, and in 1980, she was among those selected to join an evangelistic tour of Nigeria.

Bernice decided to learn to play the guitar and asked me to teach her. I remember those early lessons, as I guided her fingers across the fretboard and helped her master the chords. One day her late father watched her practising and asked in Ga: "Ofeibea, nii nɛɛ obaanyɛ otwa?" "Ofeibea, will you really be able to play this thing?"

Bernice persevered - and she did. She went from struggling with simple chords to becoming a skilled guitarist, eventually accompanying herself in ministry. I also had the privilege of hearing some of her songs before they were recorded and helping her fine-tune some of her Twi lyrics. Those moments, ordinary then, are precious memories now.

The last time I heard Bernice minister live was at a birthday gathering for her mother, organised by Harvest Chapel International during a Saturday evening Koinonia service. I did not know then that it would be the last time I would hear her voice publicly in person. Farewell, Bernice. You trusted God without reservation. The words of the Apostle Paul speak powerfully today: "I have fought a good fight, I have finished my course, I have kept the faith." Bernice, you fought the good fight. You finished your course. You kept the faith, and now you are with the Lord whom you loved and served so faithfully.

And so, Ofeibea, one last thing. I can almost imagine you wondering: "Is this going to be a commendation or a reprimand?" Well, Ofeibea - this time there is no reprimand. Only gratitude.

But above all, I thank God that our paths

crossed that Saturday evening at Achimota School. I thank Him for the privilege of knowing you - not merely as the young student who answered a call, but as the devoted Christian, gifted singer, servant of God, friend and sister you became.

Fare thee well, Bernice Ofeibea Offei. You have sung your song on earth. You have kept the faith. May your distinctive voice now join the heavenly choir, praising the One you loved so dearly. Rest in perfect peace, until we meet again.

TRIBUTE FROM– THE KORANTENGS

We first met and got to know Bernice in 1981 at the University of Ghana. As members of the University Christian Fellowship, we met every Friday evening on top of the Bookshop. This was a never-to-be missed two hours of fellowship, and Bernice was ever present.

On a number of occasions, Bernice came to minister in songs at the Legon Baptist Church (LBC) in Commonwealth Hall where we were members. The church was always packed when Bernice was on the programme. This also sometimes meant the "I know, I know choir" would have a break on that particular Sunday. This is the LBC Choir, noted for this favourite hymn "I Know That My Redeemer Lives", which we featured on most Sundays.
Our friendship grew stronger after we left Legon, especially when Bernice was in the UK in the early 90s. After her Master's programme, she returned several times on visits. She spent quite a big chunk of these visits with us in Bicester and in Preston.

We travelled all over the UK with Bernice; visiting friends and family in Aylesbury, Leicester, Milton Keynes, Cardiff, and Liverpool. She sometimes agreed to sing at churches where we had been invited to preach at. As recently as in 2023, when we moved house to the northwest of England to Preston, Bernice and her husband Prof. Kwame Offei were the first to visit and spend time with us in our new home. This made it an extra special and memorable visit for us.

We had lots of fun and laughter together during these visits. I remember one particular visit - we invited a couple of our friends, Noel Tagoe and Joe Mia, where we met at Cosmos in Oxford for a meal. We had so much fun, and everyone in the restaurant kept looking in our area and wondering who this noisy gang was. Another memorable time was when we had lunch on a boat across the Thames in London with live music. No, Bernice was not singing!
Bernice was funny and witty, and anytime we teased her she would say, "with friends like you, who need an enemy." We remember when we invited Bernice to church in Wigan. A couple of Ghanaians in the church could not believe we had just walked in with Bernice. After the service one of them came and asked: "Is that Auntie Bernice? Do you know her? Oh, please, can I take a picture with her?" Bernice overheard her and said, "Of course, come let's take a picture." Your humility is exemplary and attractive and has made a lasting impression on us too. Within minutes of meeting someone, you make them feel like you have known them for years and how important they are to you.

Lydia's cousin in Chicago still says he feels over the moon that his cousin [Lydia] is a friend to Bernice and that she comes to live in our house. He still can't believe Bernice comes to live in our house. To him, Bernice is a mega superstar, but we know Bernice does not see herself that way.

Bernice and Kwame have hosted us several times in their home as well as anytime we were in Ghana. Our holidays are reciprocal in Ghana. We would always start and end our visit in your house. Try as we would, we could not convince either Kevin or Daniel to marry one of our daughters, and Prof. Offei is still working on that. No holiday was considered complete until we had our banku with okro stew with tilapia.

I still see you sitting at the breakfast table on 6th March, 2026 in your house at Agbogba, ...still feels surreal. Kevin made me freshly-

me omelette with hot chocolate. The conversation was normal and when you'll be visiting us too. Indeed "life is so short," just like you sang it.

Anyɛmiyoo permit us to borrow a line from one of our English poets John Keats's 1819 poem "Heard melodies are sweet, but unheard melodies are sweeter." Anyɛmiyoo, you poured out your heart and served us from your "heard melodies," but when we meet in heaven we will be hearing the "unheard melodies." Though the void you have created by leaving us is painful at present, we are comforted that we shall be reunited when the morning comes.

Psalm 30:5 "Sadness may endure for an evening or a night, but joy comes in the morning." We say "Good night" because we are convinced that we will see you in the morning at the other side and declare:

The heavens are telling your glory Oh Lord
The skies are proclaiming the works of your hands
The Nations are healed at the sound of your voice
Oh Alpha Omega your praise we declare
Oh Anyɛmiyoo, Anyɛmiyoo, Lady B, Anyɛmiyoo... Rest well.

Damirifa due

TRIBUTE FROM– DR. GEORGE AMPONSEM

TO A SISTER AND LIFELONG FRIEND

In the early 1980s, amidst the vibrant awakening of the Pentecostal movement on the campus of the University of Ghana, Legon, a profound friendship was born. Our very first encounter took place at a Scripture Union (SU) Outreach team meeting held in the quiet of the Legon Hall vestry right above the hall's reception room. From that pivotal moment, an inseparable bond was forged.

Together, we walked the length and breadth of the campus, ministering from hall to hall. Our shared mission soon took us beyond the boundaries of Legon, carrying the gospel to the Institute of Professional Studies (IPS), Presbyterian Boys' Secondary School (PRESEC), and many other campuses. Those were glorious, foundational days. Bernice would minister powerfully in song, her uniquely beautiful, raspy voice tearing through the melodies of Mary McKee And The Genesis, Aretha Franklin, Keith Greene, and others in the Gospel Song scene in the '80s. I had the profound privilege of supporting her, preaching the Word and praying for the students.

As her ministry grew stronger, I moved with her from event to event and invitation to invitation. I did so with such joy that I soon became affectionately known in some campus circles as simply "the man who carries Bernice's guitar." It was a badge of honour. Witnessing her transition from singing the songs of others to writing, composing, and ministering in her very own original music was nothing short of deeply inspiring.

Life eventually led us down different paths as I moved out of Ghana, while they relocated to the United Kingdom, I moved to Belgium. Distance, however, could not diminish our bond. I fondly remember travelling from Belgium to visit them in the UK during the precious years when their boys were born.

Though the busy tides of life and relocation, with my move to Canada and their return home to Ghana, caused us to briefly lose touch in the 2000s, the Lord reconnected us in the early 2010s. That reconnection birthed a beautiful worship tour across Canada in 2014, where Bernice touched lives and ministered in Calgary, Toronto, and Montreal. Since then, we have remained close, anchoring a friendship that has spanned decades and continents.

Bernice was, and will always remain, a monumental source of inspiration and encouragement in my Christian journey. Her fierce dedication to reaching out to the youth in those early campus years was a massive motivator that shaped my own faith. Over the years, my admiration for her family has only deepened. The dedication, humility, generosity, and transparency that both

Bernice and Kwame lived out every day were palpable to anyone who knew them.

What will forever remain etched in my heart is my last visit to the family home. I did not know that it would be the last goodbye. Thank you, Bernice, for being a true sister, a faithful friend, and an unwavering beacon of God's love. Your race is run, and your impact is eternal.

Farewell, my beloved sister. Rest well in perfect peace, until we meet again in Our Father's bosom.



TRIBUTE FROM– **KAFUI OSUTEYE**

Aunty Bernice, you were such a beautiful soul inside and out! You blessed so many with your exemplary Christian life and your self-composed gospel music.

What a joy and privilege to have called you Aunty and friend! I will treasure all the memories we shared, from your warm and gentle friendship to the pleasure of choreographing your songs and dancing at your album launches to the honour of having you minister a special song at our wedding.

My relocation to the UK and the distance that came with it was not a barrier to our friendship. You kept in touch regularly, and Nii Noi and I had the pleasure of having you stay with us in our home in Canterbury when you visited the UK. And anytime we visited Ghana, Elsie and Emma were thrilled to meet our famous Aunty!

Aunty Bernice, you have fought a good fight. Your race is finished! You are now at peace in the bosom of our Lord.

Your songs are on repeat! You are still ministering into many lives and blessing them! Your legacy will live on!

Rest in perfect peace, Aunty Bernice.

TRIBUTE FROM– NELLY ODOOM

Some people touch our lives through the moments we share with them. Others leave an imprint through the gift they carry. Aunty Bernice did both.

Her music marked so much of my life that many memories are inseparable from her songs. Her first album, released in the early 1990s, was among the first cassette tapes we bought, and we played it endlessly. It became the soundtrack to much of my childhood, accompanying me through both joyful and difficult times and remaining woven into the different seasons of my life.

As I grew older, her music continued to mean something different, yet still deeply familiar. Songs such as "We Are Victors", "What is Man", "The Heavens Are Telling" and "Kaashe Gbeyei" became some of my most cherished songs. They became part of my quiet times with God, especially in moments when I had no more words left to say. Somehow, the words of her songs would well up in my spirit and become my prayer and source of encouragement when I could not find the words myself.

But my memories of Aunty Bernice go beyond her music.

When I began my National Service, Aunty Bernice supported me through a simple yet profoundly meaningful act. Every morning, she gave me a ride to work, arriving at our meeting point at No. 1 Little Legon promptly at 7:00 a.m., never early, never late. Her punctuality left a lasting impression on me. Without saying a word, she gave me a masterclass in discipline. She may have considered the gesture ordinary, but her generosity remains extraordinary in my memory.
That was the kind of person she was: a beautiful soul, kind, generous, warm, and giving.

Today, I realise that I was blessed not only to have lived in a time when her music was part of my life, but also to have personally experienced the beauty of the person behind the music.

Aunty Bernice, your music will live on in my heart, evoking memories of my childhood and years of growing up, quiet moments with God. And what more can I say about your beautiful smile?

I will miss you dearly.

Thank you for the music.

Thank you for your kindness.

May you rest peacefully, knowing that the gift God placed in you touched lives in ways you may never have fully known.

Until we meet again, rest well, Aunty Bernice.

TRIBUTE FROM– DR. MAUREEN IHEANACHO

Many in Ghana, particularly Christians, knew Mrs. Bernice Offei as a gospel musician, songwriter and singer, which she was. I wonder, though, how many would describe her as a theologian. Yet, if we understand theology simply as the way we think about God, then that is what she was, at least in my book. Her songs did not only reflect her knowledge and understanding of the nature of God, His creation, the gift of His Son to humanity as Saviour and His mission in our world. They also expressed her personal faith response. That resonated deeply with me, as I know it also did with thousands of others who loved to listen to her songs. Still, I wonder if Bernice ever saw herself as a formal theologian.

I met Bernice in the mid-1990s at the Legon Interdenominational Church (LIC) when I joined the membership. Bernice sang regularly at the Sunday services, always offering the congregation the first taste of her new songs before the album CDs came out. I especially looked forward to the times when as officiant

alto voice leading the singing made for a delightful worship experience.

One of such enduring highlights for me was the first time I heard her sing the hymn of introspection for confession, 'God Of Mercy And Compassion' (Edmund Vaughan, 1872-1904). Coming from a Roman Catholic background, I had learnt the hymn in my childhood and naturally assumed that it was sung only in the context of the Mass. My initial surprise quickly turned into gratitude. For by singing it, Bernice helped me bridge my Roman Catholic past to my Protestant charismatic present. Every time I hear or sing that hymn since that Sunday service, I remember Bernice.

I grew to love Bernice's songs and we soon became friends. I bought and gave away many of her music CDs as birthday, Easter and Christmas presents. I became a self-proclaimed marketer of her CDs and a devoted encourager. I would ask after each album release, 'When is the next one coming out?' And she would say, "Pray for me, Maureen, that the Lord would give me the songs to write." Thus, I also became a prayer partner.
To show her sincere appreciation for my support and to mark her 30th anniversary in ministry in 2009, Bernice gifted me a framed Citation that hangs prominently on my gallery wall at home. It has assumed more meaning for me now and I re-read her words with her voice ringing in my memory. I am grateful for who she was to me. I will miss her.

Bernice is now singing with the choirs of angels in heaven. May her gentle soul rest in God's eternal peace. May the Lord comfort and console Prof. Kwame Offei, their sons Kevin and Daniel, and the entire family. Amen.
Dr. Maureen Iheanacho (Enugu, Nigeria)

TRIBUTE FROM– SIKA COLEMAN

TO MAMA BERNICE OFFEI (MY VERY 1ST MENTOR)

There are many things
That happen around
There are many scenes
That all seem so sound
But in my whole life
Through all of my days
Every beam of light is just through God's grace
Song title - His Love For Me

Hello Aunt Bernice, my primary aim of meeting you was to conduct a biographical study, a field research project or long essay to enable me graduate successfully with a Bachelor of Arts degree in Music. My Supervisor asked, "Why Bernice Offei?" As a young lady, why a biography of Bernice Offei?

I said, "she is different"; and of truth, you are different.

When I first stepped into your home, I was carrying more scholarly questions than confidence. I didn't know I had just begun a journey to getting schooled on total surrender



to God and His ways. You took time off your busy schedules to attend to all the questionnaires and questions I had penned down from the campus of UCC.

You didn't just offer me answers; you taught

me how to ask the right questions. You also showed me that excellence in singing gospel music doesn't have to come at the cost of losing my very self but rather, accepting my uniqueness and totally surrendering to God in every step of the way

You said, "promotion comes from above." I learnt the strength of patience, listening, and leading by example. I remember when I asked, how have you impacted society apart from your songs? You said, "I organized breast cancer awareness for women; I share with various young groups, but I'd rather not mention my contributions in cash or kind."

Then I asked faintly, "can I meet your husband?" Your response; "why not, I only need to confirm with his schedules." Wow. You took me to Prof., and the fond memories and lessons of that moment lives on.

You received me with grace, clarity, and an unwavering belief in what I could become. You pushed me past my own self-doubt – not because you wanted things to be hard, but because you saw a version of me that I hadn't yet learned to see. Thank you for your time, your generous spirit, your honesty, and the safe haven you created in my mind.

You said "gospel music is different. The minstrel is as important as her song; again the minstrel and the song are deeply inseparable."

The lessons you poured into me go far beyond gifts, talent or education and connection, composition and performance exploits as a minstrel. These cornerstones have shaped how I carry myself, how I treat others, how I guide others, and most importantly my relationship with God.

I am endlessly grateful to walk a little taller because I stand on the shoulders of a giant.

Thank you for being my inspiration.
Thank You for shaping my path
Thank you for being the very first person to see the Gold in Sika
Till we meet again Aunty B, keep resting.

TRIBUTE FROM– AMB. DR. WINFRED NII OKAI HAMMOND

TO A TRULY VIRTUOUS AND GODLY WOMAN

As for man, his days are like grass; he flourishes like a flower of the field; [16]for the wind passes over it, and it is gone, and its place knows it no more (Psalm 103:15-16).

Today, we celebrate the remarkable life of a true woman of God who impacted the lives of many generations.

In July of 1984, a brilliant final year student from the Faculty of Agriculture at the University of Ghana showed up for a three-month internship at the International Institute of Tropical Agriculture (IITA) at Ibadan where I was working as a Junior Scientist.

It was not difficult to identify a life that was a living sermon of grace, love, and unwavering devotion to Jesus Christ, with music engraved in her spirit.

Miss Bernice Djoleto, as she was then known, demonstrated her deep passion for music when she arrived at IITA with her guitar for an academic pursuit. Calling her "Melody" would have been fitting. My family and I were blessed that after long days in the fields, she often came to our apartment after dinner, and with her skills on the guitar and silky-smooth voice, led us in praise and worship before the throne of grace. To her, serving God was not a mere duty, but a lifestyle.

I have no doubt that these were the virtues that attracted the love of her life, Kwame Offei, whom she missed so much and frequently spoke about whilst away on that internship.

Professor Kwame Offei, damirifa due.

Bernice, you were so endowed that you could perfectly combine academics, banking, and an authentic gospel music that won you both

the Best Female Vocal Performance and Songwriter at the 2009 Ghana Music Awards. To God be the glory for this special gift.

Through your music backed by an exemplary lifestyle, you taught millions how to put God first in every season of joy and trial. Your gentle laughter, resilient strength, and profound love for the Word of God remain woven into the fabric of many lives.

You lifted your family, friends, and your community before the throne on several occasions. You were a Pillar of Wisdom with words guided by kindness and seasoned with truth. Through your Hit Songs: "Hold On", "Life Is So Short", "Kaashe Gbeyei", "Nyame Kokroko", among others, you comforted the broken-hearted and pointed everyone back to God.

Though your physical voice is still on this earth, your legacy continues to speak through every life you touched.

Our hearts ache with the deep pain of parting, but we do not grieve as those who have no hope. Because "If only for this life we have hope in Christ, we are of all people most pitiable" (1 Corinthians 15:19).

We rejoice knowing that your faith has now become sight, and you are resting in the loving arms of your Savior. Sing on our beloved sister, as you join the angels to worship before the eternal throne night and day.

Da yie, yaawɔ ojogbaŋŋ. Rest in perfect peace, our dearest Bernice Offei.

TRIBUTE FROM–

FRANK D. AMPONSAH-MENSAH ESQ. AND FAMILY

My Senior, My Senior Prefect, My Big Sister, A cherished friend and a faithful witness!

Too early, Bernice..!! Many fond memories....!

I was your junior in Achimota School by many years but meeting you on Legon Campus, you took me as a younger brother and showed me affection and respect! I still remember you saying, "Herh, Nino Boy, I am your Big Sister ooo," anytime I was teasing you about one thing or the other.

Interviewing you for my Mass Comm project in 1991 with your baby first-born son making interrupting sounds on the tape;

Bumping into you from time to time at Balme Library as you drove up in your brown Nissan ARD 706;

Teasing you about that particular wedding photo;

Visiting you and Kwame (Prof.) at Annex C with Durowaa and later at the different locations on Legon campus, especially your house with the beautiful green lawn;

Commending you on your Albums released and the Award. (My favourite song is 'His Love For Me').

Your surprised comment on seeing my picture with the 'bald head and the grey beard'.

Commending me as I was rising through the ranks (to Principal) at Ghana International School;

Your dedication to Christ, your Music, your Family, your Job and to all you put your hand to...!

Sending all those messages that went unanswered; And then the devastating news!

I planned to but was never able to visit at Agbogba when you mentioned you had moved there from campus;

Go with God, Bernice Ofeibea Djoleto Ofei..! You have more than made your mark and all who are associated with you will call you Blessed!

I will miss chatting with you;
We are all missing you!

From Frank, Durowaa, Maame Afia, Akosua and Nana Yaw Amponsah-Mensah.

TRIBUTE FROM–

DEDO MATE-KODJO

I first met Bernice Offei (née Djoleto) when she arrived at Achimota School as a Form 1 student and was assigned to Clark House, where I was already a Form 2 "veteran." The very first thing I noticed about her was her smile - a warm, radiant smile that crinkled up her eyes. She appeared shy at first, but she had a wonderful gift for conversation, a sharp wit, and a playful side. And my, could she laugh.

We quickly became close friends. When she introduced me to her parents, it marked the beginning of a friendship built on deep mutual respect. In time, my own parents and some of my siblings grew to know and love her as well. I still fondly remember the weekend ritual of sharing "homemade" - the cherished meals our parents brought us during school visits.

I distinctly remember her disappointment when in Form 2, she auditioned for the school choir and wasn't selected. But Bernice didn't let that setback define her. Instead, she taught herself to play the guitar. That quiet resilience birthed the deeply profound, faith-filled songs that comforted and encouraged so many to trust in God.

Bernice was a dedicated, serious student who remained remarkably focused on her goals. She pursued the sciences and went on to become Girls' Senior Prefect in 1981.
When my family moved to Osu in 1980, we became closer, occasionally visiting each other and arranging to visit other friends in the neighbourhood. Around 1981–1982, she introduced me to a prayer group that met at Ridge Church, and we would walk together from Osu to Ridge to join in the prayer sessions. Then life took us in different directions. I left Ghana on a scholarship in 1982, and we lost touch for seven years. On my return, we unexpectedly bumped into each other at the bank where she was working. I visited her office and, later, she invited my family to her home in Legon to meet hers. During the ensuing years, her songs became the daily soundtrack to my family's commute to work and school.

I travelled abroad once again, returning in 2017, now having completely lost contact. Learning of her passing was a profound shock. Bernice poured her heart, belief, and unwavering faith into every song she wrote, becoming the legendary gospel icon we know, love, and mourn today.

Rest in perfect peace, dear Bernice. God loves you. Rest in perfect peace.

TRIBUTE FROM–

MONICA SENANU

My sweet, calm, beautiful, and stylish Auntie Bernice,

As a young girl, I watched you on television singing gospel music and playing the guitar. You were the first woman I had ever seen doing both, and I was captivated. I listened closely to the lyrics you sang in your unique and beautiful voice, and they touched my heart deeply.

Over the years, I attended your album launches, treasured your cassettes, and later CDs. I saved and bought them as gifts for friends. Through your music, you blessed our hearts and filled our homes with worship and joy.

I finally got to know you personally when we sat together in church one day and you struck up a conversation with me. We chatted so easily, and from that moment, a beautiful friendship began.
Auntie Bernice, you led so many of us into worship through your songs. One of my favorites has always been "The Heavens Are Telling the Glory of God." Through your music, you inspired countless people to draw closer to God.

You loved my girls dearly. You prayed for them, encouraged them, and celebrated every achievement, no matter how big or small. You lived as a witness of Christ and when one of the girls had a muslim roommate in Uni, your

encouragement to her was "be a witness, I will be praying for you."

I remember that whenever we came to church and the welcome song began, they would make a beeline across the sanctuary to greet you and receive one of your warm hugs before greeting anyone else. That is how much they loved you, and how much you loved them in return.

Their admiration for you was so great that we had to buy them guitars when they were young because they wanted to sing and play just like you. You were a role model to them in every sense of the word.
You also had a heart full of gratitude. I once did some small legal work for you, but your appreciation was overwhelming. You thanked me so generously and thoughtfully, showering me with beautiful gifts that I will always remember.

Today, Heaven has received God's unique songstress. I can only imagine you joining the heavenly choir and continuing to do what you loved most: worshipping our Heavenly Father with all your heart.
Thank you for being our Auntie Bernice. Thank you for your music, your prayers, your encouragement, your friendship, and your love.

Until we meet again, may your beautiful voice continue to resound in the presence of the King.

Rest well, Auntie Bernice in the bosom of the Lord.

TRIBUTE TO AUNTIE BERNICE –

FROM NANA ADJOA AND NANA AKUA SENANU



Sometimes, we believe that the closest relationships can only be shared with those connected to us by blood. Yet, through fellowship in Christ, we meet people whose love reminds us that family is also formed through the heart, and in this instance, through a common faith in God.

For us, Aunty Bernice was one such person. She loved us like her own nieces and showed us the love of Christ through her kindness, warmth and care. She was our role model, our

heroine and a very special Aunt.

So, we looked out for her at various church events and would make a beeline to her whenever possible! For example, when it was time to welcome each-other at church service. Though many times older, with a sweet and knowing smile and her arms wide open, she would give each of us a hug. Those embraces meant the world to us, because she made us feel truly loved.

With Aunty Bernice, we never had to wonder whether we belonged or had to be cautious about sharing our challenges. She regularly asked us about our schoolwork, enquired about our extracurricular activities and consistently encouraged us to do much better. She took a genuine interest in everything we did, celebrating our achievements and demonstrating how proud she was of us. The things that mattered to us mattered to her, too! And that encouraged us to share deeply with her.

Aunty Bernice, we were truly your nieces, and you were truly our Aunty! No blood connection was needed to make this bond real. We thank you for every smile and appreciate you for every embrace. We will remember you for every word of encouragement and emulate how you expressed God's love selflessly. We will surely miss you dearly, but we are happy to note that you are with the Lord! You remain forever in our hearts! God bless you and keep you!

With love, Nana Adjoa & Nana Akua Senanu





Appreciation

The family of the late **Bernice Ofeibea Offei** wishes to express their profound gratitude for your presence, prayers and support during this time.

We thank you for joining us to celebrate a life well lived.

Thank You